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Emergency Preparedness Quick Start

Do these first. Write down your choices, share them with your household, and practice them.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

If danger is immediate: follow official instructions and move to safety. Do not delay an evacuation to finish a plan or collect supplies.

TODAY: MAKE CONTACT POSSIBLE

- ☐ Choose one out-of-area contact everyone can reach.
- ☐ Save local emergency-alert and trusted information sources.
- ☐ Pick two meeting places: one near home and one outside your neighborhood.
- ☐ Write the plan on paper; place a copy in each go-bag.

Go deeper: Use **COM-003** to set up alerts, **COM-004** to save official sources, and **STH-005** to plan caregiver contacts, pickup, and reunification.

If you spot a suspected wildfire: use **COM-001 — Report a Wildfire Sighting**.

NEXT: PLAN HOW YOU WILL LEAVE

- ☐ Choose more than one route and decide where you could stay.
- ☐ Plan transportation now; include a backup if you do not drive.
- ☐ List the help, equipment, medication, communication, and power each person needs.
- ☐ Include every animal: carrier or restraint, transport, identification, supplies, and a destination that will accept it.

Go deeper: Use **STH-004 — Disability & Access Planning** for individual access and functional needs, and **STH-006 — Animal Planning** for pets, service animals, and other animals.

THEN: KNOW WHAT MAY HAPPEN

- ☐ Ask your local emergency-management authority which hazards affect your address and what actions it recommends.
- ☐ Use **STH-003 — Know Your Local Hazards** to record the official alerts and protective actions for your location.
- ☐ Practice one part of the plan, then update names, routes, and needs.

Emergency Preparedness Quick Start — continued

COMPLETE YOUR HOUSEHOLD PLAN

Use **EVS-001 — Evacuation Readiness Checklist** to track readiness, **EVS-002** for portable go-bags, **EVS-003** for departure decisions, **EVS-004** for routes, and **EVS-005** for transportation. Use **COM-005** to record contacts and meeting places.

Build supplies next: use **STH-002 — Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit**. Store what your household can safely carry and use.

Keep the plan usable: use **STH-007 — Annual Binder & Kit Review** every year and after a household change, move, drill, or emergency. Replace expired supplies and update contacts, routes, equipment, medications, and care needs when they change.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Make a Plan,” “Alerts & Warnings,” “Evacuation,” “Build A Kit,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” “Prepare Your Family,” “Pets and Animals,” and “Get Tech Ready.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit

Build a portable go-bag for leaving quickly, then build a separate two-week supply for staying at home. A full two-week home supply is not meant to be carried during an evacuation.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Local direction comes first: hazards, climate, water availability, and evacuation conditions vary. Follow local emergency-management and public-health authorities whenever their current instructions or recommended quantities differ from this checklist.

1. WRITE DOWN THE PLANNING NUMBERS

Household members: adults ____ + children ____ = **people** ____

Animals (list species and number): _____

Two-week planning period: **14 days** | Go-bag planning period set by local authorities: ____ days

Use each person's real daily needs—not an average—when the table says “daily use.” Round up and allow for spills, delays, or damaged supplies where space and budget permit.

Need	Two-week home calculation	Quantity to obtain
Water	1 gallon × ____ people × 14 days = ____ gallons minimum. Plan more for pregnancy, illness, hot climates, and hygiene or medical needs. Add each animal's usual daily water × 14.	People: ____ gal Animals: ____ gal
Shelf-stable food	3 meals × ____ people × 14 days = ____ person-meals, adjusted to normal portions. Add snacks or formula as needed.	____ meals Other: _____
Medications and health supplies	Each person's daily use × 14, **only when permitted** by the prescriber, pharmacist, insurer, and law. Include prescriptions, over-the-counter items, and supplies used with medicines or medical devices.	Person/item: _____ Qty: ____ Refills due: ____
Sanitation and hygiene	Each person's daily use × 14 for diapers, menstrual products, incontinence items, wipes, and other consumables. Add soap, toilet paper, trash bags, ties, and a safe backup toilet method.	_____ Qty: ____
Lighting	One flashlight or headlamp for each person who can use one, plus area lighting. Calculate replacement batteries or recharge cycles for 14 days from the device instructions. Prefer lights to candles.	Lights: ____ Batteries/cycles: ____

Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit — continued

Need	Two-week home calculation	Quantity to obtain
Communications	At least one battery-powered or hand-crank weather radio; a charged phone/device for each user; paper contact and meeting plans; local map.	Radios: ____ Devices: ____
Power	For every essential device, list watt-hours, battery type, or recharge cycles needed across 14 days. Prioritize medical, mobility, communication, and refrigeration needs; make a power-outage plan with the utility and care team.	Device: _____ Batteries/charges: ____
Cash	Choose an amount for 14 days of essential local purchases; include small bills and coins. Do not keep more than you can store securely.	$____ total
Documents	One protected paper or offline copy set for the household: identification, contacts, prescriptions, insurance, financial and medical information, plans, and animal records.	Paper sets: ____ Offline copies: ____
Climate and clothing	One season-appropriate change/layer set per person, then add blankets, rain protection, sun protection, sturdy shoes, heating/cooling aids, and other items for local conditions.	Sets: ____ Other: _____
Animal supplies	Each animal's usual daily food, water, medicine, litter, and other consumables × 14. Include bowls, sanitation supplies, records, identification, carrier, leash, harness, or other safe restraint.	Food: ____ Water: ____ Medicine/other: ____

Water is the minimum priority: CDC and the American Red Cross recommend storing at least **1 gallon per person per day**; the Red Cross lists a **two-week supply for home** and a **three-day supply for evacuation**. Your local authority may set a different evacuation amount.

Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit — continued

2. PACK THE PORTABLE GO-BAG SEPARATELY

Pack only what each person can safely move, or arrange help. Do **not** delay an evacuation to collect supplies.

- ☐ Water and ready-to-eat food for the evacuation period recommended by local authorities—not the entire two-week home supply
- ☐ Essential medicines, copies of prescriptions, medical and accessibility supplies, and a list of health needs
- ☐ Phone, charging cable, power bank, battery/hand-crank radio, flashlight or headlamp, and spare batteries
- ☐ Identification and protected copies of contacts, plans, insurance, and other essential records
- ☐ Small bills, keys, local map, basic first aid, hygiene items, masks, sturdy shoes, and climate layers
- ☐ For children and animals: essential food, water, medicines, comfort items, identification, and safe restraints

Label bags. Keep medical, communication, mobility, sensory, and animal items beside the person or animal who needs them. Review transport, shelter, and backup-power arrangements with support networks before an emergency.

3. CHOOSE FOOD AND SUPPLIES PEOPLE CAN USE

- ☐ Choose shelf-stable foods that require little water, refrigeration, or cooking. Include a manual can opener and utensils.
- ☐ Plan for allergies, intolerances, religious or cultural diets, diabetes or other medical diets, infant feeding, and texture or feeding assistance. Check every label; do not assume an emergency food is safe.
- ☐ Include glasses, hearing-aid batteries, communication boards, mobility-device parts, chargers, adaptive utensils, service-animal supplies, and sensory or comfort items as applicable.
- ☐ Ask a clinician or pharmacist how to obtain and safely store an emergency medication supply; never change doses or use expired medicine unless an authorized official specifically directs it.

Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit — continued

4. STORE SAFELY AND ROTATE

- ☐ Keep supplies accessible, dry, and protected from pests, flooding, extreme temperatures, and household chemicals. Do not block an exit. Split heavy water and food among smaller containers or locations.
- ☐ Use unopened commercially bottled water by its printed date. For water you fill yourself, use sanitized food-grade containers, label the date, keep them cool and out of direct sunlight, and replace the water every 6 months. Never use a container that held toxic chemicals.
- ☐ Keep food in a cool, dry place in closed containers. Discard cans that are leaking, bulging, badly dented, or heavily rusted. When in doubt about food safety, throw it out; never taste food to test it.
- ☐ Store medicines exactly as their labels or pharmacist direct, secured from children and animals. Keep batteries and power banks dry and at manufacturer-recommended temperatures; inspect for swelling, leaks, corrosion, or damage.
- ☐ Every 6 months—and after using the kit—check water replacement dates, food and medicine dates, batteries and charge levels, document accuracy, clothing fit, animal needs, and seasonal hazards. Use and replace items before they expire when safe to do so.

Next check date: ____ / ____ / _____ Checked by: _____

Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit — continued

5. BUILD IT IN STAGES

If buying everything now is not possible, start with what you already have. Do not take on unsafe debt or skip current medicines, food, rent, or utilities.

1. **This week:** pack evacuation essentials and three days of water, food, medicines, sanitation items, and lighting.

2. **Next:** add one day per person and animal at a time until the home supply reaches 14 days.

3. **Then:** add communications, backup power, documents, cash, climate, accessibility, and comfort items in the order most critical to your household.

4. **Keep it ready:** rotate supplies into normal use, replace them gradually, and revisit the plan when household needs or local guidance change.

Ask local emergency management, public health, utilities, schools, disability organizations, food assistance programs, animal services, and community groups about local guidance or assistance.

Go deeper: Use **EVS-002** for portable go-bags, **COM-005** for household contacts, **STH-004–006** for access, caregiver, and animal needs, and **STH-007** for maintenance records.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Build A Kit,” “Personal Needs,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” and “Pets and Animals”; CDC, “Creating and Storing an Emergency Water Supply”; American Red Cross, “Survival Kit Supplies”; FDA, “Food.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

Know Your Local Hazards

Research the hazards that could affect the places you use, record the official instruction for each one, and recheck it regularly.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

During an emergency, current instructions from local authorities take priority over this worksheet. General preparedness guidance helps you plan; it does not set local evacuation zones, routes, shelter locations, alert thresholds, or re-entry rules.

1. LIST THE PLACES TO CHECK

Place	Address or route	People, animals, access, or transport needs
Home		
Workplace(s)		
School / care site		
Common travel routes		

2. ASK OFFICIAL SOURCES

- ☐ **Local emergency management:** ask which hazards affect each place, who can order evacuation or sheltering, and where official zone and route information is published.
- ☐ **Official alerting services:** enroll every household member who can receive alerts; note coverage, languages, accessibility features, and a backup method. Wireless Emergency Alerts require no sign-up, but local opt-in systems may.
- ☐ **Map owners:** check official evacuation-zone maps and, where applicable, flood, fire, earthquake, tsunami, dam, landslide, severe-weather, or other hazard maps. Record the map issuer, layer, and date—not only a screenshot.
- ☐ **Workplaces, schools, and care sites:** request their emergency, reunification, closure, and transportation procedures.
- ☐ **Utility providers:** ask about hazard-specific shutoffs, outage alerts, safe service interruption, medical-equipment programs, and restoration information.
- ☐ **Insurance and property records:** review declarations, exclusions, deductibles, inventories, surveys, disclosures, permits, and assessor or recorder documents. Ask the insurer or record holder to explain unclear entries.

Map caution: a map may describe one hazard or planning purpose only. Do not treat an insurance, parcel, or risk map as an evacuation order. Confirm its purpose with the issuing authority.

Know Your Local Hazards — continued

Use one record for every hazard at every place it affects. Duplicate these pages when needed.

HAZARD RECORD A

Hazard		**Places affected**	☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes
Warning signs I may observe			
Official alert source	Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method:		
Protective action	What the issuing authority says to do:		
Evacuate or shelter trigger	Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it:		
Seasonal timing	Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”):		
Household-specific complications	Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits:		
Information verified	Date: _____	**Verified with**	Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____

Know Your Local Hazards — continued

HAZARD RECORD B

Hazard		**Places affected**	☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes
Warning signs I may observe			
Official alert source	Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method:		
Protective action	What the issuing authority says to do:		
Evacuate or shelter trigger	Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it:		
Seasonal timing	Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”):		
Household-specific complications	Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits:		
Information verified	Date: _____	**Verified with**	Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____

Know Your Local Hazards — continued

Record what an official source says, not what a neighbor, social post, or unlabeled map assumes.

HAZARD RECORD C

Hazard		**Places affected**	☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes
Warning signs I may observe			
Official alert source	Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method:		
Protective action	What the issuing authority says to do:		
Evacuate or shelter trigger	Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it:		
Seasonal timing	Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”):		
Household-specific complications	Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits:		
Information verified	Date: _____	**Verified with**	Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____

Know Your Local Hazards — continued

HAZARD RECORD D

Hazard		**Places affected**	☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes
Warning signs I may observe			
Official alert source	Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method:		
Protective action	What the issuing authority says to do:		
Evacuate or shelter trigger	Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it:		
Seasonal timing	Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”):		
Household-specific complications	Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits:		
Information verified	Date: _____	**Verified with**	Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____

Know Your Local Hazards — continued

Finish the local blanks, compare hazards across places, and carry the results into your plans.

LOCAL DETAILS STILL TO RESOLVE

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Local emergency-management authority: _____

[VERIFY] Official local alert service and enrollment page/number: _____

[VERIFY] Evacuation-zone map issuer, URL/office, and my zone(s): _____

[VERIFY] Locally applicable flood/fire/earthquake or other map(s): _____

[VERIFY] Utility emergency/outage sources: _____

[VERIFY] Workplace, school/care, and route authorities: _____

[VERIFY] Insurance contact and relevant property-record office: _____

Verified by: _____ Date: _____ Next review: _____

TURN RESEARCH INTO ACTION

- ☐ Compare hazards across home, work, school/care, and routes; identify alternatives where one event could affect several places.
- ☐ Save official sources on phones and on paper. Keep a battery-radio or other backup method appropriate to local guidance.
- ☐ Write zone names and triggers into the household plan; do not preselect a route that officials may close.
- ☐ Discuss assistance, transport, medicines, power, communication, and animal needs before an alert.
- ☐ Review after a move, school/job/route change, insurance renewal, map revision, major incident, or official guidance update—and at least annually.

Know Your Local Hazards — continued

BINDER FOLLOW-THROUGH

Section 7 — Hazard Guides: use the guide for each hazard you identify to learn protective actions and hazard-specific supplies. Confirm every locally controlled trigger, zone, and instruction with its issuing authority.

Section 8 — Plans & Records: transfer verified alerts, contacts, meeting places, evacuation/shelter decisions, access needs, insurance information, inventories, and review dates into the household plan and protected records.

SOURCES

General preparedness and alerting: Ready.gov, “Be Informed” and “Alerts and Warnings”; FEMA, “Integrated Public Alert & Warning System for the American People”; and USA.gov, “State Emergency Management Agencies.” Mapping: FEMA, “Flood Maps”; U.S. Geological Survey, “Earthquake Hazards Program”; and U.S. Department of Agriculture Forest Service, “Wildfire Risk to Communities.” Records: National Association of Insurance Commissioners, “Disaster Preparedness.” All accessed September 25, 2026. Local instructions must be supplied and verified by the responsible local authority.

Disability & Access Planning

Plan around what you need to stay safe, communicate, move, receive support, and use essential equipment—not around a label or diagnosis.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

If danger is immediate: follow official instructions and move to safety. Tell responders about urgent access, communication, medical, or equipment needs.

START WITH YOUR USUAL DAY

Think through each activity you may need to do at home, while leaving, in transit, and at a shelter. Include supports you use sometimes as well as every day.

- ☐ I identified how I receive warnings and communicate if power, internet, speech, hearing, or vision access changes.
- ☐ I planned how I will move through doorways, stairs, smoke, debris, or unfamiliar spaces.
- ☐ I identified any help I want with transfers, positioning, personal care, eating, or drinking.
- ☐ I packed sensory supports and wrote down ways to reduce noise, light, touch, or crowding.
- ☐ I chose cognitive supports, such as a simple sequence, pictures, reminders, familiar items, or a calm guide.

TRANSPORTATION AND SHELTER PROMPTS

- ☐ Ask local emergency management and transportation providers how to request accessible evacuation transportation. What is the backup?
- ☐ Will the ride accommodate the person, mobility device, support person, service animal, and essential supplies together?
- ☐ Which destinations can meet access needs? Confirm entrances, routes, toilets, cots, charging, refrigeration, communication access, and personal assistance.
- ☐ How will the household reconnect if separated? Keep destination and contact information in more than one accessible format.
- ☐ Practice the route and boarding plan without creating risk. Update the plan when needs, equipment, or providers change.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Do not assume a shelter has the support or equipment you need. Ask the responsible local authority before an emergency, and keep an alternate destination and transportation plan.

Disability & Access Planning — continued

BUILD A SUPPORT NETWORK

Choose people you trust—near home, work, or other regular locations. A network member should agree before being included.

- ☐ Share only the parts of the plan each person needs. Exchange keys or access instructions only if you choose.
- ☐ Agree who will check in, who can assist, and who has a backup role.
- ☐ Show helpers how you prefer to communicate and how to assist with mobility or transfers; do not let anyone guess or improvise unsafe techniques.
- ☐ Practice contacting one another and review the plan at least when information or needs change.

PLAN FOR HEALTH, EQUIPMENT, AND POWER

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Make these plans with the right experts. Discuss medical contingencies with relevant clinicians; equipment operation and backup power with the supplier or manufacturer; outage programs with the utility; and evacuation, shelter, and emergency-power options with local authorities. This handout does not establish safe device runtimes, battery sizes, medication changes, or clinical instructions.

MEDICATIONS AND REFRIGERATION

- ☐ Keep a current list of medication names, doses, schedules, allergies, prescriber, and pharmacy.
- ☐ Ask the prescriber and pharmacist what to do if a dose, refill, evacuation, contamination, or temperature control is disrupted.
- ☐ For each refrigerated item, get product-specific storage and outage instructions from the pharmacist, clinician, or manufacturer.
- ☐ Use a cooler or discard a product only according to verified product-specific instructions. Do not guess from appearance or a general time limit.
- ☐ Plan how medicines and supplies will travel with you, within required temperature limits and legal requirements.

Disability & Access Planning — continued

DURABLE MEDICAL EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRICITY

Include mobility, breathing, communication, monitoring, transfer, feeding, and other equipment you rely on.

- ☐ Record the exact equipment name, model, serial number, supplier, and support number.
- ☐ Ask the supplier or manufacturer for written shutdown, transport, storage, charging, and backup instructions for the exact model.
- ☐ Ask the clinician for a written contingency plan if equipment is unavailable, damaged, or loses power.
- ☐ Identify compatible backup equipment and power sources. Have a qualified provider confirm connections, ventilation, capacity, maintenance, and safe location.
- ☐ Register for any applicable utility or local emergency program, but do not treat registration as a guarantee of priority restoration or evacuation help.
- ☐ Test and maintain batteries or backup systems only as directed. Never use a fuel-burning generator indoors, in a garage, or near openings.

SERVICE ANIMALS

- ☐ Plan for the animal to remain with its handler during transportation and sheltering; ask local authorities about accessible arrangements.
- ☐ Pack food, water, medicines, bowls, waste supplies, leash or harness, identification, and veterinary information.
- ☐ Identify alternate handlers and care options if the handler cannot provide care.
- ☐ Do not separate, distract, feed, or handle a service animal without the handler's permission.

Disability & Access Planning — continued

PORTABLE SUPPORT-INFORMATION WORKSHEET

Complete only the fields you choose. Use your own words. This is not a requirement for receiving help.

My name or the name I want used: _____

Date reviewed: _____ **Preferred language:** _____

How I communicate best: _____

How to provide information to me (plain words, large print, writing, interpreter, extra time, other):

_____

What helps me understand, remember, or stay regulated:

_____

Mobility, guiding, positioning, or transfer assistance I want:

_____

Do not move or assist me this way: _____

Essential equipment and where it travels with me:

_____

Equipment supplier / support contact: _____

Power, charging, or refrigeration plan: _____

Medications or health information I choose to share:

_____

Service animal support or supplies: _____

Sensory, food, personal-care, or other support needs:

_____

People I authorize helpers to contact:

1. _____ Relationship/role: _____

Phone / other contact: _____

2. _____ Relationship/role: _____

Phone / other contact: _____

Where to find my separate clinical and equipment instructions:

_____

Other information I choose to share: _____

_____

Disability & Access Planning — continued

PROTECT THIS INFORMATION

- ☐ Include only information you want another person to see; leave any field blank.
- ☐ Keep paper copies in a closed, water-resistant holder. Do not display sensitive details on the outside of a bag.
- ☐ Protect digital copies with device access controls and secure sharing. Avoid public links or unencrypted messages for sensitive records.
- ☐ Give copies only to people you choose. Retrieve old copies and update or destroy them securely when information changes.
- ☐ Carry essential instructions, but consider keeping detailed records separately with a trusted contact or in protected storage.

Disability & Access Planning — continued

ESSENTIAL INSTRUCTIONS TO COPY AND CARRY

Written instructions should be specific to you and the exact product or support. Ask the appropriate clinician, pharmacist, supplier, or manufacturer to verify them.

- ☐ Current medication list, allergies, prescriber, pharmacy, and verified missed-dose or disruption instructions
- ☐ Care, communication, behavior-support, mobility, transfer, positioning, or personal-assistance instructions you choose to share
- ☐ Equipment model information and verified setup, shutdown, transport, cleaning, charging, and backup instructions
- ☐ Verified refrigeration requirements and what to do after a temperature excursion
- ☐ Emergency contacts, support-network roles, insurance details, and copies of identification you choose to carry
- ☐ Advance directives or other legal documents, if applicable, stored and shared according to your wishes and local law

BEFORE YOU CALL THE PLAN READY

- ☐ I can reach alerts, plans, and contacts in the formats I use.
- ☐ My primary and backup transportation plans address my access needs.
- ☐ My likely destinations can support me, my equipment, and my service animal.
- ☐ My network knows its roles and has practiced the plan.
- ☐ My medication, refrigeration, equipment, and power contingencies were verified by the relevant experts.
- ☐ My go-bag contains the supplies and copies of instructions I chose to carry.
- ☐ My portable worksheet is current, protected, and shared only as I choose.

RELATED START HERE HANDOUTS

Continue with STH-001 — Emergency Preparedness Quick Start, STH-002 — Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit, STH-003 — Know Your Local Hazards, and STH-007 — Annual Binder & Kit Review.

Disability & Access Planning — continued

SOURCES

Sources and further planning tools

U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Ready.gov, “Individuals with Disabilities”.

U.S. Department of Justice, ADA.gov, “Emergency Planning”.

U.S. Food and Drug Administration, “Emergency Power Planning Checklist”.

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Administration for Strategic Preparedness and Response, HHS emPOWER Program.

Accessed 2026-09-25.

Child & Caregiver Planning

Make one reunification and care plan for children and anyone who relies on another person for transportation, communication, personal care, supervision, or decision support.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Official instructions take priority. Follow evacuation, shelter, school-release, and other directions from the responsible authority. Never return to a closed or dangerous area to reach a meeting place.

PEOPLE, CONTACTS, AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Person who Needs Support	Need / Responsibility	Primary Caregiver	Backup Caregiver

Out-of-area contact: _____ **Phone / method:** _____

School, child care, or care program: _____ **Phone:** _____

Authorized pickup people: _____

People who must not pick up: _____

RECONNECTION AND TRANSPORTATION

Near-home meeting place: _____

Outside-neighborhood meeting place: _____

Primary safe destination: _____ **Backup:** _____

Primary transportation: _____ **Backup:** _____

- ☐ Each caregiver understands the school or care site's emergency, release, and reunification rules.
- ☐ Children and other household members know who may pick them up and how to reach the out-of-area contact.
- ☐ Transportation can carry each person, essential equipment, supplies, and service animal together.
- ☐ Caregivers have keys, permissions, identification, instructions, and safe access to needed supplies.
- ☐ A paper copy is stored in each go-bag and given to each caregiver in a usable format.

Child & Caregiver Planning — continued

CARE DETAILS TO CARRY

Preferred communication, language, or calming method: _____

Medicine, allergy, dietary, mobility, medical, sensory, or personal-care instructions:

_____

Essential equipment, comfort item, or supply location: _____

- ☐ Private information is limited to what each caregiver needs and is stored securely.
- ☐ The plan was practiced on: _____
- ☐ Contacts and permissions were verified on: _____ Next review: _____

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Make a Plan” and “Individuals with Disabilities”; Ready Kids, “Prepare Your Family.” Accessed September 25, 2026.

Animal Planning

Plan for every animal before an alert. Identify who will move each animal, what they need, where they can go, and what happens if normal transport is not possible.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Act early for livestock: loading and moving large animals takes time, trained handlers, suitable vehicles, and a confirmed destination. Follow current instructions from local emergency management, animal control, agricultural extension, and your veterinarian. Do not enter a threatened area or delay your own evacuation to move an animal.

PREPARE EVERY ANIMAL

- ☐ Use permanent identification when appropriate; add a securely attached temporary contact label. Keep current photos showing the animal and its identifying features, including a photo with the owner or handler.
- ☐ Protect copies of veterinary, vaccination, prescription, registration, microchip, ownership, and any health-certificate records. Keep veterinarian and poison-control contact information with them.
- ☐ Pack current medications, written dosing and care instructions, and needed administration supplies. Ask the veterinarian how to manage medicines requiring refrigeration.
- ☐ Rotate animal food and drinking water; pack bowls or feeders, a manual can opener if needed, and species-appropriate sanitation supplies.
- ☐ Practice calm confinement and loading with the carrier, crate, leash, harness, halter, or other restraint the animal will actually use.
- ☐ Name a primary and backup caregiver. Give each person written permission, access instructions, the animal inventory, and a way to reach the veterinarian.
- ☐ Confirm more than one evacuation destination and route. Ask each destination what species it accepts, what records or equipment it requires, and whether owner and animal can remain together.

Do not assume a public shelter, hotel, boarding facility, fairground, or rescue site will accept an animal. Rules, capacity, opening times, and health requirements vary and can change during an incident. Verify them locally before leaving and again when officials activate evacuation or shelter sites.

Animal Planning — continued

HOUSEHOLD PETS

- ☐ Assign one carrier or safe restraint to each pet; label it with animal and household contact information.
- ☐ Pack litter and a pan, waste bags, cleaning supplies, familiar bedding, and species-specific heat, light, habitat, or handling equipment.
- ☐ Identify pet-friendly lodging, boarding, friends or relatives, and any locally designated animal sheltering. Keep an option outside the immediate hazard area.
- ☐ Plan for frightened or hiding pets: record likely hiding places and keep safe capture tools where they are accessible.

SERVICE ANIMALS

A service animal is not a pet. Keep the animal with its handler whenever possible and include its work and access needs in the household plan.

- ☐ Pack food, water, medicines, sanitation supplies, a leash or harness, and any gear needed for the animal's work. Do not separate the animal from the handler's essential mobility, communication, medical, or power equipment.
- ☐ Plan accessible transport with enough space for the handler, animal, mobility device, and supplies. Arrange an accessible backup vehicle and driver.
- ☐ Record the animal's tasks, commands, routine, stress signals, and care instructions in case a backup caregiver must assist.
- ☐ Verify current shelter and transport arrangements with local officials. Under the ADA, service animals generally accompany people with disabilities in public facilities; different rules may apply to animals that provide comfort but are not trained to perform a disability-related task.

Animal Planning — continued

LIVESTOCK AND OTHER LARGE ANIMALS

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Use local, incident-specific direction: suitable routes, loading sites, movement controls, health documentation, shelter locations, and options for animals left in place depend on the hazard and jurisdiction. Generic advice cannot confirm that a road or facility is safe or open.

- ☐ Maintain a current herd or flock inventory. Record species, number, identification, photographs, usual location, ownership, veterinarian, and special handling or medical needs.
- ☐ Map gates, pens, pastures, barns, water shutoffs, feed, handling equipment, and vehicle access. Give the map and access information to caregivers.
- ☐ Keep species-appropriate halters, leads, panels, gates, cages, loading aids, and protective equipment ready and in working order.
- ☐ Confirm enough suitable towing vehicles, trailers, drivers, handlers, fuel, and accessible loading space. Practice loading before an emergency; never exceed equipment ratings.
- ☐ Set a loading order that accounts for temperament, compatibility, medical needs, young animals, and the time each group needs. Keep incompatible animals separated.
- ☐ Confirm destinations with the facility and local authorities. Ask about capacity, identification, health records, biosecurity, feed and water, sanitation, unloading, and who provides daily care.

IF NORMAL HOUSEHOLD TRANSPORT WILL NOT WORK

1. **Identify the gap now.** Note animals that are too large, numerous, difficult to handle, medically fragile, or unable to use the available vehicle or carrier.
2. **Arrange qualified help.** Make written primary and backup arrangements with trained caregivers, transporters, boarding facilities, neighbors, or mutual-aid partners. Confirm how they will gain access and who may authorize care.
3. **Set an early trigger.** Decide when to call and load—before roads, air quality, weather, staffing, or animal behavior make movement unsafe. Reconfirm the plan during high-risk periods.
4. **Plan a locally approved alternative.** Ask local emergency management, animal control, agricultural extension, and the veterinarian what to do if evacuation is impossible. Record only instructions verified for the location, species, and hazard; do not release animals or improvise an unsafe move.

Animal Planning — continued

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Verify locally before an incident:

Emergency-management / evacuation instructions: [VERIFY] _____

Animal control / activated animal sheltering: [VERIFY] _____

Agricultural-extension contact and livestock guidance: [VERIFY] _____

Veterinarian / emergency veterinary service: [VERIFY] _____

Transporter and backup transporter: [VERIFY] _____

Related handouts: use **STH-001 — Emergency Preparedness Quick Start** for immediate priorities; **STH-002 — Build a Two-Week Preparedness Kit** for shared supplies; **STH-003 — Know Your Local Hazards** for local alerts and protective actions; and **STH-007 — Annual Binder & Kit Review** to keep this plan current. Follow the detailed animal plan on this handout when a general checklist differs.

Animal Planning — continued

ANIMAL INVENTORY AND EVACUATION WORKSHEET

Complete one row for each animal or clearly identified compatible group. Attach extra pages, photos, records, maps, and written care instructions. Update after any change.

Animal / group and species	Identification and current photo reference	Usual location	Handling considerations
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Carrier, restraint, or handling equipment and location	Loading order	Confirmed destination and route
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Animal Planning — continued

CARE AND BACKUP ARRANGEMENTS

Primary caregiver / handler: _____ **Phone:** _____

Access and written authorization: _____

Veterinarian / clinic: _____ **Phone:** _____

Primary transporter / vehicle / trailer: _____

Backup caregiver: _____ **Phone:** _____

Backup destination: _____

Backup transport and loading arrangement: _____

Plan for animals that cannot use normal household transport:

_____

_____

Early-action trigger: _____

Medication, food, water, sanitation, or accessibility notes:

_____

Last verified (date / by whom): _____

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Pets and Animals”; CDC Healthy Pets, Healthy People, “Emergency Preparedness”; U.S. Department of Justice Civil Rights Division, “Frequently Asked Questions about Service Animals and the ADA”; and USDA APHIS, “Animal Health Emergency Management.” Accessed 2026-09-25. Local evacuation, shelter, agricultural-extension, animal-control, and veterinary instructions must be verified for the incident and jurisdiction.

Annual Binder & Kit Review

Review the whole preparedness binder and every home, vehicle, and go-bag kit at least annually and whenever household needs or local guidance change.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Follow product instructions: replace expired, damaged, leaking, recalled, or improperly stored items. Store medicines, food, water, batteries, fuel, and chemicals as their labels and qualified guidance direct.

REVIEW DETAILS

Binder or kit location: _____ **Person responsible:** _____

Who or what this review covers: _____

REVIEW CHECKLIST

- ☐ Water and food are intact, within date, and suitable for household needs.
- ☐ Medicines and medical supplies were reviewed using professional and label guidance.
- ☐ Lights, radio, chargers, and batteries work; damaged batteries were removed safely.
- ☐ Clothing, masks, footwear, hygiene items, and animal supplies still fit current needs.
- ☐ Contact lists, plans, maps, identification copies, and cash are current.
- ☐ Alert enrollment, official information sources, zones, meeting places, routes, and transportation plans were rechecked.
- ☐ Household members, caregivers, support contacts, access needs, equipment, and animal plans reflect current needs.
- ☐ Each intended carrier can safely lift or move the assigned bag.

Date	Binder / kit	Replaced, charged, or updated	Next review

Item or task still needed: _____

Assigned to: _____ **Due:** _____

Annual Binder & Kit Review — continued

Use two schedules: check stored supplies at least every six months using **STH-002**; review the whole binder annually. Check sooner after use or a change in contacts, care needs, routes, equipment, or official guidance. Product and professional instructions may require more frequent checks.

SOURCES

Source: Ready.gov, “Build A Kit.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

Report a Wildfire Sighting

Report a suspected wildfire from safety. Give the call-taker the location and what you can actually see.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

For a fire emergency, call 911. Move away from immediate danger first. Do not approach smoke or flames, stop in a dangerous place, or delay evacuation to make observations.

MAKE THE REPORT

1. **Give the location.** Name the city, street address or nearest intersection, and landmarks. Distinguish where you are from where the smoke or fire appears to be. Say if the exact fire location is unknown.
2. **Describe what you see.** Report visible smoke or flames, nearby buildings or people at risk, and any injuries you know about. Separate observations from guesses.
3. **Give your callback number.** Answer the call-taker's questions and follow instructions. Stay on the line until told to hang up, unless remaining there puts you in danger.

A SHORT EXAMPLE

“I am in La Habra Heights at [your location]. I can see [smoke/flames] near [landmark or apparent location]. The exact location is [known/unknown]. My callback number is [number].”

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Do not wait for a neighborhood radio reply. A Fire Watch radio net, group message, website, or app is not a substitute for emergency dispatch. Do not call 911 merely to request incident updates.

After reporting: follow current official protective instructions. Use **COM-003** for alerts, **COM-004** for official information, and **EVS-003** for leaving promptly.

SOURCES

Sources checked 2026-11-13: City of La Habra Heights, Contact and Your Fire Department (911); National 911 Program, Calling 911 (updated 2023-01-24). Draft requires editorial and fire-service review.

Radio Usage and Etiquette

Use clear, brief calls on your assigned channel. These habits apply across radio models

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Life safety comes first. Call 911 when available for immediate danger. A radio call does not mean emergency services have been notified. Do not delay evacuation or enter a hazard to make a report.

BEFORE YOU TRANSMIT

- ☐ Battery charged; spare or charging cable ready
- ☐ Antenna secure; volume audible
- ☐ Assigned channel selected; callsign known
- ☐ Receive checked; transmit only if authorized
- ☐ Push-to-talk protected from accidental use

- **Listen first.** Wait for a clear channel.
- **Press, pause, speak.** Use a normal voice; follow your microphone guide.
- **Release and listen.** Leave time for urgent calls to break-in.
- **Stay professional.** Avoid private details and speculation.

COMMON RADIO PHRASES

Phrase	Meaning
Roger / Copy	Message received. Read back critical details to confirm understanding.
Affirmative / Negative	Yes / No.
Over	Finished speaking; a reply is expected.
Out	Exchange finished; no reply expected. Do not say “over and out.”
Stand by / Standing by	Please wait / I am waiting and ready.
Go ahead	Send your message; I am listening.
Say again	Please repeat your message or the specified part.
Correction / Disregard	Correcting my message / Ignore my previous message.
Radio check	Can you hear me? / Your audio is clear.
Emergency traffic	Urgent call requesting priority; Stop talking and listen.
Traffic	Messages / Information to send/receive
Monitoring	I have no traffic, but am listening
Break	I have urgent information to share or have to briefly stop and restart transmission

Normal Operation and Directed Nets

A radio net is an organized group of stations meeting on a shared channel for a common purpose, such as check-ins, training, or emergency coordination.

WHAT MAKES A NET DIRECTED

In a **directed net**, one station acts as **Net Control** and manages who speaks and in what order. “Traffic” means a message or report to pass. “No traffic” means you are checking in without a message. A scheduled check-in can use directed procedures even when there is no emergency.

Action	Normal operation	Directed net operation
Start a call	Listen for a clear channel; call the intended member directly.	Call Net Control and wait for recognition, or answer when called.
Pass a message	Speak briefly to the station you called.	Pass traffic through Net Control; contact another station directly only when directed.
Join the activity	Identify yourself in the exchange.	Check in as instructed; give your callsign and whether you have traffic.
Finish	Close the exchange and monitor.	Stay available; tell Net Control before checking out or changing channels.
Urgent danger	Give emergency traffic priority.	Announce emergency traffic at a break; routine stations hold while Net Control handles it.

WHY THIS MATTERS IN AN EMERGENCY

Several stations transmitting together can cover up a location, a request for help, or a warning. Directed procedures give emergency reports priority, reduce overlapping calls, and let Net Control track stations, messages, and unanswered requests. Short reports, accurate readbacks, and a clear speaking order help critical information reach the right person.

Follow the directed procedure even when the channel sounds quiet. Net Control may be waiting for a reply or coordinating a relay. Listen continuously, leave pauses for urgent calls, and keep unrelated conversation off the net. Net Control coordinates radio traffic; that role does not grant incident command authority.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Changing modes: The designated operator announces when a directed net starts, its purpose, and its channel. Use directed procedures until Net Control explicitly closes the net or transfers control. A pause or a change of operator does not return the channel to normal operation.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Fire Watch owner brief (October 23, 2026). General net principles: IARU, Emergency Telecommunications Guide (September 2016), Chapters 7–11; accessed October 23, 2026. www.iaru.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/01/emcommguide_1sept2016.pdf

Radio Calls and Emergency Traffic

Use plain language to communicate: “What is your location?” is clear "what is your 20?" is not clear

On a directed net, Net Control coordinates calls. You may only speak to Net Control and no other stations unless given specific permission by net control. Listen, wait to be recognized, and report the essential facts.

PASS ROUTINE TRAFFIC DURING A DIRECTED NET

1. **Call and identify:** “Net Control, [callsign].” Release and wait for “Go ahead.” If unanswered, pause and try once more.
2. **Report** location, observation, time, threats, action taken, and help needed. Identify unconfirmed information.
3. **Confirm.** Read back critical details; ask “Say again” if unclear. End with your callsign; resume monitoring.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Fire Watch identification: Use your assigned three-digit callsign and any legally required station ID. Address city personnel by title. Outside a net, call the member directly: “145, 238.” Wait for “This is 238, go ahead.”

GIVE EMERGENCY TRAFFIC PRIORITY

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Urgent danger: At a break, say **“Emergency traffic, [callsign].”** Release and listen for acknowledgment, then give the exact location and danger first. Other stations hold routine calls. If unanswered, use another available way to summon help.

Confirm the interruption phrase before duty: the existing brief uses **“Emergency traffic”**; the supplied sheet uses “Break, break.”

Radio Check and Field Call Examples

Practice with your assigned callsign. Replace bracketed fields with confirmed facts and exact locations.

SAMPLE RADIO CHECK

When the channel is clear and checks are permitted:
You: “Fire Watch, this is [callsign]. Radio check. Over.”
Other station: “[Callsign], loud and clear. Over.”
You: “Copy. [Callsign], out.”

REPORT DURING A DIRECTED NET

You: “Net Control, [callsign].”
Net Control: “[Callsign], go ahead.”
You: “Visible smoke near [exact location], first seen [time]. [Observed conditions]. [Help needed]. Over.”
You: Read back instructions when received; close with “[Callsign], out.”

EMERGENCY REPORT

You: “Emergency traffic, [callsign].”
Net Control: “All stations hold. [Callsign], go ahead.”
You: “[callsign] at [Exact location]. Active fire. [People or access threatened]. [Action taken]. [Help needed]. Over.”

Blocked road: give street/intersection, obstruction, and passability. Report from safety.

MONITOR UPDATES AND CHECK OUT

◎ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

[VERIFY] Net Control updates: High activity: :00, :15, :30, :45; quieter: :00, :30; stand-down: :00 hourly. Hold routine calls for updates; follow current net instructions.

Ask to check out or report a channel/radio change before leaving the net. After duty, report equipment problems and recharge. Neighborhood radio coordination does not replace official emergency instructions.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Fire Watch brief and supplied pages. Verify local procedures. Programming: COM-009; UV-PRO: COM-008.

Scheduled Check In Net Script

Use a check-in net to practice the same speaking order and acknowledgments needed during an emergency.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Local script examples: Confirm Heights 6, callsign 172, the Saturday 1800 schedule, and the ten-minute duration before use. Substitute the assigned operator, channel, date, and actual times. Times below use local 24-hour time. Include any legally required station identification.

OPEN THE NET

“This is 172. For the next ten minutes I will be operating as Net Control for La Habra Heights Firewatch on Heights 6. This is a directed check-in net. Please pass all traffic through Net Control and transmit one station at a time when invited or called. At check-in, give your callsign and state whether or not you have traffic.”

“First, a break for emergency traffic.”

Release push-to-talk and listen. If emergency traffic is heard, acknowledge it and handle it before check-ins. Say “Hearing none” only after listening.

“Hearing none, stations wishing to check in, one at a time. First station, go ahead.”

ACKNOWLEDGE AND MANAGE CHECK INS

Member: “238, no traffic.”
Net Control: “238, checked in, no traffic. Next station, go ahead.”

Member: “145, with traffic.”
Net Control: “145, checked in with traffic. Stand by.”

When ready: “145, go ahead with your traffic.”

Log callsigns and pending traffic. If stations overlap, ask them to repeat one at a time or call specific stations from the roster. Before closing, ask: “Any additional check-ins or remaining traffic?” Release and listen; resolve pending messages.

CLOSE THE NET

“Thank you to all members who checked in this evening. This concludes the Saturday night 1800 net. We will do a check-in next Saturday at the same time on this frequency. I am now returning this channel to normal use by authorized members of La Habra Heights Firewatch. Net Control clear at 1810. 172 clear and monitoring.”

If an actual emergency develops, suspend the practice check-in and announce the change to emergency net operation. Do not close at ten minutes while emergency traffic remains unresolved.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Adapted from Fire Watch owner script examples (October 23, 2026). Verify local schedule, identification, and procedures before duty.

Emergency Net Control Script

Keep emergency traffic moving first. Use short transmissions, release to listen, and record messages and follow-up actions.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Activation and closure: Use the team's designated Net Control and incident coordination process. Replace bracketed fields with confirmed information. An emergency net has no automatic ten-minute end. Include required station identification.

ACTIVATE OR CHANGE FROM A CHECK IN NET

“All stations, this is [callsign], Net Control for La Habra Heights Firewatch on Heights 6. [The check-in net is suspended.] We are operating a directed emergency net for [incident or purpose]. Hold routine traffic. Pass all traffic through Net Control unless directed otherwise. Stations with emergency traffic, call now.”

Release and listen. If no emergency station answers: “Hearing none, stations with incident traffic, identify one at a time with your callsign and the nature of your traffic.” Call stations individually if responses overlap. Request general check-ins only as the situation permits.

RECEIVE EMERGENCY TRAFFIC

Member: “Emergency traffic, [callsign].”
Net Control: “All stations hold. [Callsign], go ahead with your emergency traffic.”
Member: “[Exact location]. [Immediate danger]. [People threatened]. [Action taken]. [Help needed]. Over.”

Read back the location and critical details; ask for corrections. Confirm who is contacting 911 or the appropriate response agency and whether contact succeeded. Log the report, recipient, time, and pending action. Acknowledging a radio report does not confirm dispatch or completion.

After handling the call: “Emergency traffic from [callsign] received. All stations, the directed emergency net remains active. [Next station], go ahead.” Leave a listening break for new emergency traffic.

TRANSFER NET CONTROL WITHOUT CLOSING

Brief the relief operator on checked-in stations, pending messages, and unresolved requests. After the relief operator accepts: “All stations, [new callsign] is now Net Control. The directed emergency net remains active.” The new operator confirms control on air.

CLOSE ONLY WHEN AUTHORIZED TO STAND DOWN

Confirm unresolved traffic has been completed or handed to an identified station or agency. Then announce: “All stations, this is [callsign], Net Control. The directed emergency net for [incident] is closed at [time]. [State any continuing monitoring or reporting instructions.] Heights 6 is returned to normal use by authorized members of La Habra Heights Firewatch. Net Control clear. [Callsign] clear [and monitoring, if true].”

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Fire Watch owner brief (October 23, 2026); IARU, Emergency Telecommunications Guide (2016), Chapters 7–11. Source URL on page 2.

NATO and LAPD Phonetic Alphabets

Use phonetic words to spell names, streets, or letter groups clearly. Say “I spell,” then give one word per letter.

Letter	NATO	LAPD	Letter	NATO	LAPD
A	Alfa	Adam	N	November	Nora
B	Bravo	Boy	O	Oscar	Ocean
C	Charlie	Charles	P	Papa	Paul
D	Delta	David	Q	Quebec	Queen
E	Echo	Edward	R	Romeo	Robert
F	Foxtrot	Frank	S	Sierra	Sam
G	Golf	George	T	Tango	Tom
H	Hotel	Henry	U	Uniform	Union
I	India	Ida	V	Victor	Victor
J	Juliett	John	W	Whiskey	William
K	Kilo	King	X	Xray	X-ray
L	Lima	Lincoln	Y	Yankee	Young
M	Mike	Mary	Z	Zulu	Zebra

Use the alphabet specified by the team or Net Control; keep it consistent within a spelling. Read back critical spellings.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. NATO, Phonetic alphabet, codes and signals (2018), accessed October 23, 2026. www.nato.int/alphabet. LAPD, Candidate Advancement Program Guide, “Phonetic Codes,” p. 8; accessed October 23, 2026. personnel.lacity.gov/joinlapd/pdf/LAPD_CAP_Manual.pdf

DRAFT

COM-003

Receive and Verify Official Emergency Alerts

Use more than one way to receive warnings. Start with the City's official signup page, then plan for missed messages and loss of connectivity.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Act without delay. Follow current official protective instructions. Do not wait for a second alert or neighborhood confirmation when danger is immediate or officials direct evacuation.

KNOW THE DIFFERENCE

Official emergency instructions

Messages issued by an authorized government public-safety agency may direct you to evacuate, shelter in place, avoid an area, or take another protective action. Follow the message and later updates from the issuing authority.

Neighborhood coordination

Neighbors may relay an official message, check on one another, or share observed conditions. They do **not** issue evacuation orders or replace 911, public-safety dispatch, or an authorized alerting agency.

SET UP LAYERED ALERTS

1. **Enable Wireless Emergency Alerts.** Check the emergency-alert settings on each compatible mobile phone. WEA alerts do not require enrollment; device, carrier, location, and settings affect receipt.
2. **Enroll in the verified local system.** For La Habra Heights, start at lhhcity.org/478/Be-Informed and use the City-linked signup form. The City describes Everbridge notifications; the embedded form is branded Nixle. Record your confirmation below. Add home, work, school, and caregiving locations when the official system permits.
3. **Add a non-cellular backup.** Choose a verified broadcast source, weather radio, landline notification, or a person who can relay official information.
4. **Make alerts accessible.** Set preferred languages and sound, vibration, caption, screen-reader, or other access features where available.
5. **Confirm before sharing.** When safe, check the issuing agency and time. Do not delay a protective action to verify a message. Use its official website or verified account; do not treat a screenshot or forwarded post as a new instruction.

Receive and Verify Official Emergency Alerts — continued

MY HOUSEHOLD ALERT RECORD

What to record	Household entry
Verified local alert system	_____
Exact enrollment URL	_____
Responsible agency	_____
Official information phone	_____
Broadcast station / frequency	_____
Accessible or language option selected	_____
Backup person and method	_____
Last tested / reviewed	_____

Household enrollment check:

Resident / device	Text	Voice	Email / app	Enrollment confirmed
_____	☐	☐	☐	_____
_____	☐	☐	☐	_____
_____	☐	☐	☐	_____

Review enrollment after a phone number, email address, home, workplace, school, or caregiver changes. Keep account-recovery information secure, and do not assume enrollment guarantees delivery during a network failure.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Publication verification: The City entry point and linked form were inspected on 2026-11-13; enrollment and delivery remain untested. Before publication, the reviewer must verify completed local entries with the responsible agency and test the enrollment path.

Agency representative: _____ **Title/unit:** _____
Verification method: _____ **Date:** _____
Binder reviewer: _____ **Signature/initials:** _____

SOURCES

Local sources: City of La Habra Heights, “Be Informed” and its linked signup form; Ready LA County, “Emergency Notifications” (checked 2026-11-13). General alerting guidance: Ready.gov, “Alerts and Warnings”; FEMA, “Wireless Emergency Alerts”; FCC, “Emergency Alert System.” Accessed September 25, 2026.

Find Official Emergency Information

Keep these official starting points on paper and on your devices. Look for the issuing agency, affected location, action, and issue time.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Act on urgent instructions. Do not delay evacuation or another protective action while searching for a second source. A neighborhood radio net or group chat does not issue official evacuation orders.

SAVE THESE STARTING POINTS

Official source	Use before an emergency
City of La Habra Heights **lhhcity.org/478/Be-Informed**	Find the City's emergency-notification information and embedded signup form. See COM-003 for enrollment planning.
Ready LA County **ready.lacounty.gov/emergency-notifications/**	Find County alert enrollment, city-specific systems, and information on broadcast and weather-radio alerts.

These are preparedness starting points, not a guarantee of a live incident feed. Follow the current issuing agency's incident instructions and updates. The City page lists emergency apps as supplemental tools.

PREPARE AN OFFLINE BACKUP

- ☐ Save or print the official addresses and the household contact plan in COM-005.
- ☐ Choose a battery-powered broadcast or weather-radio backup using the County's guidance; confirm reception at home.
- ☐ Record a person who can relay official messages when your usual device or connection fails.

Find Official Emergency Information — continued

DURING AN INCIDENT

1. **Read the whole official message.** Note who issued it, when, the affected location, and the action required.
2. **Take the protective action.** Follow current instructions for your location. Do not wait for a neighborhood vote or forwarded confirmation.
3. **Check for later official updates when safe.** Do not assume an old screenshot, map, or saved page shows current conditions.
4. **Share the original official message.** Keep its agency, location, time, and link attached. Clearly distinguish your own observations.

MY INFORMATION BACKUP

Item	Household entry
Official incident source selected before an emergency	_____
Broadcast / weather-radio source and reception check date	_____
Backup contact and method	_____
Where paper copies are kept	_____

Use **COM-007** for checking uncertain claims. Never interpret an empty webpage or missing alert as proof that conditions are safe.

SOURCES

Sources checked 2026-11-13: City of La Habra Heights, Be Informed; Los Angeles County Office of Emergency Management, Emergency Notifications. Local choices and the finished proof require review before publication.

DRAFT

COM-005

Household Emergency Communication Plan

Decide how household members will reconnect, give each person a copy, and review the plan whenever contacts or care needs change.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Official instructions take priority. Follow evacuation, shelter, road-closure, and other protective instructions from the responsible public-safety agency. This plan does not replace official alerts or emergency services.

MAKE THE PLAN TOGETHER

1. **Choose two meeting places:** one just outside the home and one outside the neighborhood. Never travel there when officials say the route or area is unsafe.
2. **Choose an out-of-area contact.** Each person should know how to call or text that person. Do not assume any one method will always work.
3. **Plan for access and support.** Include transportation, mobility, equipment, medications, power, language, children, animals, and authorized pickup.
4. **Keep copies.** Put one in each wallet, school bag, go-bag, and vehicle without including unnecessary private information.
5. **Practice twice a year.** Update the plan after a move, school or job change, or change in household or care needs.

DRAFT

COM-005

Household Emergency Communication Plan — continued

HOUSEHOLD CONTACTS

Person / role	Primary phone or method	Backup method / accessibility need
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Key contact	Name	Phone / method
Out-of-area contact	_____	_____
School / child care	_____	_____
Workplace	_____	_____
Caregiver / support person	_____	_____
Veterinarian / animal contact	_____	_____

Situation	Place / action
Outside-home meeting place	_____
Outside-neighborhood meeting place	_____
Alternate safe destination	_____
Primary evacuation transportation	_____
Backup transportation / driver	_____
Message everyone should send	“I am at _____. I am _____. Next update at _____.”

IF HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS ARE SEPARATED

1. **Follow** official instructions for your current location.
2. **Send** one short update with your name, location, safety status, and next action.
3. **Contact** the out-of-area person if household members cannot reach one another.
4. **Conserve** the battery: dim the screen, close unused apps, and retry later if networks are busy.
5. **Update** the contact whenever your location or plan changes.

Household Emergency Communication Plan — continued

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Household's verified official source: _____

Responsible agency: _____ **Enrollment URL or phone:** _____
Verified with agency by: _____ **Date:** _____

- ☐ Every household member has the plan in a usable format.
- ☐ Children know which trusted adult may pick them up.
- ☐ Support people know when and how to assist.
- ☐ Everyone understands that silence may mean a network failure—not that an area is safe.

Plan reviewed together on: _____ **Next review:** _____

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Make a Plan”; FEMA, “Family Emergency Communication Plan.” Accessed September 25, 2026. Household and local fields must be completed and checked before use.

DRAFT

COM-006

Neighborhood Communication and Check-Ins

Build a voluntary neighbor network that relays verified information and checks on people without acting as an emergency authority.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Neighborhood messages are not official emergency instructions. Only an authorized public-safety agency can issue an official evacuation, shelter, or access instruction. Never delay calling 911, leaving danger, or following an official alert while waiting for a coordinator.

AGREE ON BOUNDARIES BEFORE AN EMERGENCY

Neighbors can

- Relay an official message with its issuer and time
- Ask whether help is requested
- Share firsthand observations, clearly labeled
- Report unmet needs through the proper channel
- Protect private household information

Neighbors must not

- Issue or cancel an evacuation order
- Enter a closed, burning, flooded, or unsafe area
- Self-deploy or impersonate responders
- Share rumors or sensitive medical details
- Promise rescue, transport, or radio coverage

USE A DISCIPLINED MESSAGE

1. **Label the source:** “Official message from [agency]” or “Neighbor observation—not an official instruction.”
2. **Add time and place.** State when and where the information applies.
3. **Repeat exactly.** Do not strengthen, soften, or interpret an official instruction.
4. **Name the next step.** Give the agency's source so recipients can verify updates themselves.
5. **Close the loop.** Mark whether the person received the message or requested assistance; pass needs to the appropriate service without broadcasting private details.

Neighborhood Communication and Check-Ins — continued

OUR VOLUNTARY CHECK-IN NETWORK

Area / household	Primary contact and method	Backup contact and method	Assistance requested?
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Coordinator: _____ **Backup:** _____ **Review date:** _____

VERIFY LOCAL COMMUNICATION DETAILS BEFORE USE

Item	Verified entry	Responsible agency / owner	Verified by and date
Official alert system and enrollment URL	_____	_____	_____
Official information phone	_____	_____	_____
Neighborhood channel / group	_____	Neighborhood network	_____
Radio frequency / channel	_____	_____	_____
Assigned call sign(s)	_____	_____	_____

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Required publication check: An authorized representative of the named agency must verify every official local entry. The neighborhood owner verifies coordination details. Blank, expired, secondhand, or unverified entries must not be published.

Agency representative and role: _____
Direct verification method: _____ **Date:** _____
Binder reviewer initials: _____

SOURCES

Sources: FEMA, “Community Emergency Response Team Basic Training Participant Manual”; Ready.gov, “Make a Plan.” Accessed September 25, 2026. This worksheet assigns no response authority and intentionally contains no unverified local operational details.

Rumor Control and Verifying Emergency Information

Pause before you pass along an emergency claim. Find the original message, check it against a current official source, and share only what people need to act safely.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Do not let verification delay protective action. If a current official alert tells you to evacuate, shelter, or avoid an area, follow it immediately. Call 911 for immediate danger. Do not wait for a neighbor, group chat, or social-media post to agree.

USE THE SIFT CHECK

1. **Stop.** Do not react to a headline, screenshot, cropped video, forwarded voice message, or urgent request to “share with everyone.” Ask: What exact claim would I be repeating?
2. **Identify the source.** Find the person or organization that first published the claim. A familiar sender is not necessarily the original source.
3. **Find official coverage.** Check the responsible public agency's website, verified account, alert, or recorded information line. When safety and time allow, confirm through a second official source.
4. **Trace the context.** Open the original message. Check its issue time, location, map boundaries, links, and whether a newer official update replaced it.

Warning signs

- No issuing agency, date, time, or location
- A screenshot with no link to the original
- A look-alike account or misspelled web address
- An old photo, map, or alert presented as current
- A claim that only unnamed insiders can confirm
- Pressure to forward before checking

Stronger evidence

- The original, current agency message
- A known official web address opened directly
- The same instruction on another official channel
- A clearly marked issue time and affected area
- A correction or update from the issuing agency
- Information that still matches the latest alert

SHARE WITHOUT ADDING CONFUSION

Use plain attribution: **“At [time], [agency] said [instruction] for [location]. Check [official source] for updates.”** Link to the original when possible. Do not crop away the issuer, date, map legend, or safety instructions. Do not guess why an alert was sent, declare an area safe, or turn an observation into an official instruction.

Rumor Control and Verifying Emergency Information — continued

WHEN A CLAIM IS NOT CONFIRMED

1. **Do not amplify it.** Repeating a false claim—even to criticize it—can spread it farther.
2. **Save and route it.** Note the exact claim, source, and timestamp without reposting it. Match the topic to the responsible agency: incident instructions, roads, utilities, schools, or public health.
3. **Ask safely.** Use the agency's published non-emergency contact or rumor-reporting channel. Keep 911 free for immediate threats to life or property.
4. **Correct with evidence.** Share the current official information and link. Avoid shaming the person who sent the claim.
5. **Update the same audience.** If you shared information that became wrong or outdated, clearly correct it wherever you posted it.

QUICK VERIFICATION RECORD

Check	What I found
Exact claim	_____
Original source / link	_____
Issue time, update time, and place	_____
Responsible agency / source checked	_____
Result	☐ Confirmed ☐ False ☐ Outdated ☐ Unconfirmed

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

COMPLETE ONLY AFTER LOCAL VERIFICATION

Emergency authority / alerts page: _____
Official non-emergency information line: _____
Rumor-control page, if provided: _____
Verified by / date: _____ / _____

PROTECT PEOPLE WHILE CHECKING

- ☐ Keep names, home addresses, medical details, and absence information private.
- ☐ Do not call a number or open a link supplied only in the questionable message.
- ☐ Do not travel into a closed or dangerous area to confirm a report.
- ☐ Label firsthand observations clearly, and keep checking as conditions change.

SOURCES

Sources: FEMA, “Rumor Response”; Ready.gov, “Alerts and Warnings.” Accessed September 25, 2026.

BTECH UV-PRO Getting Started

Turn on your radio, connect your phone, and save Heights 6, the La Habra Heights Firewatch channel identified in this project's channel plan.

1. FIND THE CONTROLS FIRST

Hold the radio with the screen facing you, as in the supplied photo.

Control	Where to find it	What you will do
Power / Volume	Top-right knob with orange stripe	Turn it to switch on and adjust sound.
Menu / Confirm	Green button below the screen, on the left; overlapping rectangles	Press to open a menu or confirm a choice.
Arrow pad	Four arrows below the screen, in the middle	Use up/down to move through choices; left/right as a menu requires.
Return / Back	Red curved-arrow button below the screen, on the right	Press briefly to go back.
Star (*)	Right end of the first number-key row	Hold to switch between frequency and saved-channel modes.
Hash (#)	Bottom-right keypad button	If the keypad is locked, hold to unlock.
PTT — push to talk	Long orange button on the left side	Leave it alone during setup. Use only for an authorized radio check.

Press means press briefly and release. **Hold** means keep pressing until the mode changes. **Tap** means touch a control on your phone.

2. TURN ON THE RADIO

1. **Attach the antenna and charged battery.** Use the supplied charging instructions if the battery needs charging.
2. **Turn the top-right knob clockwise past the click.** Wait for the screen to start.
3. **Turn the knob a little farther clockwise** to raise the volume.

You should see: the radio's operating screen. To switch off later, turn the same knob counterclockwise past the click.

SOURCES

Button locations: supplied radio photo; functions: BTECH UV-PRO Manual, pp. 4–7. Channel plan: preserved source history and project-owner confirmation, October 9, 2026. Draft for training review.

BTECH UV-PRO Getting Started — continued

Connect the phone to your own radio before changing a channel.

3. LINK THE RADIO TO YOUR PHONE

1. **Install BTECH UV Programmer** on your Android phone or iPhone. Use the app links on BTECH's UV-PRO product page.
2. **Turn on Bluetooth on your phone.** Keep the phone beside the powered-on radio. Allow the app's requested Bluetooth or nearby-device permissions.
3. **Open the radio menu.** Press the green **Menu / Confirm** button.
4. **Choose Connections, then Pairing.** Use the arrow pad to highlight each choice and the green button to select it. The owner-confirmed shortcut from the operating screen is **green button → up → up → green button**; check that Pairing is selected. If pairing is already active, continue. The manual says the red and green indicator lights flash in pairing mode.
5. **Open BTECH UV Programmer on the phone.** Tap the **three-line menu** to find the connection panel. Look for **Bindable Device** and tap your UV-PRO. If several radios appear, ask the lead to identify yours.
6. **Wait for the radio's operating screen and channel list in the app.** If they do not appear, check **Connection management** in the app's device settings and select your radio.

You should see: the connected radio's controls and numbered channel tiles in the app.

RECOGNIZE THESE PHONE CONTROLS

Phone control	Use it for
Three lines	Opening the panel with numbered channel tiles.
Gear in that panel	Opening device settings, including Connection management and Channel & Groups.
Numbered channel tile	Tap to select; press and hold to open **Edit channel**.

Screen differences: the supplied Android captures show the three-line menu at the upper left; older manual pictures show it at the lower left. Recognize the symbol. iPhone and newer app layouts may differ.

SOURCES

BTECH UV-PRO Manual, pp. 11–15, 22, 26; supplied Android captures and project-owner confirmation of the press-and-hold gesture.

BTECH UV-PRO Getting Started — continued

Heights 6 uses two frequencies: one to listen and one to transmit.

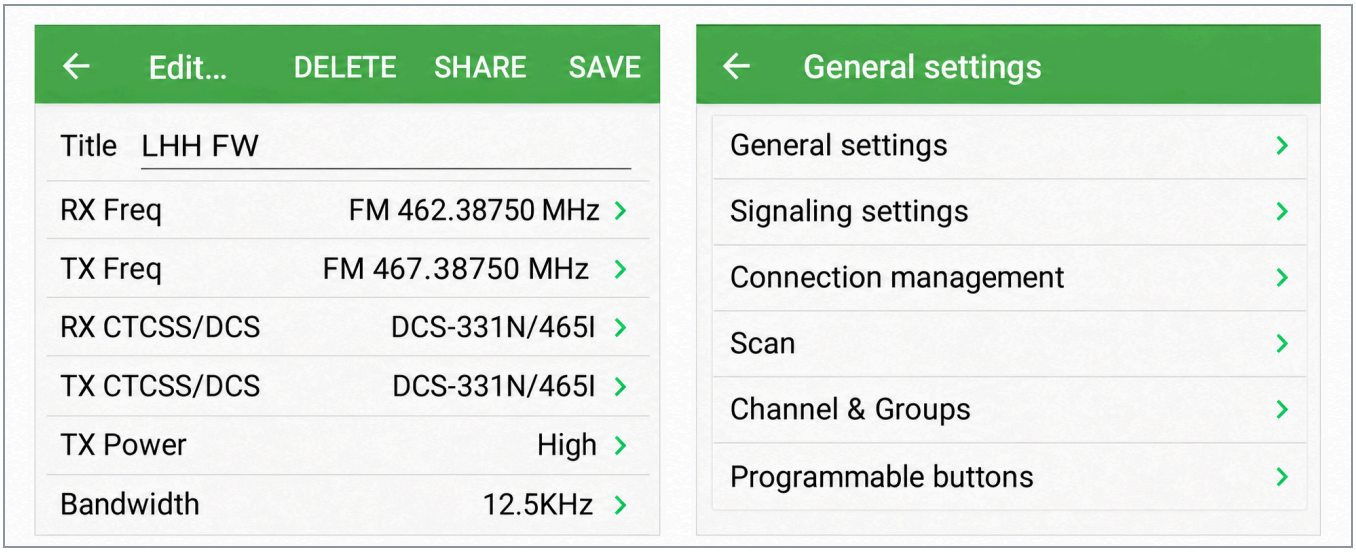
4. OPEN AN UNUSED CHANNEL AND ENTER THE FREQUENCIES

1. **Tap the three-line menu** to open the channel panel.
2. **Find an unused numbered tile** in the channel group assigned by your radio lead. The tile number does not need to be 6. Do not overwrite an existing channel.
3. **Press and hold that tile.** Tap **Edit channel** in the menu that appears.
4. **Tap Title.** Enter **Heights 6**.
5. **Tap RX Freq.** Enter **462.38750 MHz**. If asked for a mode, choose **FM**. Confirm the entry.
6. **Tap TX Freq.** Enter **467.38750 MHz**. Choose **FM** if asked, then confirm.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Heights 6 — project-owner-confirmed settings, October 9, 2026.

RX / listen: 462.38750 MHz
TX / transmit: 467.38750 MHz
Both receive and transmit DCS: **331N** (set on the next page).



Screen reference adapted from the supplied Android captures. **Enter the values above.** RX and TX are shown with the confirmed target values.
Original captures: project owner; adaptation: OpenAI.

Check: RX starts with **462**; TX starts with **467**. Both end in **.38750**. A final zero may disappear without changing the value; an extra nonzero digit needs the lead's check. Keep Talk Around off for normal repeater use; use it during repeater failure only under the lead's instructions.

SOURCES

Channel-plan source history; project-owner frequency confirmation; supplied Android channel-editor and channel-panel captures.

BTECH UV-PRO Getting Started — continued

Set the receive and transmit codes separately, then save.

5. SET DCS AND SAVE HEIGHTS 6

1. **Tap RX CTCSS/DCS.** Choose **DCS 331N** and confirm. The **N** means normal polarity.
2. **Tap TX CTCSS/DCS.** Choose **DCS 331N** again and confirm. Both fields must be set.
3. **Check the other channel settings with your radio lead.** Set **Bandwidth to 12.5 kHz**, as specified in the owner's current channel instructions. Use the transmit power required by your radio lead; the captured **High** setting alone does not establish the approved power.
4. **Leave Talk Around and Reverse Frequency off.** Heights 6 needs the separate RX and TX frequencies entered on the previous page.
5. **Tap SAVE at the upper right.** Keep the phone connected to the radio until saving finishes.

If the DCS list looks different: the supplied app displays **DCS-331N/465I**. Select the entry containing **331N**. This is one selection label; do not enter a second code or choose **331I**.

COMPARE BEFORE YOU CONTINUE

Field	Correct entry
Title	Heights 6
RX Freq	**462.38750 MHz**, FM
TX Freq	**467.38750 MHz**, FM
RX CTCSS/DCS	**331N**
TX CTCSS/DCS	**331N**
Talk Around / Reverse Frequency	Both off
Bandwidth / TX Power	12.5 kHz / power assigned by the radio lead

You should see: your saved channel in the numbered grid. If saving reports an error, reconnect and check the entry before continuing.

Protect existing programming: use SAVE. Do not use DELETE, factory reset, an unknown channel import, or a firmware update during this setup.

SOURCES

Project-owner-confirmed frequencies and DCS; supplied editor captures 6–7; BTECH UV-PRO Manual, p. 31 (Talk Around). Draft; the radio lead must verify settings before duty.

BTECH UV-PRO Getting Started — continued

Make sure the channel was saved to the radio and works without the phone.

6. SELECT AND CHECK HEIGHTS 6

1. **Reopen the saved channel.** Press and hold its tile, then tap **Edit channel**. Compare both frequencies and both DCS fields with the table on the previous page.
2. **Return to the grid and tap the Heights 6 tile.** Check that it is selected and that the radio shows the same channel. The captured name **LHH FW** refers to this channel; use the lead's agreed label if different.
3. **Select Single CH** in the app panel's **Work Mode** row. This makes the first check easier to follow.
4. **Disconnect the app.** Turn the radio off, then on again with the top knob.
5. **Find Heights 6 on the radio.** If it is in frequency mode, hold ***** to switch to saved-channel mode. Use **up/down** to select Heights 6. If the keypad is locked, hold # to unlock it.
6. **Ask the radio lead to verify the stored settings.** The lead can inspect the radio's channel-list **Edit** view or read back its settings after reconnecting. The phone's editor alone may show cached data.

You should see: Heights 6 available after restarting, with the phone disconnected. Normal radio voice operation does not require the phone or internet.

7. LISTEN, THEN MAKE AN AUTHORIZED RADIO CHECK

1. **Arrange a check with your radio lead.** Have the lead confirm the radio and settings are authorized for this channel. Listen first; avoid emergency traffic.
2. **Check reception.** Turn the volume up enough to hear the lead clearly. Silence may simply mean nobody is talking.
3. **When the lead says to call, press the orange side PTT.** Pause briefly, then say your assigned callsign and “radio check.”
4. **Release PTT to listen.** Confirm that you hear the reply and that the other station heard you clearly.

SOURCES

BTECH UV-PRO Manual, pp. 4, 7–8; COM-002 net procedures; supplied channel-panel captures. A physical radio check is still required before duty.

BTECH UV-PRO Getting Started — continued

If a step fails, check the matching item below before changing anything else.

HELP WHEN SOMETHING DOES NOT WORK

Problem	What to do
Radio will not turn on	Check that the battery is charged and fitted securely. Turn the top knob past the click.
Buttons do not respond	At the operating screen, hold # to unlock a locked keypad.
Phone cannot find the radio	Check radio power, phone Bluetooth, app permissions, and radio pairing mode. Keep them close; confirm the selected device.
Channel cannot be edited	Ask the lead to check **Device settings → General settings → Lock channel data**. Do not reset the radio.
Heights 6 is missing after restart	Check the channel group and saved-channel mode. Reconnect, repeat SAVE, and have the lead read back the stored settings.
No speech is heard	Check volume, selected channel, RX frequency, and RX DCS. Arrange a known transmission with the lead.
The lead cannot hear you	Ask the lead to check TX frequency, TX DCS, Disable TX, power, and coverage before trying again.

READY-TO-USE CHECKLIST

- ☐ Battery charged and antenna attached
- ☐ Heights 6 selected on the radio
- ☐ Both frequencies and both DCS fields checked
- ☐ Bandwidth and power confirmed by the radio lead
- ☐ Channel remains saved after restarting
- ☐ Reception and authorized two-way check passed

Checked by: _____ Date: _____
Bandwidth / power: _____

Related guides: COM-009 covers general programming and verification. For radio etiquette and net calls, follow COM-002 and your assigned callsign. For immediate danger, call 911 when available.

SOURCES

References: BTECH UV-PRO Manual, Rev. 3, pp. 4–8, 11–15, 22, 26, 31; BTECH UV-PRO product page; COM-002; project-owner confirmations and supplied Android captures/photo, October 9, 2026. Draft requires editor and subject-matter review before publication.

Radio Programming

Program a radio from a current, authorized channel plan, then verify the saved settings. Use a separate guide for your exact radio model, software, and connection method.

> △ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM
>
> **Confirm compatibility first.** Being able to enter a frequency does not authorize transmission. The radio, operator, and settings must be permitted for the radio service and channel. Ask the radio lead if any requirement is unclear.

GET THE CHANNEL PLAN FROM THE RADIO LEAD

Setting	What to confirm
Channel name and memory	Agreed label and destination slot; avoid overwriting a needed channel.
Receive frequency (RX)	Frequency your radio listens to.
Transmit frequency (TX)	Frequency your radio sends on. Simplex: same RX/TX. Repeater: may differ.
Repeater shift or offset	Confirm direction and amount if required; check the resulting TX frequency.
Tone or code	Confirm TX and RX separately: none, CTCSS, or DCS; include DCS polarity (normal/inverted) when specified.
Mode, bandwidth, power	Exact plan requirements and radio compatibility; use authorized power appropriate to the link.

CTCSS and DCS filter which received signals open the speaker. They do not encrypt a conversation or make a channel private.

LOAD AND SAVE THE SETTINGS

1. **Identify the exact model and software.** Follow its guide for keypad entry, a cable, or an app. Do not substitute another model's button sequence.
2. **Back up.** Read and save the existing configuration when supported; confirm you connected to the intended radio.
3. **Enter the channel plan.** Set the name, RX, TX, tones/codes, mode, bandwidth, and power. Check decimal places, units, and DCS polarity.
4. **Save to the radio.** Complete the model's write or synchronization step. An entry saved in phone or computer software may not yet be stored in the radio.
5. **Read back the stored channel.** Reopen or read from the radio and compare each value with the plan. Stop if any field is missing or does not match.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Sources: Fire Watch programming brief; COM-008.

Verify a Programmed Radio

A successful write is only the first check. Verify that the radio retains the channel and can communicate as intended.

CHECK BEFORE RETURNING TO SERVICE

- ☐ Restart as directed; confirm the saved channel remains available.
- ☐ Select the intended memory/group; check volume and receive audio.
- ☐ Check the active transmit channel when using dual watch or scanning.
- ☐ Verify any talk-around or reverse setting against the plan; these can change the transmit path.
- ☐ When authorized and the channel is clear, make a short radio check with a known station. Follow COM-002 for call procedure.
- ☐ Confirm both stations can hear and understand each other; a receive-only check does not verify your transmit settings.
- ☐ Record the plan version, radio, date, and result. Report unresolved problems to the radio lead before duty.

RECORD THE VERIFIED CHANNEL PLAN

Complete from the authorized plan. Keep the record with the radio's setup instructions.

Field	Confirmed value
Radio model and identifier	_____
Channel plan version and date	_____
Channel name, memory, and group	_____
RX frequency and TX frequency	_____
Shift / offset, if used	_____
RX and TX tones/codes, DCS polarity	_____
Mode, bandwidth, and power	_____
Programmed by and date	_____
Two-way check with station and result	_____

USE THE MATCHING MODEL GUIDE

COM-008: BTECH UV-PRO Getting Started covers that model's controls, pairing, and channel entry. Keep menus, cables, apps, and screenshots for other radios, such as the Baofeng UV-5R Mini, in separate guides verified for their exact model and firmware.

SOURCES

SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE. Sources: Fire Watch programming brief; COM-008.

DRAFT

Evacuation Readiness Checklist

Preparing today: complete sections 1–5. Leaving now: use the final page; do not finish planning worksheets first.

EVS-001

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Life safety comes first. If danger is immediate or officials direct you to evacuate, leave now. Do not wait to finish this checklist, gather belongings, or complete home-departure tasks.

Household: _____ **Reviewed:** _____ **Next practice:** _____

PREPARE NOW—BEFORE AN EVACUATION

1. Official alerts and terms understood

- ☐ I receive local official alerts in ways I can notice, understand, and act on, including during sleep or a power outage.
- ☐ I recorded the official alert source(s): _____
- ☐ I know my evacuation zone or other local identifier: _____
- ☐ Everyone understands the exact local terms for prepare, leave, shelter, road closure, and re-entry. We know terms vary by jurisdiction and will follow the instructions in each alert.
- ☐ We will use official information rather than rumors and will not enter a closed area until authorities permit re-entry.

Use **COM-003** for alert setup and **COM-004** for official information. See **EVS-003** for departure decisions and local terminology that still needs verification.

2. Contacts, meeting places, and destinations selected

- ☐ Each person carries household and out-of-area contacts on paper and, when possible, on a charged device.
- ☐ We selected an accessible near-home meeting place and an outside-neighborhood meeting place.
- ☐ We selected a primary destination and at least one backup that can meet our household's lodging, health, accessibility, and animal needs.
- ☐ Our plan covers separation at work, school, care, or other regular locations; authorized pickup people are current.
- ☐ We shared the plan with our contacts and practiced it on: _____

Near-home meeting place: _____

Outside-neighborhood meeting place: _____

Primary destination: _____ Backup: _____

DRAFT

Evacuation Readiness Checklist — continued

PREPARE NOW—CONTINUED

3. Two routes and backup transportation planned

- ☐ We mapped two routes from home and routes from school, work, and care locations, while recognizing officials may change routes.
- ☐ Drivers keep vehicles safely maintained and, when practical, fueled or charged; keys are easy to reach.
- ☐ Everyone has a ride, safe seating or restraints, and space for essential mobility, medical, child, and animal equipment.
- ☐ If our usual vehicle, driver, road, or transit service is unavailable, we have a backup transportation plan.
- ☐ We know how to check official road, transit, and shelter information when leaving.

Primary route: _____ Alternate route: _____

Backup driver/service: _____ Phone or contact method: _____

See **EVS-004** for route planning and **EVS-005** for transportation planning.

4. Go-bags, medicines, documents, and equipment ready

- ☐ Portable go-bags are labeled, reachable, and sized so assigned people can move them safely.
- ☐ Essential medicines and health supplies are current; refill, storage, refrigeration, and power arrangements have been discussed with the prescriber or pharmacist.
- ☐ Protected paper or offline copies of identification, contacts, prescriptions, insurance, and essential records are ready.
- ☐ Phones, alert devices, communication aids, mobility equipment, chargers, batteries, and other necessary equipment are ready to take.
- ☐ Cash, keys, sturdy footwear, weather layers, water, and ready-to-eat food are positioned with the go-bags.
- ☐ Supplies are checked on this schedule: _____ and after every use.

See **EVS-002** for go-bags, documents, medicines, power, and necessary equipment; use **EVS-010** for a detailed accessible-equipment plan.

Evacuation Readiness Checklist — continued

PREPARE NOW—CONTINUED

5. Children, animals, access needs, and neighbors accounted for

- ☐ Children know the plan at an age-appropriate level; a responsible adult and backup are assigned to each child.
- ☐ Animals have identification, carriers or restraints, transport, essential supplies, and accepting destinations.
- ☐ Each person's mobility, communication, sensory, cognitive, medical, language, and personal-assistance needs have a primary and backup solution.
- ☐ Service animals remain with their handlers; their transport and supplies are included.
- ☐ We arranged help with neighbors or support networks without assuming emergency responders can provide individual transportation.
- ☐ No one will enter or remain in danger to check on another person or retrieve an animal.

Person/animal: _____ Need: _____ Primary helper: _____

Backup helper/contact: _____

See **EVS-006** for children and animals, **EVS-010** for access needs and support networks, and **EVS-011** for small-animal evacuation.

Evacuation Readiness Checklist — continued

ONLY WHEN LEAVING—AND ONLY IF TIME PERMITS

6. Safe home-departure tasks

Do these only if officials allow time, conditions are safe, and the task does not delay departure.

- ☐ Take the people, animals, go-bags, medicines, necessary equipment, phones, keys, and destination information already prepared.
- ☐ Wear protective clothing appropriate to current official guidance and conditions.
- ☐ Close doors and windows and adjust utilities only when specifically directed and only if you already know how to do so safely.
- ☐ Leave a household contact the planned destination and route without posting sensitive details publicly.
- ☐ Use the route and transportation officials direct; stay alert for changing instructions.

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

Skip any unsafe task. Never search for belongings, take a hazardous route, or handle a suspected leak, fire, downed line, or damaged equipment. See **EVS-003** for leave-now actions.

7. FINAL “LEAVE NOW” CHECK

- ☐ **Danger is immediate or officials directed evacuation: leave now—do not delay for this checklist.**
- ☐ Account for people and animals without re-entering danger or waiting for someone who has another safe plan.
- ☐ Take only the essential items already within reach; do not add last-minute packing.
- ☐ Follow current official routes and instructions, even when they differ from the household plan.
- ☐ Go to the safest available destination and monitor official updates when safe to do so.

! **WARNING — URGENT ACTION**

Once you leave: do not return until authorities say it is safe. If the planned route or destination is unsafe, follow official directions and use the safest available alternative.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation,” “Make a Plan,” “Alerts and Warnings,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” and “Pets and Animals.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

Go-Bag Checklist

Use this list to pack what your household needs to leave quickly. Tailor every bag to each person's health, age, abilities, language, animals, local hazards, and destination—and to what that person can safely carry.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Leave when officials say to leave. A go-bag supports an evacuation; it is never a reason to delay. Follow current local instructions about routes, shelters, allowed items, and supplies.

Household/member: _____ Bag number: ____ of ____

Likely destination or meeting place: _____

1. EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

Choose amounts for the trip and likely delays using current local guidance. Do not overload a bag to meet a one-size-fits-all quantity.

- ☐ **Water:** sealed drinking water in containers the carrier can manage; add a cup or drinking aid if needed
- ☐ **Food:** ready-to-eat, shelf-stable foods household members can safely eat; manual can opener and utensils if needed
- ☐ **Clothing:** change of clothes, underwear, sturdy footwear, and weather layers
- ☐ **Light:** flashlight or headlamp—prefer this to candles
- ☐ **Information:** battery-powered or hand-crank radio that receives local emergency broadcasts
- ☐ **Power:** correct spare batteries and charging cables; tested power bank if used
- ☐ **Hygiene:** soap or sanitizer, toothbrush and paste, toilet paper, menstrual products, diapers, incontinence supplies, masks, and sealed waste bags as needed
- ☐ **Basic first aid:** household-sized first-aid kit and instructions; gloves and any items household members know how to use

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Prevent battery fires: Follow the device and battery maker's charging, temperature, and storage instructions. Keep batteries dry and protect loose battery terminals from metal objects, such as keys, with their original package, a case, or nonconductive tape. Do not pack a swollen, leaking, damaged, or recalled battery or power bank. Never put gasoline, propane cylinders, camp-stove fuel, or other fuel in a go-bag.

EVS-002

Go-Bag Checklist — continued

2. MEDICINES, HEALTH, AND ACCESSIBILITY

Ask a pharmacist, prescriber, equipment supplier, and insurer how to build and rotate a lawful emergency supply. Storage requirements and refill rules differ; do not stop treatment or change a dose to make a supply last.

- ☐ Essential prescription and over-the-counter medicines, stored exactly as the label or pharmacist directs and secured from children and animals
- ☐ Copies of current prescriptions; pharmacy, prescriber, and equipment-supplier details
- ☐ Paper medical summary: medicine names, doses and schedules; allergies; conditions; treatment and communication needs; emergency contact
- ☐ Glasses, contacts and supplies, hearing-aid batteries, mobility-device parts, syringes, testing supplies, dressings, or other daily health supplies
- ☐ Assistive communication tools, instructions for helpers, and a backup method that does not require internet service
- ☐ Backup-power plan for each essential device: device and connector, safe compatible battery or power bank, charge time, expected run time, and where to recharge
- ☐ Plan for temperature-controlled medicine or equipment; use only storage methods approved by the label, pharmacist, or manufacturer

Medicine/device that cannot go in the bag: _____

Who retrieves or carries it: _____ Backup: _____

3. DOCUMENTS, CONTACTS, ACCESS, AND PAYMENT

Carry copies rather than irreplaceable originals when copies will work. Protect paper from water; protect digital copies with strong access controls. Do not put account passwords or PINs on a label.

- ☐ Identification needed by each person and recent household photos
- ☐ Health, home/renter, vehicle, life, and other relevant insurance information
- ☐ Protected copies or offline records for prescriptions, vital records, accounts, property, vehicles, and animals
- ☐ Printed emergency contacts, out-of-area contact, meeting places, medical contacts, schools, caregivers, veterinarian, and utility or service providers
- ☐ Paper local and regional maps with evacuation destinations and alternate routes marked
- ☐ House, vehicle, gate, storage, and device keys or access items that will be needed
- ☐ A limited amount of securely stored small bills and coins, plus only the payment cards needed; choose an amount that fits the household's plan and risk

Go-Bag Checklist — continued

4. PEOPLE AND ANIMALS

Pack only the lines that apply, using familiar items that are safe for the intended person or animal.

- ☐ **Infant or child:** feeding supplies, diapers, wipes, clothing, medicines, identification, caregiver contacts, quiet activity, and compact comfort item
- ☐ **Pet:** food, water, medicine, bowls, waste supplies, identification, photo, vaccination/medical records, and a safe carrier, leash, or harness
- ☐ **Service animal:** food, water, medicine, bowls, waste supplies, identification and records, working gear, and backup leash or harness
- ☐ **Individual needs:** translated or picture instructions, communication cards, ear protection, sensory aids, religious or cultural items, adaptive utensils, and a compact comfort item

Animal-friendly destination/backup: _____

Item that must stay with its user: _____

5. SEASONAL AND LOCAL-HAZARD ADDITIONS

Check local emergency-management guidance; conditions and permitted equipment vary by place and season.

- ☐ Hot weather: sun protection, cooling aid, light clothing, and additional drinking needs identified by local guidance
- ☐ Cold weather: warm layers, hat, gloves, dry socks, blanket, and traction aids if appropriate
- ☐ Rain, flood, or storm: rain layer, waterproof document pouch, extra dry layer, and local route information
- ☐ Smoke, dust, or poor air: correctly sized respiratory protection recommended by public-health officials; eye protection if locally advised
- ☐ Earthquake, wildfire, severe weather, power shutoff, or other local hazard: _____
- ☐ Seasonal medicine, allergy, mobility, animal, school, or work need: _____

Go-Bag Checklist — continued

6. MAKE THE BAGS MOVABLE AND FINDABLE

Test the complete load without risking a fall, strain, or loss of balance. Split supplies, use a wheeled option, or arrange help when one bag is too heavy.

- ☐ Label the outside with the owner's name or household identifier and a safe callback method—no diagnosis, account details, or other unnecessary private information
- ☐ Put a contact card inside and mark which medicines, devices, or animal supplies must remain with their user
- ☐ Store the bag where its carrier can reach it quickly, away from heat, moisture, pests, and household chemicals; do not block an exit
- ☐ Make sure straps, handles, wheels, and closures work and reflective markings are visible if used
- ☐ Weigh the packed bag and have the assigned person test moving it along the planned exit route
- ☐ Assign every bag, child/animal carrier, device, and item that cannot be prepacked; name a backup carrier
- ☐ Tell household members and helpers where bags are kept; return used items promptly

Bag or separate item	Storage location	Weight	Primary carrier	Backup carrier
_____	_____	____	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	_____	_____
_____	_____	____	_____	_____

Go-Bag Checklist — continued

7. DATED MAINTENANCE PANEL

Review after any use and whenever needs, seasons, routes, or household members change. Set a recurring schedule that matches the shortest manufacturer, medicine, food, and document review interval in the bag.

Check	Date checked	Replace/update by	Initials
Food, water, first aid, hygiene: dates, seals, leaks, fit	_____	_____	_____
Medicines and prescriptions: dates, supply plan, storage	_____	_____	_____
Flashlights, radio, batteries: test and inspect	_____	_____	_____
Phones, power banks, medical backup power: charge, test, inspect	_____	_____	_____
IDs, insurance, records, contacts, maps, keys, payment plan	_____	_____	_____
Clothing, child, animal, accessibility, seasonal items	_____	_____	_____
Bag condition, label, location, weight, carrier assignments	_____	_____	_____

Next full review: ____ / ____ / _____ Reviewed by: _____

Continue the plan: See **EVS-001** for the readiness checklist, **EVS-005** for transportation, **EVS-007** for shelter-in-place planning, and **EVS-010** for accessible evacuation planning.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Build A Kit,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” “Emergency Financial First Aid Kit,” and “Pets and Animals”; U.S. Food and Drug Administration, “Prepare for Emergencies”; Federal Aviation Administration, “Lithium Battery Safety.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

DRAFT

Leave Early When Evacuation Is Possible

Leaving early gives you more time and helps keep routes open for emergency responders. Match your action to the most urgent condition below—and always follow current instructions from authorized local officials.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Terminology and legal authority differ by jurisdiction. “Warning,” “advisory,” “order,” zone names, and readiness levels may not mean the same thing everywhere. The issuing authority's instructions—not the headings on this handout—control. Verify local terms, zones, alert providers, routes, shelters, and phone numbers before publication.

1. WARNING OR ADVISORY: GET READY TO LEAVE

Conditions may worsen or officials may recommend that you prepare. Treat the time as an opportunity to act—not a promise that another message will arrive.

1. **Monitor official channels.** Check who issued the message, its time, the affected area, and what action it requests. Keep more than one alert method available.
2. **Notify the household and support network.** Tell everyone the current plan, including caregivers and people who may need transportation, mobility, communication, language, medical, or animal assistance. Do not send anyone into danger.
3. **Load essential items now.** Take go-bags, medicines, medical and mobility equipment, identification, keys, phones and chargers, water, protective clothing, and essential animal supplies. Keep the vehicle pointed toward the exit if it is safe to do so.
4. **Reassess transportation and destinations.** Confirm who is leaving, the vehicle or assistance needed, fuel or charging status, a primary and backup route, and more than one safe destination. Conditions, road closures, and shelter availability can change.
5. **Leave early if conditions threaten you.** People who need extra travel time, have animals or transportation constraints, or are uncomfortable waiting should consider leaving before an order, when officials permit and a safe route and destination are available.

EVS-003

Leave Early When Evacuation Is Possible — continued

2. EVACUATION ORDER OR DIRECTION: LEAVE NOW

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Do not wait to finish packing. Follow the authorized official's instructed route and destination. Use a different route or destination only if officials redirect you or the instructed path presents an immediate danger.

1. Take the people and animals with you who are present and ready. Take only essential items already at hand.

2. Use the instructed transportation, route, destination, and timing. Obey roadblocks and responder directions; do not take shortcuts into closed areas.

3. If you cannot evacuate as directed, contact the emergency or transportation-assistance service identified by local officials. If there is an immediate threat to life, call emergency services when safe and appropriate.

4. Continue monitoring official updates while traveling, without distracting the driver. Do not return until the responsible authority says the area is open.

3. IMMEDIATE THREAT: MOVE AWAY FROM DANGER

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

If life is in danger, do not wait for an alert, warning, or evacuation order. Move away from the danger immediately using the safest available direction. Conditions you can see, hear, smell, or feel may become life-threatening before an official message reaches you.

- Put distance and a protective barrier between you and the hazard. Do not enter smoke, moving floodwater, fire, a chemical release, damaged buildings, downed-wire areas, or another obvious danger to follow a planned route.
- Warn people immediately nearby if you can do so without delaying escape. Help children, people with access or functional needs, and animals only when you can do so without trapping yourself or others.
- Call emergency services when you are in a safer place and when calling is safe and appropriate. State your location, the threat, injuries, and anyone known to remain in danger; follow the call taker's instructions.
- Once clear, use official information to choose a safe destination and learn whether the area is closed. Do not go back into danger.

Leave Early When Evacuation Is Possible — continued

DO NOT DELAY FOR

- belongings beyond essentials already at hand;
- photographs or keepsakes;
- watering, covering, defending, or otherwise preparing property;
- searching for absent household members in an unsafe area — use the household communication plan and tell responders what you know; or
- television, radio, phone alerts, social media, neighbors, or other communication channel to agree.

ACT ON AUTHENTICATED INSTRUCTIONS OR AN IMMEDIATE THREAT.

FILL IN ONLY AFTER LOCAL VERIFICATION

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

LOCAL INFORMATION — UNVERIFIED UNTIL CONFIRMED BY THE RESPONSIBLE LOCAL AUTHORITY

Local warning/readiness levels and meanings:

_____

_____

Evacuation zone name/number and official lookup method:

_____

Official alert provider(s) and enrollment address:

_____

Official public-information / evacuation-assistance phone number(s):

_____

Authority confirming these entries: _____
Representative and role: _____ **Date verified:** _____
Verification method: _____ **Binder reviewer:** _____

Leave Early When Evacuation Is Possible — continued

CONTINUE YOUR PLAN

- **EVS-001:** use the readiness checklist to confirm that your household plan and essential supplies are ready.
- **EVS-004:** use your two planned routes and destinations, unless officials direct otherwise.
- **EVS-005:** use your primary or backup transportation arrangement; never enter an unsafe area to search for someone.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation” and “Alerts and Warnings”; FEMA, “Wireless Emergency Alerts” and “Planning Considerations for Evacuation and Shelter-in-Place”; CAL FIRE, “Ready, Set, Go!” Accessed September 25, 2026. Local details above intentionally remain unverified.

Plan Two Evacuation Routes

Plan and review two ways to leave—but always use the route that officials direct when an evacuation happens.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

DANGER — Current instructions come first. These planned routes do not override road closures, responder directions, changing fire or hazard conditions, or official evacuation routes. Never enter a closed road or drive toward smoke, fire, floodwater, debris, or another hazard. Leave early when officials direct you to evacuate.

START AND DESTINATIONS

Starting location: _____

Primary destination: _____

Address: _____ **Phone:** _____

Interim safe meeting place: _____

Use it when: _____

Out-of-area destination: _____

Address: _____ **Phone:** _____

Destination availability confirmed on: _____

ROUTE A — PRIMARY CORRIDOR

General direction / corridor: _____

Plan item	Route A details
Roads and turns, in order	_____ _____ _____
Recognizable landmarks	_____ _____
Household pickup points and who waits there	_____ _____
Hazards to monitor	_____ _____
Likely constraints (gates, bridges, narrow roads, traffic, seasonal access)	_____ _____

Safe place to pause or change plans: _____

Estimated travel time in ordinary conditions: _____

Plan Two Evacuation Routes — continued

- ☐ Route A follows a corridor officials may direct us to use; it is not treated as guaranteed open.
- ☐ Every driver or travel companion can identify the pickup points and destination.
- ☐ We have a paper map in case phone, power, or data service fails.

ROUTE B — GENUINELY DIFFERENT WAY OUT

Choose a different direction or corridor where possible—not just different turns that rejoin the same bottleneck.

Different general direction / corridor: _____

How this avoids Route A's shared roads, bridge, gate, or other constraint:

_____

Plan item	Route B details
Roads and turns, in order	_____ _____ _____
Recognizable landmarks	_____ _____
Household pickup points and who waits there	_____ _____
Hazards to monitor	_____ _____
Likely constraints (gates, bridges, narrow roads, traffic, seasonal access)	_____ _____

Safe place to pause or change plans: _____

Estimated travel time in ordinary conditions: _____

Plan Two Evacuation Routes — continued

HAND-DRAWN ROUTE MAP

Mark north, the start, both corridors, destinations, meeting place, pickup points, landmarks, known constraints, and alternate decision points. This blank is intentional; draw a map for your location.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

OFFICIAL INFORMATION WE WILL USE

Record responsible local sources now, then check them for current directions before and during travel.

Official source	Name, URL, phone, channel, or app	Last checked
Evacuation map	_____	_____
Zone / zone lookup	_____	_____
Emergency alerts	_____	_____
Road closures / transportation agency	_____	_____
Fire, law enforcement, or emergency management agency	_____	_____

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE USE

Our evacuation zone: _____ **Map edition / date:** _____

Who will monitor official updates: _____ **Backup:** _____

Local names and links remain blank until the household verifies them with the responsible agency.

DRAFT

EVS-004

Plan Two Evacuation Routes — continued

TRANSPORTATION AND FUEL ASSUMPTIONS

Primary transportation, driver, and seats: _____

Backup transportation / driver: _____

Fuel or charge level we will maintain: _____

Where fuel / charging may be available: _____

If fuel, charging, or the vehicle is unavailable, we will: _____

_____

Mobility equipment, car seats, animal transport, or loading time: _____

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Plan for support now. People who cannot drive should complete **EVS-005**. Anyone who may need evacuation assistance should also complete **EVS-010**. Do not assume emergency transportation will be immediately available.

IF A ROUTE IS UNAVAILABLE

If Route A is closed, unsafe, or conflicts with official instructions, who decides and what do we do?

Decision-maker: _____ We will: ☐ Follow the official route ☐ Use Route B if officials allow

☐ Go to the interim safe meeting place if safe ☐ Other: _____

We will not: cross a closure, improvise a shortcut, or continue toward a worsening hazard.

REVIEW BOTH ROUTES

Route	Driven	Walked	Otherwise reviewed (method)	Person(s) reviewing / notes
A	_____	_____	_____	_____
B	_____	_____	_____	_____
A	_____	_____	_____	_____
B	_____	_____	_____	_____

Next review date: _____ **Review after roads, destinations, transport, or household needs change.**

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation,” https://www.ready.gov/evacuation; CAL FIRE, “Ready, Set, Go!,” https://www.fire.ca.gov/prepare/get-ready-to-go. Accessed September 25, 2026. Local maps, zones, alerts, closures, and routes must be confirmed with the responsible agencies.

DRAFT

Evacuation Transportation Plan

Arrange a safe way to leave, a backup if that way fails, and the help each person, animal, and essential device will need.

EVS-005

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Leave when officials direct you to leave. Follow current evacuation routes and traffic control. Do not delay departure to finish this worksheet, gather belongings, or wait for a preferred ride.

IF USING A VEHICLE

- ☐ **Maintain it:** follow the manufacturer's routine service schedule; check tires, lights, brakes, fluids, battery, and required safety equipment.
- ☐ **Keep it usable:** maintain enough fuel or battery charge to leave the affected area, accounting for detours and congestion. Know a safe backup fueling or charging option.
- ☐ **Keep access ready:** place keys where authorized drivers can find them, and keep any gate, garage, or charging instructions with the plan.
- ☐ **Load safely:** use a seat and restraint for every person. Secure mobility equipment, carriers, supplies, and other cargo so they cannot move or block the driver's view, controls, or exits. Stay within vehicle and restraint limits.
- ☐ **Carry navigation:** keep current paper maps in case cellular service or navigation fails. Mark more than one route, but use the route officials direct during an evacuation.
- ☐ **Carry emergency supplies:** include water, essential medicines, first aid, phone charging, a flashlight, weather-appropriate clothing, and vehicle emergency items appropriate to local conditions.
- ☐ **Be ready early:** load essential items and position the vehicle before roads become congested—without blocking a road, sidewalk, fire lane, or hydrant.

Driver/contact name: _____ **Phone:** _____

Backup driver/contact: _____ **Phone:** _____

Vehicle make/model/color: _____

License plate: _____ **Usual location of keys:** _____

Fuel/charging plan: _____

EVS-005

Evacuation Transportation Plan — continued

IF NOT DRIVING

- ☐ Ask at least two household members, neighbors, friends, or caregivers whether they can provide a ride. Confirm what would cause them to come or call.
- ☐ Identify regular public transit and paratransit options. Learn eligibility, advance-reservation rules, operating hours, fare, service-area, companion, mobility-device, and animal policies before an emergency.
- ☐ Learn whether local officials provide evacuation transportation or an assistance registry. Registration may not guarantee a ride; keep another method.
- ☐ Tell the provider about an accessible pickup location and any boarding help, lift or ramp, securement position, mobility-equipment space, communication support, personal assistant, service animal, pet carrier, or other capacity needed.
- ☐ Keep the pickup address and entrance precise. Arrange a safe way to reach the pickup point; do not wait outdoors in hazardous conditions.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Jurisdiction-specific transportation — VERIFY BEFORE USE OR PUBLICATION

Public transit provider / route: [VERIFY provider, service area, operating status, and official source]
Official phone: [VERIFY] **Website:** [VERIFY]

Paratransit provider: [VERIFY provider, eligibility, reservation process, and emergency policy]
Official phone: [VERIFY] **Website:** [VERIFY]

Evacuation assistance program or registry: [VERIFY agency, eligibility, enrollment, and limitations]
Official phone: [VERIFY] **Website:** [VERIFY]

Official evacuation pickup site(s): [VERIFY locations and when officials activate them]

Verified directly with responsible agency by: _____ Date: _____

Evacuation Transportation Plan — continued

BACKUP PLAN

Choose two contacts or methods that do not depend on the same person, vehicle, provider, or communication channel.

Method/contact 1: _____ **Phone:** _____

Vehicle/provider and capacity: _____

Method/contact 2: _____ **Phone:** _____

Vehicle/provider and capacity: _____

Primary meeting/pickup point: _____

Backup meeting/pickup point: _____

Trigger to request help early: When _____

I will contact: _____ **by this method:** _____

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

Request help before conditions worsen. Use the trigger above when transport may take time—for example, when an official warning is issued, a likely hazard is approaching, a driver becomes unavailable, or accessible transportation may be limited. Do not wait for immediate danger.

CAPACITY AND ACCESS CHECK

Pickup location and accessible entrance: _____

Boarding, transfer, lift, ramp, or communication help: _____

Mobility equipment and space required: _____

Equipment dimensions/weight or securement note: _____

Animal capacity needed (number, species, carrier/restraint): _____

_____

Passenger count: _____ **Seat/restraint needs:** _____

Evacuation Transportation Plan — continued

1. **Check** current instructions from public officials before moving, if it is safe to do so.
2. **Follow** official routes, signs, checkpoints, lane controls, and directions from emergency personnel. Do not take a familiar shortcut when officials direct another route.
3. **Keep** roads, shoulders, intersections, gates, and access points clear for responders and other evacuees. Stop or park only in a safe, permitted place.
4. **Turn around** rather than drive through floodwater or a closed, damaged, blocked, burning, smoke-obscured, or otherwise unsafe road. Never move a barricade.
5. **Avoid exposing** anyone to smoke, floodwater, fire, downed wires, debris, hazardous materials, or another danger while walking, waiting, loading, transferring, refueling, or charging. Change plans and request help from a safe location.
6. **Tell** the household contact when the group departs and, when safe, when it arrives. Continue monitoring official information because routes and destinations can change.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Do not enter floodwater. Water can hide a washed-out road and can move a vehicle. Turn around, obey closures, and use an official alternate route.

VERIFY AND CONNECT THIS PLAN

- ☐ Both transportation methods agreed to the plan and know the pickup points.
- ☐ The vehicle or provider can carry every passenger, mobility device, essential item, and animal safely.
- ☐ Routes, contact details, provider rules, and pickup accessibility were checked.
- ☐ This plan is stored with paper maps and the household's evacuation materials.

Last verification date: _____ **Verified with/by:** _____

Use related handouts instead of duplicating their worksheets: EVS-004 for evacuation routes and destinations; EVS-006 for children and animals; EVS-007 for shelter-in-place planning; and EVS-010 for accessible evacuation planning.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation” and “Individuals with Disabilities” (accessed 2026-09-25); National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, “Vehicle Safety” (accessed 2026-09-25); National Weather Service, “Turn Around Don't Drown” (accessed 2026-09-25).

https://www.ready.gov/evacuation

https://www.ready.gov/disability

https://www.nhtsa.gov/vehicle-safety

https://www.weather.gov/safety/flood-turn-around-dont-drown

DRAFT

Evacuating Children and Animals

Assign a person, safe way to travel, and confirmed destination for every child and animal before an evacuation.

EVS-006

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Life safety comes first. Animal loading can take significant time. Begin early when officials advise preparation, especially for livestock—but never delay escape from immediate danger to find, catch, or load an animal.

CHILDREN

- ☐ **Assign caregivers:** name a primary adult and a backup for each child. Make sure each person accepts the role and has needed car seats, medicines, access items, and contact information.
- ☐ **Follow reunification rules:** learn each school or childcare site's emergency notification, relocation, identification, and authorized-pickup process. Go to the location officials announce; do not rush to a school or care site unless directed.
- ☐ **Carry identification:** give the child age-appropriate household and emergency-contact information. Keep a current photo and key medical, allergy, communication, and custody or pickup information with the caregiver.
- ☐ **Pack familiar essentials:** include required medicines and support items, plus a comfort item, quiet activity, hearing protection, and a communication card or device when useful.
- ☐ **Practice without frightening:** explain likely sounds and steps in simple, age-appropriate language. Practice holding hands, going to the meeting place, using a car seat, stating a caregiver's name, and following a trusted adult.

Primary caregiver: _____ **Backup:** _____
School/care reunification instructions kept at: _____

PETS AND SERVICE ANIMALS

A service animal is not a pet. When confirming transportation and shelter, identify it as a service animal and ask officials about current access and shelter procedures for the animal and handler. Pet admission or co-sheltering rules may differ. Do not assume that any destination accepts pets.

- ☐ Keep identification and contact details on each animal when appropriate. Carry a current photo of the animal with its handler or owner, microchip information, and recovery contacts.
- ☐ Assign a primary and backup handler. Practice using the labeled carrier, crate, leash, harness, or other species-appropriate restraint that will travel with the animal.
- ☐ Pack medicines, dosing and care instructions, veterinary and vaccination records, food, water, bowls, and any gear needed for a service animal's work.
- ☐ Pack litter or bedding, waste bags, absorbent material, cleaning supplies, and other species-appropriate sanitation items.
- ☐ Confirm a primary and backup animal-accepting destination before an incident and again when leaving. Ask what species, records, equipment, and arrangements the site currently accepts.

Evacuating Children and Animals — continued

Animal / handler: _____ **Backup:** _____
Confirmed destination / phone: _____

LIVESTOCK AND LARGE ANIMALS

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Move early or move yourself: loading large animals requires time, suitable equipment, capable handlers, and usable routes. Start at the early trigger in your plan when officials advise preparation. If conditions become immediately dangerous, leave without delaying for an animal.

- ☐ **Set early decision triggers:** use official alerts and local direction, plus the time needed to gather handlers, reach the animals, load, and travel before routes or conditions become unsafe.
- ☐ **Know transport capacity:** inventory animals and confirm enough suitable tow vehicles, trailers, cages, fuel, loading space, and trips. Stay within vehicle and trailer limits.
- ☐ **Assign trailers and handlers:** identify capable primary and backup drivers and handlers. Keep halters, leads, panels, loading aids, keys, and protective equipment ready.
- ☐ **Confirm destinations:** contact the receiving location and responsible local authority. Confirm route, opening, capacity, unloading, identification and health-record requirements, biosecurity, feed, water, shelter, and daily care.
- ☐ **Identify animals:** maintain an inventory, current photos, owner contact details, and permanent or temporary identification appropriate for the species.
- ☐ **Follow local direction:** local officials determine safe routes, activated facilities, movement restrictions, and incident-specific livestock instructions. Follow current livestock-evacuation direction from emergency management and the responsible animal or agricultural authorities.

Early trigger: _____
Trailer / driver / handlers: _____
Destination confirmed with / date: _____

IF THE HOUSEHOLD IS SEPARATED

1. **Follow instructions where you are.** A child stays with the responsible school, childcare site, or caregiver until released through that site's process.
2. **Use assigned retrievers.** Record who is authorized and equipped to retrieve each child, pet, service animal with its handler, or livestock group. Share any written authorization and access instructions in advance.
3. **Call the backup.** If the primary person cannot act, contact the named backup and the out-of-area household contact. Tell them what officials have directed and where the dependent or animal is believed to be.
4. **Do not go into danger.** Never enter an unsafe, evacuated, or closed area to retrieve a child, dependent, or animal. Tell emergency officials what help is needed and follow their direction.

Evacuating Children and Animals — continued

Child, dependent, or animal	Authorized retriever / handler	Backup and phone
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE AND MAINTENANCE

- ☐ Practice calm carrier, vehicle, and trailer loading. Include the actual handlers and equipment, but stop if a drill would endanger a person or animal.
- ☐ Time the loading drill and use the result to move the early-action trigger sooner if needed.
- ☐ Reconfirm school and childcare release procedures and every human- and animal-accepting destination. Check alternatives, routes, hours, capacity, and contact details.
- ☐ Update child and animal photos, identification, medicine lists, veterinary and vaccination records, care instructions, pickup authorizations, and emergency contacts.
- ☐ Inspect carriers, restraints, car seats, trailers, tires, lights, hitches, brakes, gates, ramps, loading aids, sanitation supplies, batteries, and communication devices.

Check	Last completed	Next review / action
Child plan and reunification rules	_____	_____
Pet / service-animal loading and destination	_____	_____
Livestock loading, transport, and destination	_____	_____
Photos, identification, medicines, and records	_____	_____
Carriers, restraints, vehicles, and trailers	_____	_____

Evacuating Children and Animals — continued

USE WITH THE REST OF THE PLAN

- Use **STH-005 — Child & Caregiver Planning** for medicines, equipment, communication, transportation, and caregiver support.
- Use **STH-006 — Animal Planning** for the detailed animal inventory, supplies, handling notes, and backup transport plan.
- Use **EVS-003** for leave-early decision points, **EVS-004** for routes and destinations, **EVS-005** for transportation, **EVS-007** for shelter-in-place planning, and **EVS-009** for return. Follow current official instructions if a worksheet conflicts with incident direction.

SOURCES

Sources: Ready Kids, “Make a Plan”; Ready.gov, “Pets and Animals”; U.S. Department of Justice Civil Rights Division, “Frequently Asked Questions about Service Animals and the ADA”; and USDA APHIS, “Animal Health Emergency Management.” Accessed 2026-09-25. Confirm school, childcare, shelter, transport, livestock, and evacuation procedures with the responsible local organizations.

DRAFT

Shelter-in-Place Basics

Sheltering in place means staying inside, or moving into a nearby building, to reduce exposure to a danger outside.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

The right action depends on the hazard. A safe location for severe wind may be unsafe during a flood, fire, or chemical release. Follow current instructions from the responsible public agency. If officials order evacuation, do not remain simply because this plan says “shelter.”

ACT QUICKLY

1. **Go indoors.** Enter the nearest suitable building. Do not travel across a hazard to reach a preferred location.
2. **Bring people and animals in when safe.** Do not delay or go back into danger. Use leashes, carriers, or other restraints if they are within reach.
3. **Close openings.** Close and lock exterior doors and windows. Follow officials' instructions about ventilation, fans, fireplaces, dampers, or sealing a room; those actions vary by hazard.
4. **Move to the hazard-appropriate location.** Take essential supplies and help anyone who needs mobility, communication, medical, or other support.
5. **Monitor official information.** Use the alert source below and keep checking for changes, evacuation orders, or an all-clear.
6. **Preserve communication.** Keep a phone or radio with you, use low-power mode, dim screens, text instead of calling when practical, and reserve emergency calls for emergencies.

CHOOSE FOR THE HAZARD—NOT BY HABIT

Severe wind or tornado

Use a basement or a small interior room on the lowest level of a sturdy building, away from windows. Protect your head and neck. A vehicle or mobile/manufactured home is not a safe tornado shelter; use the sturdy shelter identified in your plan when you can reach it safely.

Chemical release

Follow the issuing agency's exact location and ventilation instructions. Officials may direct you to an interior room with few windows or exterior doors and tell you whether to shut down air-handling equipment and seal openings. Do not assume wind-storm or smoke actions apply.

Smoke or poor outdoor air

Follow official air-quality and public-health instructions. For choosing and setting up a cleaner-air room, use **EVS-008**; this handout does not replace its smoke-specific guidance.

Fire, flood, or other threat

An interior room is not a universal refuge. Rising water may require movement to higher ground, and fire or structural damage may require immediate escape. Use the protective action and destination named by officials.

Shelter-in-Place Basics — continued

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

LOCAL SHELTER INSTRUCTIONS / ALERT CHANNELS — VERIFY BEFORE USE

Responsible agency: _____
Official shelter instructions: _____
Official alert channel or enrollment page: _____
Verified directly with agency by: _____ **Date:** _____

Leave entries blank until checked against a current, agency-controlled source. Incident instructions override this planning handout.

KEEP THESE SUPPLIES WITHIN REACH

- ☐ **Communication:** charged phone, power bank and cables; battery or hand-crank radio; written contacts
- ☐ **Light:** flashlights or headlamps and spare batteries—use these instead of candles
- ☐ **Water:** stored drinking water for people and animals
- ☐ **Necessary medicines:** labeled medicines, dosing information, and temperature control as required
- ☐ **Sanitation:** hygiene items, toilet supplies, waste bags, hand-cleaning supplies, and animal cleanup items
- ☐ **Individual support equipment:** mobility and communication aids, glasses, hearing-device supplies, backup power, service-animal supplies, and other daily essentials

PREVENT CARBON MONOXIDE POISONING AND FIRE

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Never use fuel-burning equipment indoors. A generator, charcoal grill, camp stove, gasoline engine, or other combustion device can produce deadly carbon monoxide (CO), an odorless, colorless gas.

- Operate a portable generator outdoors, at least 20 feet from the home, with exhaust pointed away from doors, windows, and vents. Never use it in a home, basement, garage, shed, carport, or other enclosed or partly enclosed space.
- Keep working battery-powered or battery-backup CO alarms near sleeping areas, and follow the manufacturer's placement and maintenance instructions.
- Never heat a home with a gas oven or range. Never burn charcoal indoors. Keep combustion devices away from dry materials and never refuel a hot generator.
- If a CO alarm sounds, or anyone develops headache, dizziness, weakness, nausea, vomiting, chest pain, or confusion, get everyone—including animals—to fresh air away from the suspected source and call emergency services. Do not re-enter until responders say it is safe.

Shelter-in-Place Basics — continued

LEAVE THE SHELTER ONLY WHEN

- **Officials direct a move:** follow an evacuation order, relocation instruction, or all-clear and use the route or precautions they give.
- **The location becomes immediately unsafe:** fire, rising water, structural failure, a gas odor, a CO alarm, or dangerous symptoms may require immediate movement away from the danger and a call to emergency services.

Before opening doors or moving outside, check the latest official message when possible. During a chemical or airborne hazard, leaving may increase exposure; move only under official direction unless remaining presents an immediate danger.

WRITE THE HOUSEHOLD PLAN

Primary shelter location: _____

Alternate location: _____

Official alert source: _____

Support contact (name and method): _____

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Shelter” and “Chemical Emergencies”; National Weather Service, “During a Tornado”; Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, “Carbon Monoxide Poisoning Basics.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

DRAFT

Set Up a Cleaner-Air Room for Wildfire Smoke

A cleaner-air room can reduce wildfire-smoke particles while it is safe to remain indoors. Prepare it before smoke arrives, if possible.

EVS-008

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

A smoke shelter is not flame shelter. A cleaner-air room does not protect you from flames, extreme heat, or an approaching wildfire.

An air cleaner reduces particles; it does not supply oxygen, control heat, remove every gas, or make an unsafe building safe..

1. CHOOSE THE ROOM

Choose one room where everyone who needs cleaner air can spend time comfortably.

- ☐ It has a door and as few windows and exterior doors as practical, so it can be closed off.
- ☐ It is large enough for the people and animals who will use it, without blocking exits.
- ☐ It can remain at a safe, comfortable temperature. A closed room can become dangerously hot.
- ☐ It has electricity for an air cleaner and space around the unit for unobstructed airflow.
- ☐ It is away from indoor smoke, cooking fumes, and other particle sources.

Bring needed medicines, water, a phone and charger, and the household's alert information. Never block a required exit.

2. KEEP SMOKE OUT—WITHOUT TRAPPING DANGEROUS HEAT

- Close the room's windows and doors. Limit trips in and out. Close other windows and exterior doors in the home when it is safe to do so.
- For a central heating or cooling system, use **recirculate** mode and close the outdoor-air intake **only if the system's verified manufacturer or HVAC guidance says how**. Use a high-efficiency system filter that the manufacturer says the system can accommodate, and install it in the correct direction.
- If a window air conditioner has an outdoor-air damper, close it. Do not assume every air conditioner recirculates indoor air: portable single-hose units and evaporative coolers can bring in or pull in outdoor air. Follow the equipment manual or advice from a qualified HVAC professional.
- Do not tape over, disconnect, or alter combustion-air openings, exhausts, or other safety ventilation. Never defeat a smoke alarm or carbon-monoxide (CO) alarm.
- If closing the home makes it too hot, go to a cleaner-air center, cooling center, or other safe air-conditioned place identified by local officials. Heat can be immediately dangerous.

EVS-008

Set Up a Cleaner-Air Room for Wildfire Smoke — continued

3. USE A PORTABLE AIR CLEANER

Choose a unit that mechanically filters particles and does **not** intentionally produce ozone. Check the label or manufacturer's documentation rather than relying on words such as “air purifier.”

1. Measure the room's floor area. Choose a unit with a **smoke clean-air delivery rate (CADR) at least two-thirds of that area in square feet**, as recommended by EPA for rooms with 8-foot ceilings. A larger or taller room, open doorway, or heavy smoke may require more capacity; use EPA's sizing table or the manufacturer's verified room-size guidance.

2. Place the cleaner in the room where people spend the most time. Keep the air inlet and outlet clear of walls, curtains, furniture, and other obstructions. Follow the required clearance, electrical, and placement instructions in its manual.

3. Close windows and doors and run the unit as continuously as practical, at the highest speed that is tolerable. A lower speed filters less air.

4. Check the filter often during smoke events. Replace it when it is dirty, when the indicator or manual directs, or when airflow drops. Use the type specified by the manufacturer; unplug the unit before service and install the filter in the marked direction.

4. IF A DO-IT-YOURSELF AIR CLEANER IS THE ONLY OPTION

EPA reports that a well-constructed **box-fan-and-filter** air cleaner can temporarily reduce smoke particles, but its performance varies and a tested commercial unit is preferred. Use only a design published by EPA, AirNow, or your public-health authority, and follow that authority's current parts, assembly, and operating directions exactly. Do not invent a fan/filter arrangement or treat it as permanent equipment.

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

Prevent shock and fire: use a certified box fan made in 2012 or later with a fused plug and a safety mark such as UL or ETL. Inspect the fan, plug, and cord; do not use damaged equipment. Plug it directly into a suitable wall outlet—never an extension cord—and keep it away from water, curtains, clutter, children, and pets. Keep airflow clear. Do not leave it unattended or use it while sleeping.

An awake adult should supervise it. Turn it off and unplug it if it smells hot, makes unusual noise, vibrates, tips, is damaged, or the plug or cord becomes hot. Replace a dirty filter according to the verified design's directions. A DIY unit is not a substitute for leaving excessive heat, heavy smoke that continues indoors, a CO hazard, or a threatened building.

Set Up a Cleaner-Air Room for Wildfire Smoke — continued

5. DO NOT ADD PARTICLES OR COMBUSTION GASES

In the cleaner-air room and the rest of the home:

- Do not smoke or vape, burn candles or incense, or use a fireplace or wood stove.
- Avoid frying or broiling food. Use lower-particle cooking methods only when they can be used safely.
- Avoid vacuuming unless the vacuum has a HEPA filter; it can stir particles back into the air.
- Do not use aerosol sprays. Limit activities that stir up dust.
- Never use a generator, charcoal grill, camp stove, gasoline engine, or other fuel-burning device inside a home, garage, basement, shed, or near a door, window, or vent. Never heat the room with a gas oven or range.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Carbon monoxide cannot be seen or smelled. Keep working CO alarms in the home. Headache, dizziness, weakness, nausea, vomiting, chest pain, or confusion can indicate CO poisoning. Get everyone into fresh air and call 911 immediately; do not re-enter until responders say it is safe.

6. KEEP CHECKING CONDITIONS

- ☐ **Official information:** monitor local emergency alerts and evacuation directions. Check current air quality and smoke forecasts through AirNow or the air-quality agency identified by local officials.
- ☐ **Room conditions:** check temperature, comfort, visible or smelled smoke, air-cleaner airflow, and filter loading. A consumer particle monitor may show trends, but follow its instructions and do not let one reading override symptoms or official directions.
- ☐ **People:** check one another for coughing, wheezing, trouble breathing, chest tightness or pain, palpitations, unusual fatigue, headache, dizziness, confusion, or worsening of a medical condition.
- ☐ **Building safety:** keep exits clear and smoke and CO alarms active. Watch for power loss, electrical problems, fire, or worsening outdoor conditions.

Set Up a Cleaner-Air Room for Wildfire Smoke — continued

7. KNOW WHEN TO LEAVE OR GET HELP

Relocate to an official cleaner-air space, cooling center, or another safer building if the room becomes excessively hot; smoke continues to enter; filtration or essential power fails; a smoke or CO alarm sounds; the building becomes unsafe; or anyone cannot remain there safely. Check that the destination and route are open before travel when time allows.

Get medical help for symptoms that are severe, rapidly worsening, or not improving after moving to cleaner air. Call 911 for trouble breathing, chest pain, confusion, fainting, suspected CO poisoning, or another medical emergency. People with heart or lung disease, pregnant people, children, older adults, and others at higher risk should follow their clinician's action plan and seek advice early.

Evacuate immediately when officials direct, fire approaches, flames or embers threaten, or staying could cut off a safe exit. Do not rely on filtration against fire gases or flames.

RELATED HANDOUTS

Use **EVS-003** for your evacuation plan and **EVS-007** for additional wildfire-smoke actions. Current official directions always override a worksheet or handout.

SOURCES

Sources: U.S. EPA, “Create a Clean Room to Protect Indoor Air Quality During a Wildfire,” “Wildfires and Indoor Air Quality,” “Air Cleaners and Air Filters in the Home,” and “Research on DIY Air Cleaners to Reduce Wildfire Smoke Indoors”; AirNow, “Indoor Air Filtration Factsheet”; CDC, “About Carbon Monoxide.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

Returning Home After an Evacuation

Return only when the authority responsible for your location says your specific area is open. A lifted evacuation order does not guarantee that every road, building, or utility is safe.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Do not enter a dangerous property. If you see or suspect structural collapse, fire, smoke, a gas leak, damaged electrical equipment, downed lines, or a chemical release, move away and follow emergency officials' instructions.

1. BEFORE RETURNING

- ☐ Wait for official authorization to return; verify that it applies to the correct zone, neighborhood, or street address.
- ☐ Check official route restrictions, closures, curfews, and current hazards. Use the route authorities direct you to use.
- ☐ Tell a contact where you are going, your route, who is with you, and when you will check in. Do not return alone if officials advise against it.
- ☐ Bring a charged phone and backup power, battery radio, flashlight, first-aid supplies, safe drinking water, sturdy closed-toe shoes or boots, work gloves, eye protection, and task-appropriate respiratory protection.
- ☐ Bring essential medicines and identification. Plan for children, older adults, people with access or medical needs, and animals to remain somewhere safe until conditions are suitable.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE USE

Official reentry portal or information source: _____

Utility emergency contacts: _____

Approved debris/disposal site or cleanup program: _____

Confirm each entry with the responsible local authority or provider after this emergency; hours, boundaries, routes, and services can change.

Returning Home After an Evacuation — continued

2. APPROACHING THE PROPERTY

Slow down, stay alert, and obey barriers and responder directions. Do not drive or walk around a closure.

- ☐ Look up and around for leaning or unstable trees, hanging limbs, damaged poles, downed lines, and structures that may collapse.
- ☐ Watch for washed-out or undermined roads, damaged bridges, loose debris, broken glass, sharp metal, open holes, and unstable ground.
- ☐ Stay away from smoke, ash plumes, flames, smoldering material, and hotspots. Fire can remain hidden in roofs, walls, vegetation, or debris.
- ☐ Do not enter or drive through floodwater. It can conceal road damage, carry sewage or chemicals, and be electrically charged.
- ☐ Avoid spilled containers, unusual odors, oily sheen, dust, ash, and unknown hazardous material. Do not touch, move, or sample them.
- ☐ Give displaced wildlife, frightened pets, livestock, and insects space; do not reach into debris or concealed areas.
- ☐ Keep clear of firefighting, utility, law-enforcement, rescue, and debris-removal operations.

Returning Home After an Evacuation — continued

3. BEFORE ENTERING

1. **Stop at the perimeter.** Do not enter if an authority has posted a restriction, a structure has shifted or is visibly damaged, water surrounds it, or you suspect an electrical, gas, fire, smoke, or chemical hazard.
2. **Use qualified help.** Ask the appropriate building official, licensed professional, fire authority, utility, or hazardous-materials authority to assess the suspected hazard. Follow their instructions before entry.
3. **Recheck from outside.** Look for sagging roofs or ceilings, leaning walls, damaged foundations, broken utility connections, sparks, hissing, smoke, or unusual odors. Never use a flame to inspect.
4. **Leave immediately if conditions change.** Do not retrieve possessions at the cost of personal safety.

4. UTILITIES AND EQUIPMENT

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Do not switch on, reconnect, relight, test, or operate a damaged or wet utility, appliance, generator, solar or battery system, fuel tank, or other equipment. Wait for authorization or inspection by the responsible utility or an appropriately qualified professional.

- Treat every downed line as energized. Stay away and report it through the responsible authority.
- If you smell gas, hear hissing, see arcing, or suspect a leak, do not create a spark or operate switches. Leave the area and seek emergency or utility guidance from a safe location.
- Never run a generator, grill, camp stove, or other fuel-burning device inside a home, garage, basement, shed, or near doors, windows, or vents; carbon monoxide can kill without warning.
- Do not use tap water, sewer service, heating or cooling equipment, elevators, or damaged vehicles until the responsible authority or qualified professional says they are safe.

Returning Home After an Evacuation — continued

5. FOOD, WATER, MEDICINE, AND CLEANUP

- ☐ Follow current drinking-water, food, public-health, and medicine advisories. When in doubt, do not eat, drink, or use an item exposed to floodwater, heat, smoke, chemicals, or unsafe temperatures.
- ☐ Ask a pharmacist or health professional how to replace medicine that may be contaminated, damaged, or stored outside its labeled temperature range. Do not guess whether it is safe.
- ☐ Photograph damage only from a safe location. Record serial numbers and make an inventory before discarding items when it is safe and authorities or an insurer permit.
- ☐ Match protective equipment to the task and official guidance. At minimum, cleanup may require sturdy boots, heavy work gloves, eye protection, protective clothing, and suitable respiratory protection.
- ☐ Ventilate only when authorities say outdoor air is safe and doing so will not spread contamination. Keep children, people with health risks, and animals away from cleanup.
- ☐ Never mix cleaners or disinfectants. In particular, mixing bleach with ammonia or another cleaner can release dangerous gases.
- ☐ Do not cut, sand, sweep, burn, pressure-wash, or otherwise disturb unknown dust, ash, insulation, damaged building material, chemical containers, or suspected asbestos. Seek guidance for assessment and disposal.
- ☐ Use safe lifting practices, take breaks, wash exposed skin, and prevent carbon-monoxide exposure. Stop work if protective equipment fails or the hazard is beyond your training.

6. HEALTH AND STRESS

Leave again if fire, floodwater, weather, air quality, structural conditions, utilities, chemicals, animals, or responder activity make the area unsafe. Call emergency services for an immediate threat. Seek prompt medical or poison-control advice for injury, breathing trouble, chest pain, dizziness, confusion, burns, chemical exposure, or other concerning symptoms.

Disasters and loss can cause strong stress reactions. Pace the work, rest, eat and drink safely, stay connected with supportive people, and seek a health professional or crisis service if distress is severe, persistent, or makes it hard to function or stay safe.

Returning Home After an Evacuation — continued

7. RETURN CHECKLIST

Address / evacuation zone: _____

Authorization source and notice: _____

Authorization verified on: _____ **Return date / time:** _____

Approved route and restrictions: _____

Contact told my plan: _____ **Check-in time:** _____

- ☐ Protective and communication supplies packed
- ☐ Property checked from a safe distance
- ☐ Posted restrictions and responder operations checked
- ☐ Food, water, medicine, and air advisories checked
- ☐ Damage documented without entering a hazard

◎ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

LOCAL INSPECTION INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE USE

Building / structural inspection contact: _____

Electrical / gas / water utility contact: _____

Fire / hazardous-materials contact: _____

Confirm roles and contact methods with the issuing authority or provider for this incident.

Insurance / recovery contact: _____

Unresolved hazards — location, description, and who was notified:

_____

_____

Do not enter / leave again if: _____

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Returning Home After a Disaster”; CDC, “How to Safely Clean Up After a Natural Disaster” and “Keep Food Safe After a Disaster or Emergency”; FDA, “Food and Water Safety During Power Outages and Floods”; EPA, “Dealing with Debris and Damaged Buildings.” Accessed 2026-09-25.

DRAFT

Accessible Evacuation Planning

Write a person-directed plan for the assistance, information, equipment, and time you need to leave safely and stay at a destination.

EVS-010

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Leave before conditions become unsafe when officials tell you to evacuate. If danger is immediate, use the safest available way to reach safety and tell responders what assistance you want. This worksheet does not replace instructions from emergency officials or individualized advice from your clinician, pharmacist, equipment supplier, or manufacturer.

PLAN FOR DISRUPTED ROUTINES

Plan for **loss of power, separation from your usual support, inaccessible routes, and communication failures**. A diagnosis does not tell another person what assistance you need. Describe what works for you, ask before assistance is given, and revise this plan whenever your needs or circumstances change.

Name I want used: _____ **Plan date:** _____

Where I keep a portable copy: _____

1. COMMUNICATION, LANGUAGE, AND ALERTS

My preferred language: _____ **Interpreter type, if wanted:** _____

My preferred ways to communicate (speech, text, writing, sign, device, communication board, other):

_____

Give alerts or instructions to me this way (visual, audible, vibration, plain language, large print, captioning, relay, other):

_____

Allow this time or use these steps so I can receive, understand, and respond:

_____

If power, cellular service, internet, or my usual device fails, use:

_____

- ☐ I enrolled in the alert methods I choose and tested their accessibility.
- ☐ I keep alerts, contacts, and instructions in more than one format.
- ☐ My communication device, charger, batteries, adapters, and low-tech backup travel with me.

EVS-010

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

2. MOBILITY, TRANSFER, AND WAYFINDING

How I move or navigate; mobility devices I use: _____

Assistance I want with guiding, stairs, boarding, transfers, positioning, or balance:

_____

Ask or tell me before helping by: _____

Do not lift, guide, transfer, fold, or secure me or my equipment this way:

_____

Backup route or method if elevators, curb cuts, lighting, or the usual route cannot be used:

_____

Transportation assistance and loading time I need: _____

Practice only in a safe setting. Have the person direct assistance; helpers should not improvise a lift, transfer, tie-down, or equipment-handling technique.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

3. MEDICINES, SUPPLIES, EQUIPMENT, AND POWER

Keep detailed clinical information only where you choose. Ask the appropriate professional to verify product-specific instructions; do not guess about doses, refrigeration time, power connections, or device runtime.

Item or need	What must travel	Storage, power, or backup plan	Prescriber, pharmacy, supplier, or support contact
Medicine(s)	_____	_____	_____
Refrigerated item(s)	_____	_____	_____
Medical or personal-care supplies	_____	_____	_____
Durable medical equipment	_____	_____	_____
Power-dependent equipment	_____	_____	_____

Allergies or urgent information I choose to share: _____

If refrigeration is interrupted, my pharmacist, clinician, or manufacturer says to:

_____

If equipment or power is unavailable, my verified clinical contingency plan is kept:

_____

- ☐ I have a current medicine list and enough legal, safely stored supplies for my plan.
- ☐ I have compatible chargers, batteries, adapters, and a professionally reviewed backup-power plan.
- ☐ I know how supplies and equipment will travel with me, not in a separate vehicle unless I choose and can remain safe.
- ☐ I have written shutdown, transport, storage, cleaning, and restart instructions for exact equipment models.

EVS-010

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

4. PERSONAL ASSISTANCE AND BACKUP PEOPLE

Assistance I want with personal care, eating, drinking, positioning, communication, decision support, or other activities:

_____

Primary caregiver/helper and agreed responsibilities:

_____

Backup helper and agreed responsibilities: _____

If my usual support person and I are separated, I will:

_____

Out-of-area contact and how to reach them: _____

Share the minimum information each person needs. Confirm that every helper agrees to the role, knows how you direct assistance, and has a backup if they are affected by the same emergency.

5. SERVICE-ANIMAL PLAN

Animal's name and task-related support helpers should know: _____

Food, water, medicines, harness/leash, waste supplies, records, and other items packed:

_____

Relief routine or location needs: _____

Backup handler, veterinarian, or care plan if I cannot provide care:

_____

Do not distract, feed, handle, or separate a service animal from its handler without the handler's permission. Plan for the animal to evacuate with the handler and for needed supplies to remain together.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

6. PICKUP, TRANSPORTATION, AND DESTINATIONS

Confirm each arrangement directly before an emergency and again when conditions change.

Plan	Primary choice	Backup choice
Accessible pickup point	_____	_____
Route to pickup point	_____	_____
Transportation provider/method	_____	_____
Destination or shelter	_____	_____
Reunification location	_____	_____

Pickup point features I need (level route, curb access, lighting, seating, weather cover, other):

_____

Transportation capacity to confirm: person plus _____ support person(s), _____ mobility device(s), service animal, and these essential supplies/equipment: _____

Vehicle access, lift/ramp, securement, seating, transfer, or loading needs:

_____

Destination features to confirm: accessible route and entrance; toilet and bathing access; cot or sleeping arrangement; communication access; charging or backup power; refrigeration; personal assistance; service-animal relief area; and any other support I need.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

My requirements and confirmation notes:

_____

EVS-010

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Local details must be verified with the responsible organization. Keep all registry, paratransit, assistance-program, phone-number, eligibility, enrollment, pickup, capacity, and shelter-accessibility information in this block until verified. Services, eligibility, capacity, and accessibility can change; record who confirmed each fact and when.

[VERIFY] Local emergency-management or registry program:

_____

Phone/website: _____ Eligibility or enrollment rules: _____

What the program does and does not provide: _____

Confirmed by responsible organization/representative: _____ Date: _____

[VERIFY] Paratransit or accessible evacuation transportation:

_____

Phone/website: _____ Eligibility, reservation, and activation rules: _____

Vehicle/device/passenger capacity: _____

Confirmed by responsible organization/representative: _____ Date: _____

[VERIFY] Assistance program or accessible destination/shelter:

_____

Phone/website: _____ Eligibility or admission rules: _____

Accessibility and support features confirmed: _____

Confirmed by responsible organization/representative: _____ Date: _____

Registration is not a guarantee of rescue, transportation, priority power restoration, admission, or a particular service. Keep a primary and backup plan and request help early.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

7. EQUIPMENT IDENTIFICATION AND HANDLING NOTES

Attach additional manufacturer or clinician instructions if needed. Do not include information you do not want to share.

Equipment	Make/model/serial number	Travels or stores this way	Setup, shutdown, handling, or safety note	Supplier/support
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Where verified instructions are kept: _____

Parts that must stay together / parts that must not be removed:

_____

Who may operate or assist with this equipment: _____

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

8. PERSONAL SUPPORT NETWORK

Ask each person first. A confirmation means the person understands and accepts the role; it does not transfer control of your plan or authorize assistance you do not want.

Person and relationship	Contact method(s)	Location	Agreed role	Backup if unavailable	Confirmed/date
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

Who checks on me first: _____ **When:** _____

Who brings supplies/equipment: _____ **Access arrangement:** _____

Who contacts the out-of-area person: _____ **How we confirm completion:** _____

What helpers should do if communication fails:

_____

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

9. PRACTICE AND ASK-FOR-HELP TRIGGERS

Practice communication, check-in, route, loading, equipment, destination, and reunification parts separately if a full exercise would be unsafe. Never interrupt essential power, medicine, oxygen, or care to test this plan without appropriate professional guidance.

Practice or review	Date completed	What worked / what must change	Next date
Alert and communication backup	_____	_____	_____
Network check-in and separation plan	_____	_____	_____
Route and accessible pickup point	_____	_____	_____
Vehicle boarding and equipment capacity	_____	_____	_____
Destination confirmation	_____	_____	_____

I will request help early when (check and complete the triggers that apply to me):

- ☐ An evacuation warning or other official trigger occurs: _____
- ☐ My usual route, elevator, vehicle, caregiver, or communication method may become unavailable.
- ☐ Power is expected to be lost or my verified backup threshold is reached: _____
- ☐ Medicine, refrigeration, oxygen, battery, or supply reserve reaches my verified threshold: _____
- ☐ Weather, smoke, flooding, heat, traffic, or another condition will make leaving harder if I wait.
- ☐ My primary helper does not confirm by: _____
- ☐ Another person-directed trigger: _____

Who I contact first and by what method: _____

Backup action if no one responds: _____

KEEP THIS PLAN USABLE

Review it after every practice, move, change in support, medicine or equipment change, and at the interval you choose. Protect private information; carry only what you need and share it only with people you choose.

Accessible Evacuation Planning — continued

RELATED HANDOUTS

Use this worksheet with STH-004 — Disability & Access Planning; caregivers may also use STH-005 — Child & Caregiver Planning. For readiness, go-bags, leave-early decisions, routes, transportation, and children or animals, see EVS-001, EVS-002, EVS-003, EVS-004, EVS-005, and EVS-006. Check the binder index for availability; handouts still in development may not yet appear there.

SOURCES

Sources and further planning guidance

U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Ready.gov, “Individuals with Disabilities.”

U.S. Department of Justice, ADA.gov, “Emergency Planning.”

U.S. Food and Drug Administration, “Emergency Power Planning Checklist.”

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Administration for Community Living, “Emergency Preparedness Resources for People with Disabilities.”

Federal Emergency Management Agency, “Guidance on Planning for Integration of Functional Needs Support Services in General Population Shelters.”

Accessed 2026-09-25.

DRAFT

Small Animal Emergency Evacuation

Prepare to leave safely with every household pet and care for them during a three-day displacement. This guide is for La Habra Heights Fire Watch members and residents with dogs, cats, birds, and other non-livestock pets.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Leave immediate danger. Take pets you can safely reach, but never delay escape to search for or capture an animal. Do not enter smoke, floodwater, damaged buildings, contaminated areas, or closed evacuation zones. From safety, tell emergency officials about animals left behind. Call 911 for immediate threats to human life.

THE PLAN AT A GLANCE

1. **Prepare now.** Assign handlers and backups, practice loading, identify destinations, and pack supplies for each pet.
2. **Act early.** When authorities advise preparation, bring pets into a safe, accessible area if it is safe to do so. Ready carriers and transport before conditions worsen.
3. **Leave as directed.** Use current official routes and instructions. Load pets securely and take their supplies and records.

MATCH YOUR ACTION TO THE HAZARD

Emergency	What to do
Fire	For a building fire, get out immediately. For a nearby wildfire, prepare and move pets early when safe; follow evacuation instructions. Never return to a burning building for a pet.
Earthquake	During shaking, Drop, Cover, and Hold On; do not chase pets or run outside. After shaking stops, secure pets when safe and follow official instructions about evacuation and damaged areas.
Flooding	Move early along safe routes before access is cut off. Never walk or drive through floodwater to reach or transport an animal.
Hazardous materials	Follow officials' direction to evacuate or shelter in place. If told to shelter, keep pets with you in the designated indoor area and follow ventilation instructions. Report suspected contamination before entering transport or a center.

Fire Watch: help residents prepare, share official instructions, and relay assistance requests. Do not enter restricted areas or attempt unsafe rescues.

Operational owner: Mark Hughes. **Veterinary review:** pending; reviewer not yet identified. **Draft for review:** SAMPLE TEXT — NOT APPROVED ADVICE.

SOURCES

CDC guidance: Pets, Earthquakes, Floods, and Chemical Emergencies. Accessed October 29, 2026.

DRAFT

Plan Before an Emergency

Complete this checklist with everyone who may care for your pets. Keep the private household plan with your go kit; post only the window notice.

EVS-011

PLANNING CHECKLIST

- ☐ **List every pet.** Record species, name, appearance, usual location, hiding places, identification, and handling or medical needs. Keep recent photos, including one with the owner.
- ☐ **Assign a handler and backup.** Make sure each accepts the role. Arrange written permission and safe access for a trusted caregiver if you are away. Keep keys and access codes off the public notice.
- ☐ **Prepare suitable equipment.** Have a secure carrier, kennel, cage, or species-appropriate restraint for each pet. Label equipment with the animal's name and your phone number.
- ☐ **Confirm transport capacity.** Fit every pet, person, and essential supply in the planned vehicle safely. Arrange a backup driver and vehicle; do not rely on a later return trip.
- ☐ **Choose destinations and two routes.** Include a backup outside the affected area. Check accepted species, required equipment, and care arrangements. Review the City's Be Informed page for official alert information.
- ☐ **Prepare health records.** Keep vaccination and medication records, microchip details, ownership information, veterinary contacts, and care instructions in a waterproof pouch, with an offline digital copy.
- ☐ **Practice.** Rehearse calm carrier use and loading. Time the process and allow extra time in your early departure plan. Update after changes and check supplies regularly.

◎ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

La Habra Heights arrangements — [VERIFY] before distribution: The planning arrangement is for city-provided evacuation centers to accept small animals on leash or in kennels or other suitable enclosures. Confirm accepted species, intake requirements, and the animal-assistance process with the City. During an incident, use the location officials announce; ask about unusual pets before arrival when possible.

Related binder handouts: STH-006 for the animal inventory and care worksheet; EVS-004 for routes; EVS-005 for transport; EVS-007 for sheltering in place.

SOURCES

Guidance: CDC, Pet Safety in Emergencies; City of La Habra Heights, Be Informed. Accessed October 29, 2026.

DRAFT

Pack a Three Day Pet Go Kit

Pack for each pet's full food, water, medication, and care needs for 72 hours away from home. Store supplies where they can leave with you.

- ☐ **Food:** three days of the usual diet, labeled portions and feeding instructions, bowls, and a manual can opener if needed. Include special diets and species-specific feed.
- ☐ **Water:** three days of safe drinking water for every pet, plus water needed for food preparation or care. Ask your veterinarian about amounts for your animals; needs vary with species, size, health, and temperature.
- ☐ **Medication:** at least three days of prescribed medicines and administration supplies, labeled directions, prescription details, and a refill contact. Ask the veterinarian about refrigeration and power outages before an emergency.
- ☐ **Containment:** labeled carriers or kennels, secure latches, leash and harness where appropriate, and a backup restraint. Pets need space and ventilation suitable for the species.
- ☐ **Identification and records:** current photos, medical and vaccination records, microchip and owner details, emergency contacts, and written care instructions.
- ☐ **Sanitation:** waste bags, absorbent liners, litter and a portable pan where needed, bedding, paper towels, gloves, and cleaning supplies safe for the species.
- ☐ **Comfort and handling:** familiar bedding, a towel, and a suitable comfort item. Include species-specific habitat and handling supplies listed on the next page.
- ☐ **Health and power:** a pet first-aid kit and instructions, chargers or batteries for essential equipment, and a safe backup plan for powered habitat or medical equipment.

PLAN IF DISPLACEMENT LASTS LONGER

Three days is this handout's planning period, not a limit on how long evacuation may last. CDC recommends a two-week supply of pet food, water, and medications in its disaster kit guidance. Keep additional reserves when feasible and plan how to obtain refills, specialty feed, and habitat supplies if return is delayed.

Medication safety: give only medicines prescribed for that animal, following veterinary directions.

SOURCES

Kit guidance: CDC, Build a Pet Disaster Preparedness Kit. Accessed October 29, 2026. The three-day displacement period is the binder's planning choice.

DRAFT

Prepare for Each Kind of Pet

A leash or standard dog kennel will not meet every pet's needs. Plan transport, temporary housing, and power needs for the actual species you keep.

Pet	Transport and temporary care
Dogs	Use a secure leash and well-fitted harness or collar; prepare a suitable kennel for transport and center requirements. Keep identification attached. Record bite risk, fear triggers, and handling needs.
Cats	Prepare a secure, ventilated carrier for each cat. Practice carrier use before an emergency. Pack litter supplies; open carriers only in a secure enclosed space approved by the receiving site.
Birds	Use a secure travel cage or carrier. Remove unsecured objects that could injure the bird during travel. Pack familiar feed, water equipment, and cage liners. Protect ventilation and avoid smoke, fumes, and temperature extremes.
Rabbits, guinea pigs, rodents, ferrets, and other small mammals	Use an escape-resistant carrier suited to the animal. Pack the normal diet, hay where required, bedding, and familiar feeding and watering equipment. Separate incompatible animals.
Reptiles and amphibians	Arrange secure species-specific transport and housing. Record required temperature, humidity, lighting, diet, and safe handling. Plan temperature monitoring and a safe source of heat or power; prevent direct contact with heat sources.
Fish and aquatic pets	Develop a species-specific transport plan with an aquatic veterinarian or knowledgeable aquarium specialist. Prepare suitable containers and a plan for water quality, oxygen, temperature, and backup power. Do not assume a full aquarium can be moved safely.
Other non-livestock pets	Identify containment, handling, diet, environmental needs, and a suitable receiving location in advance. Confirm acceptance of unusual or potentially dangerous species directly with the site.

Service animals: keep the animal with its handler whenever possible. Tell transport and center staff that it is a service animal; service-animal access differs from pet intake. See STH-006 for planning with the handler.

SOURCES

Species guidance: AVMA, Save the Whole Family; ASPCA, Disaster Preparedness. Accessed October 29, 2026. Arrange individual veterinary instructions for specialized care.

DRAFT

Evacuate and Care for Pets Away from Home

EVACUATION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Follow official protective instructions. If safe, confirm the announced center and route; use your alternate if directed. Do not delay escape to make calls.
- ☐ Secure pets in appropriate carriers or restraints before opening exterior doors. Keep incompatible animals separate. Take your pet roster, go kit, records, and medications.
- ☐ Secure carriers in the passenger area according to equipment instructions. Maintain ventilation and safe temperatures. Never put pets in a closed trunk or leave them unattended in a parked vehicle.
- ☐ Count and identify every pet as it leaves. If safe and time permits, update the window notice with remaining, evacuated, and unaccounted-for animals and the time.
- ☐ Leave by the safe route officials direct. Keep carriers closed during travel. Report animals left behind from a safe location; never re-enter a restricted area.

AT THE EVACUATION CENTER

- ☐ Check in and recount pets. Tell staff about species, handling risks, medical needs, and any suspected smoke, floodwater, or chemical exposure before intake. Ask for veterinary help when needed.
- ☐ Follow leash, kennel, separation, sanitation, and feeding rules. Confirm whether pets stay with owners or in a separate area and who provides daily care.
- ☐ If care is transferred, record each animal's identification, receiving person or organization, location, phone, time, and reunification instructions. Obtain an intake record.
- ☐ Give food, water, and prescribed medicines on schedule; record doses. Provide a quiet area when available. Wash hands after handling animals, equipment, or waste.

Seek urgent veterinary help for trouble breathing, collapse, burns, major injury, seizures, or suspected poisoning. Notify center staff immediately. Do not improvise treatment or decontamination with household chemicals.

SOURCES

CDC, Pet Safety in Emergencies. Accessed October 29, 2026.

EVS-011

Missing Pets and Returning Home

IF A PET IS MISSING OR STILL AT THE PROPERTY

Report the address, species, number, description, last known location and time, and handling risks to the incident's animal-assistance contact. Share photos and microchip details. Check designated animal shelters and lost-pet systems. A window notice provides information; it does not submit a rescue request or guarantee rescue.

La Habra Heights contracts with Los Angeles County Animal Care and Control. Use the City's Animal Control page for service and lost-pet information. Incident-specific intake locations may differ.

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

[VERIFY] Incident animal-assistance contact / phone: _____
Animal intake location / phone announced for this incident: _____

RETURN SAFELY

Return only when officials allow it. Before releasing pets indoors or into a yard, check for damaged fencing, broken glass, ash, chemicals, standing water, and other hazards. Keep pets restrained while checking the area. Monitor their health and behavior, replace supplies, and update the plan and window notice. Use EVS-009 for more return guidance.

SOURCES

Guidance: CDC, Pet Safety in Emergencies; AVMA, Save the Whole Family; City of La Habra Heights, Animal Control. Accessed October 29, 2026.

DRAFT

Household Pet Plan Worksheet

Keep this completed worksheet with your go kit. Copy the care section for each pet. This is a private planning sheet, separate from the public window notice.

HOUSEHOLD ARRANGEMENTS

Primary handler / phone: _____
Backup handler / phone: _____
Driver / vehicle: _____
Backup transport / phone: _____
Early departure trigger: _____
Primary destination / contact: _____
Alternate destination / contact: _____
Routes / map kept at: _____
Regular veterinarian / phone: _____
Emergency veterinarian / phone: _____

WRITE CARE INSTRUCTIONS FOR EACH PET

Name / species: _____
Carrier and equipment location: _____
Food / amount / times: _____
Medicine / dose / route / times: _____
Last dose given: _____
Temperature / habitat / power needs: _____
Handling risks / hiding places: _____
Veterinary contact / special instructions: _____

CALCULATE AND RECORD THE QUANTITIES

Item	Daily amount for all pets	Amount packed for three days
Food by pet or diet	_____	_____
Drinking and care water	_____	_____
Each medicine and supplies	_____	_____
Litter, bedding, liners	_____	_____

Kit location: _____
Items to add at departure: _____
Earliest expiration / next check: _____

DRAFT

EVS-011

Animals on This Property

Photocopy this page for emergency responders. Use dark ink. Display facing outward in a visible window near the main entrance.

Property address / unit: _____
Updated date and time: _____
Contact name / phone: _____
Alternate contact / phone: _____

ANIMAL COUNTS AS OF THE TIME ABOVE

Enter a number in every applicable box, including zero. “Unaccounted for” means location is unknown. Add a separate row for each other species.

Type of animal	Still on or in property	Evacuated	Unaccounted for
Dogs	_____	_____	_____
Cats	_____	_____	_____
Birds	_____	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____	_____
TOTAL	_____	_____	_____

☐ **ALL ANIMALS EVACUATED** — check only after confirming every animal is off the property.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Animal names and descriptions; last known rooms, enclosures, or hiding places; medical needs; handling or bite risks; other information for responders.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Veterinarian / phone optional: _____

Update only if safe. Never delay escape or return to danger to change this notice. Report animals left behind through official channels from safety. This notice is not a rescue request and does not guarantee rescue.

Keep keys, access codes, and private travel details off this public notice. Print this page single-sided; leave its reverse blank.

Sandbags for Home Runoff

Fill sandbags efficiently using a multi-bag filling fixture.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Sandbags can redirect shallow stormwater runoff from vulnerable areas of your property. They work best when placed before heavy rain arrives.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

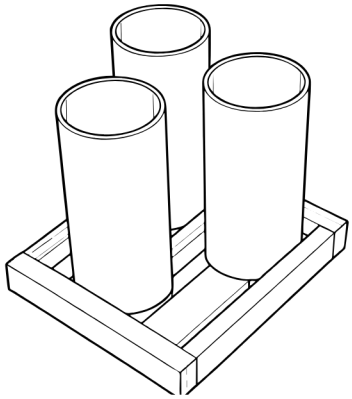
- Empty woven sandbags
- Clean sand or suitable granular fill
- Multi-bag filling fixture
- Shovel
- Gloves and sturdy footwear
- Eye protection when sand is dusty
- A clear, level work area
- A partner for lifting

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

A filled bag may weigh 35–40 lb. Use a partner or lighter bags if needed. Work on level, dry ground; keep hands and feet clear when lifting the fixture. Leave bags one-half to two-thirds full, with fabric to fold underneath; remove excess sand.

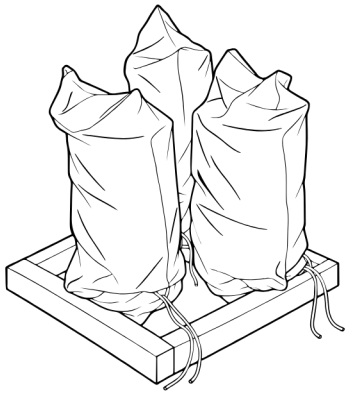
FILL SANDBAGS WITH THE FIXTURE

1 **Invert the fixture.**



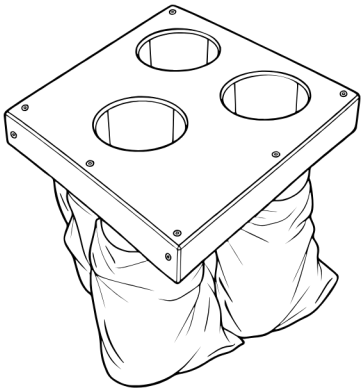
1. Invert the fixture.

2 **Put a sandbag on each pipe.**



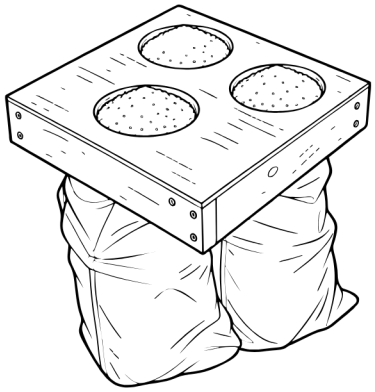
2. Put a sandbag on each pipe.

3 **Turn the fixture right side up.**



3. Turn the fixture right side up.

4 **Fill the fixture openings with sand.**



4. Fill to the top with sand.

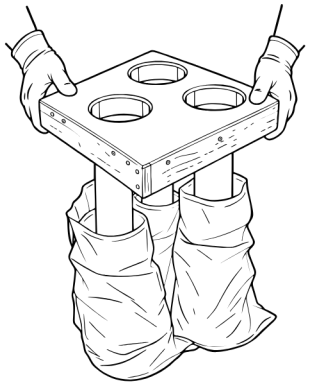
SKL-001

Sandbags for Home Runoff — continued

Remove filled bags, shape them for placement, and store them safely.

COMPLETE THE FILLING CYCLE

5 **Lift the fixture and leave the sand in the bags.** Use a partner and lift together.



5. Lift straight up. Let the filled bags remain on the ground.

6 **Set the fixture upside down.**



6. Reset the fixture for more sandbags.

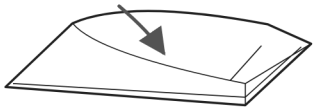
7 **Move the sandbags away.**



Four sandbags lying in a row.

SHAPE AND FOLD THE BAGS

8 **Flatten sand toward the closed end.**



8. Flatten the sand toward the closed end.

9 **Fold the empty end underneath.** Do not tie barrier bags.



9. Fold the empty end underneath.

STORE FILLED SANDBAGS

- Stack low on a pallet or stable support.
- Protect from sun and weather.
- Keep driveways and exits clear.
- Inspect for damage before use.



Sandbags should rotate 90-degrees at each layer to interleave like bricks with the bags below

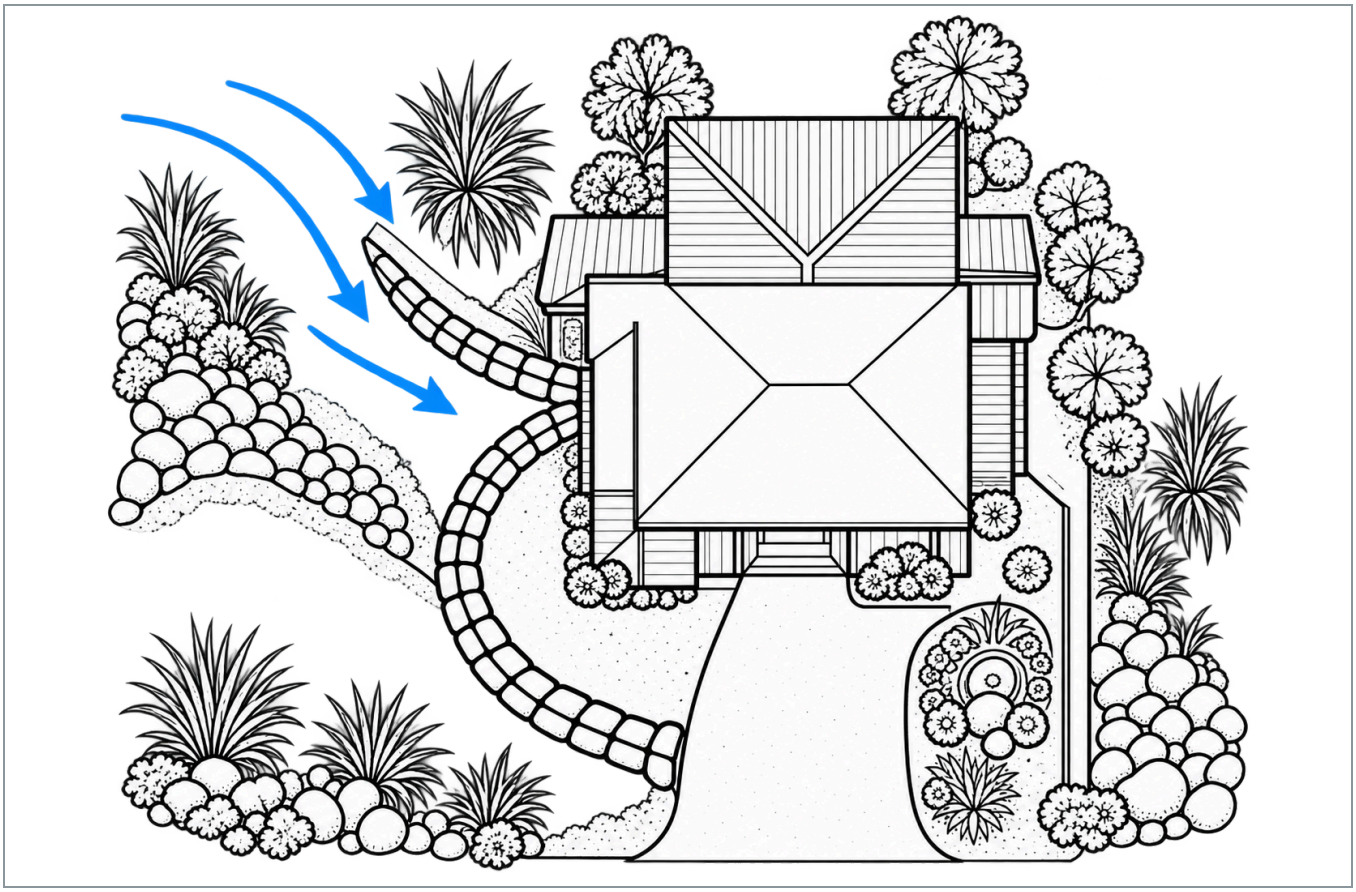
SKL-001

Planning a Sandbag Barrier

Understand where water comes from and where it can safely go.

FIRST, OBSERVE THE WATER'S PATH

1. **Where is the water coming from?** Look for runoff from hillsides, driveways, roofs, and low areas.
2. **What needs protection?** Identify vulnerable doors, garages, low windows, and openings.
3. **Where can the water safely go?** Find an existing drainage path on your property.



Use sandbags to redirect water to a safe outlet. Do not dump your water into your neighbors lawn.

SELECT THE BARRIER LOCATION

- Place bags on firm, level ground.
- Intercept runoff before it reaches the opening.
- Use a short line that redirects water.
- Keep drains, exits, and access routes open.
- Do not redirect runoff toward a neighbor, road, or another doorway.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Leave if water is moving fast, rising around you, or cutting off your exit. Do not enter flowing water or build beside an unstable slope or wall.

SKL-001

DRAFT

Building a Sandbag Barrier

Overlap bags, stagger joints, and maintain a stable base.

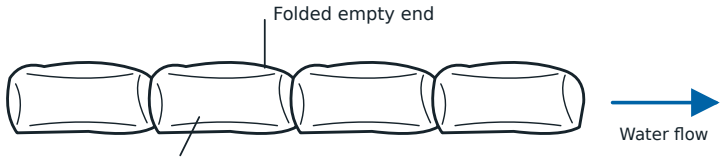
SKL-001

PREPARE THE GROUND

1. **Clear the area.** Remove loose debris and fill low spots.
2. **Establish the line.** Identify the water-facing side and intended direction of flow.

PLACE THE FIRST COURSE

3. **Lay bags flat.** Fold the empty end underneath and toward incoming water.
4. **Overlap adjoining bags.** Lay the filled part over the previous bag's empty end.
5. **Seat the bags.** Press or tamp firmly to reduce gaps.



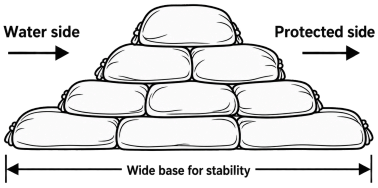
Top view — overlap adjoining bags.

ADD ADDITIONAL COURSES

6. **Stagger every course.** Offset joints by about half a bag.
7. **Maintain a wide base.** Keep the barrier low with a stable, stepped profile.
8. **Check the ends.** Connect to suitable higher ground or provide a safe outlet.



Sandbags staggered around a basement window.



As you increase the height of a dyke, increase the width of the dyke as well.

INSPECT THE FINISHED BARRIER

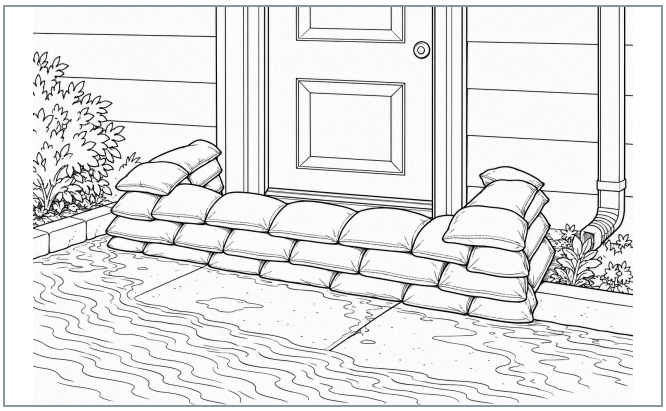
- Check for gaps, uncovered joints, and displaced bags.
- Look for water flowing around the ends or pooling behind the line.
- Sandbags are temporary and do not form a watertight seal.

Protecting Vulnerable Openings

Choose the barrier arrangement that fits the runoff problem.

A. EXTERIOR DOORWAYS

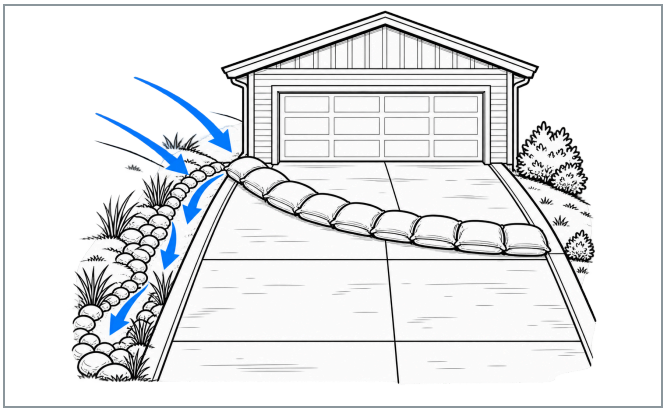
- Place a short, low barrier before water reaches the threshold.
- Extend it beyond both sides of the opening.
- Avoid blocking the only safe exit.
- Check for water entering around the ends or through other openings.
- Do not rely on sandbags to make a doorway watertight.



Doorway protection. Keep another safe exit available.

B. GARAGE DOORS AND SLOPING DRIVEWAYS

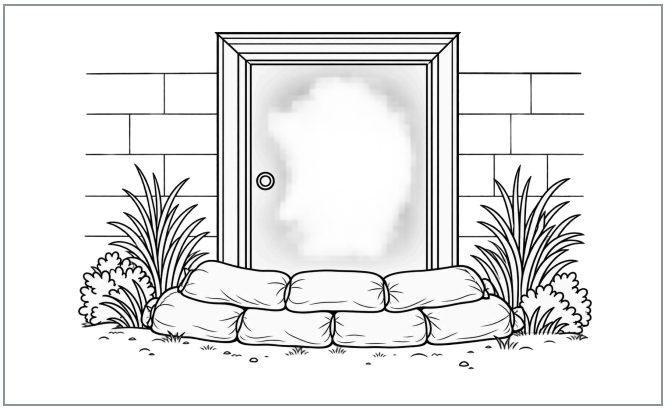
- Intercept runoff uphill of the garage door.
- Use an angled or curved line to redirect water.
- Lead water to an existing suitable drainage path.
- Avoid directing water toward a neighbor, road, or other doorway.
- Keep the evacuation route open.



Use sandbags to divert water flow along safe paths. If it overtops the sandbags, give it a safe location for the water to flow.

C. LOW WINDOWS AND UTILITY OPENINGS

- Identify low windows, window wells, and utility penetrations.
- Use a low diversion barrier to reduce surface runoff.
- Keep required ventilation, window escape routes, and utility access clear.



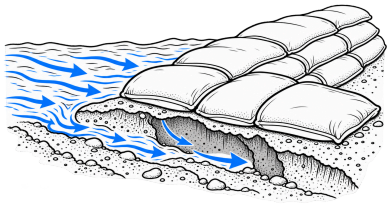
If you place sandbags around a door, give yourself enough room to enter and exit.

Understanding Water Movement

Recognize bypass, seepage, and unintended pooling.

1. WATER FLOWING AROUND THE ENDS

A line that stops below higher ground may send water around its end.



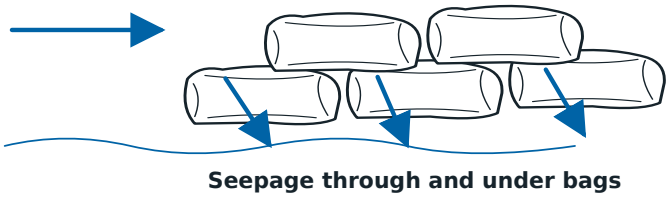
Fast moving water is undermining a sandbag installation

What to do

- Extend or adjust the line only from safe, dry ground.
- Use suitable higher ground or an existing safe outlet.

2. WATER SEEPING THROUGH THE BARRIER

Water can pass between bags, through fabric, and underneath.



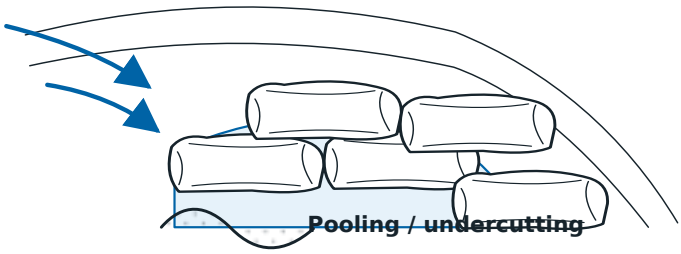
Water seeping through the barrier.

What to do

- Seat bags firmly and cover joints.
- Follow local guidance for water-side plastic sheeting.
- Inspect for leakage from safe ground.

3. WATER POOLING BEHIND THE BARRIER

A poorly placed barrier can trap water on the protected side.



Water pooling behind the barrier.

What to do

- Do not work in flowing water or on unstable ground.
- Move to safety if erosion, displacement, or a rapid rise occurs.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Leave if conditions become unsafe. Undercutting, displaced bags, or rising water can cause the barrier to fail.

Sandbag Mistakes to Avoid

Six common errors that reduce protection.

1. Aligned vertical joints

× WRONG



Aligned joints

✓ RIGHT

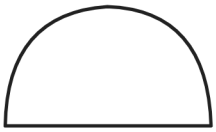


Offset joints

bag joints line up vertically. the upper bag bridges the joint below.

2. Overfilled bags

× WRONG



Overfilled and rounded

✓ RIGHT



Partly filled and flexible

an overfilled rounded bag cannot settle tightly. a partly filled bag lies flat and remains flexible.

3. Tall, narrow stacks

× WRONG



Tall, narrow base

✓ RIGHT

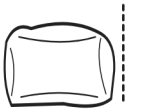


Wide, stepped base

four bags form a narrow column. a low stepped stack has a broad stable base.

4. Open gaps and loose ends

× WRONG



Gaps and loose ends

✓ RIGHT

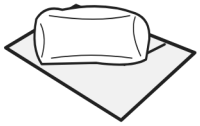


Overlap and fold tails

separated bags leave a gap. flattened bags overlap with empty ends folded underneath.

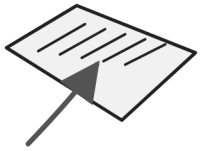
5. Blocking drainage

× WRONG



Drain blocked

✓ RIGHT

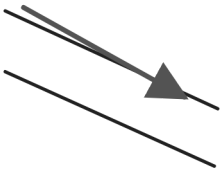


Keep drains open

a sandbag blocks a drain grate. the drain is clear, with a labeled runoff arrow entering it.

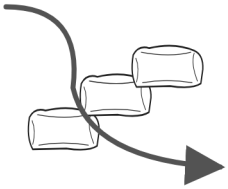
6. Unsafe diversion

× WRONG



Toward neighbor / road

✓ RIGHT



To a safe outlet

runoff arrows point toward a neighbor or road. a low line steers water to an existing safe outlet on the property.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Keep exits open. Do not work in moving water or build beside an unstable wall or slope. Leave if conditions become unsafe.

DRAFT

Sandbag Field Checklist

Prepare early, inspect safely, and remove temporary barriers when conditions permit.

BEFORE THE STORM

- ☐ Identify vulnerable openings and runoff paths.
- ☐ Locate a safe, functioning drainage route.
- ☐ Clear accessible drains and drainage channels.
- ☐ Obtain sandbags, sand, and necessary tools.
- ☐ Fill and stage bags on stable ground.
- ☐ Build the diversion before water arrives.
- ☐ Check that exits remain accessible.

DURING THE STORM

- ☐ Observe runoff from a safe location.
- ☐ Watch for water bypassing the barrier.
- ☐ Check for unexpected pooling or seepage.
- ☐ Stay away from moving water and unstable slopes.
- ☐ Stop work and leave if conditions become dangerous.



Inspect from safe ground; keep exits open.

SKL-001

AFTER THE STORM

- ☐ Wait until conditions are safe before approaching.
- ☐ Inspect for erosion, unstable ground, and displaced bags.
- ☐ Remove temporary barriers when no longer needed.
- ☐ Do not dump used sand into drains or natural channels.
- ☐ Follow local disposal guidance for wet or contaminated bags.
- ☐ Correct drainage problems before the next storm.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Sandbags redirect and slow water; they do not make a home floodproof. Do not enter floodwater, approach unstable slopes, or stay in a threatened structure to maintain a barrier.

SOURCES

U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, St. Paul District. *Flood Fight Handbook* (2022), §§2.1–2.3. Flood Fight Handbook PDF.
RiverOakRanch. “Filling Sandbags the Easy Way, With Sandbag Tubes” (2010), Instructables. Fixture instructions. Both sources accessed 2026-09-24.

DRAFT

Fire Extinguisher Check and Use

Know where the extinguisher is, what it can put out, and whether it appears ready—before an emergency.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

The device label controls. Extinguisher classifications, operating steps, inspection details, limits, and service lives vary. Read and follow the label and manufacturer instructions for the exact unit. If they differ from this handout, follow the device.

FIND AND IDENTIFY THE EXTINGUISHER

1. **Locate it:** It should be mounted or stored where it is visible, easy to reach, and not blocked. Do not move it from its designated location except for use or service.

2. **Read the front label:** Find the listed fire classifications and pictograms. Use it only on a fire type the label says it can extinguish. Common U.S. labels may show **A** (ordinary combustibles), **B** (flammable liquids), **C** (energized electrical equipment), **D** (combustible metals), or **K** (cooking oils/fats)—but the markings on this extinguisher decide.

3. **Read all instructions:** Find its operating directions, warnings, effective range, and any maintenance or disposal directions. Know whether the unit is rechargeable or disposable. Never test-discharge it during a visual check.

MAKE A MONTHLY VISUAL CHECK

A visual check does not replace maintenance or service required by the manufacturer, local rules, or the authority having jurisdiction.

- ☐ **Access:** unit is in its assigned place, visible, unobstructed, and securely mounted.
- ☐ **Pressure/readiness:** gauge or indicator—if fitted—is in the label's operable range.
- ☐ **Pin and seal:** pull pin is present; tamper seal is intact; nothing prevents operation.
- ☐ **Hose/nozzle:** attached, unobstructed, and free of cracks or other visible damage.
- ☐ **Body and label:** no leakage, corrosion, dents, or other damage; label is present and readable.

Do not use a questionable unit. If a check fails—or the extinguisher was discharged, even briefly—mark the issue and arrange qualified service or replacement according to its label and local requirements.

SKL-002

Fire Extinguisher Check and Use — continued

RECORD THE CHECK

Extinguisher/location	Date	Initials	Result and action taken
_____	_____	_____	☐ OK ☐ Service/replace: _____
_____	_____	_____	☐ OK ☐ Service/replace: _____

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Approval hold: A fire-service professional or other qualified fire-safety subject-matter expert must review this handout before approval.

SOURCES

Sources: U.S. Fire Administration, “Choosing and Using Fire Extinguishers”; National Fire Protection Association, “Fire Extinguishers”; and the product-specific extinguisher label and manufacturer instructions. Accessed 2026-09-29.

Fire Extinguisher Check and Use — continued

Use an extinguisher only on a small, contained fire when everyone else is leaving, emergency services have been called, and you have a clear escape.

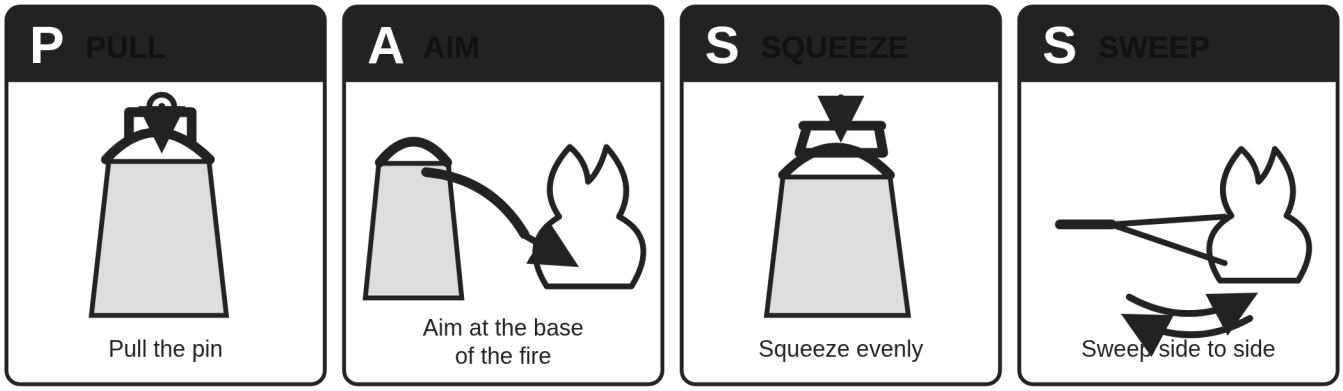
✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Life safety comes first. Calling emergency services and leaving safely take priority over fighting a fire. If there is any doubt, close the door behind you if you can do so safely, get out, stay out, and call from outside.

BEFORE YOU TRY

Use the extinguisher only if you are trained and **all** of these remain true:

- ☐ The fire is small and contained.
- ☐ Smoke is not affecting visibility or breathing, and heat is not intense.
- ☐ The extinguisher label lists the fire type and you understand its directions.
- ☐ You can keep a clear exit behind you while staying within the label's operating range.



PASS is a memory aid. Use the exact operating directions and distance printed on the extinguisher.
Original Fire Watch diagram; see asset manifest.

SKL-002

Fire Extinguisher Check and Use — continued

P—A—S—S

1. **PULL** the pin, following the label directions.

2. **AIM** low, at the base of the fire—not at the flames above it.

3. **SQUEEZE** the handle slowly and evenly.

4. **SWEEP** the nozzle from side to side at the base. Watch the area; leave immediately if the fire does not go out or conditions change.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

STOP—EVACUATE NOW if the fire is spreading; smoke affects visibility or breathing; heat is intense; the correct extinguisher is unavailable; or the exit cannot remain behind you. Never let fire, smoke, or your attempt to extinguish the fire block your way out.

After any use: get outside, report what happened to responding firefighters, and do not re-enter. Arrange recharge, qualified service, or replacement as the manufacturer directs.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Approval hold: A fire-service professional or other qualified fire-safety subject-matter expert must review this handout before approval.

SOURCES

Sources: U.S. Fire Administration, “Choosing and Using Fire Extinguishers”; National Fire Protection Association, “Fire Extinguishers”; and the product-specific extinguisher label and manufacturer instructions. Accessed 2026-09-29.

DRAFT

Practice Finding Utility Shutoffs

Learn where your controls are before an emergency. This is a **look, label, photograph, and explain** drill—not a reason to interrupt service.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Do not operate a control just to practice. Never open or remove equipment covers, break a utility seal, enter a restricted area, or guess. Ask the utility or a qualified electrician or plumber to identify an uncertain control and demonstrate any permitted action.

BEFORE YOU WALK AROUND

- ☐ Tell everyone this is a no-shutoff walk-through. Bring this sheet, a phone or camera, a permanent label, and a flashlight.
- ☐ Have an adult who can reach the control safely attend. Plan assistance or an alternate person if strength, vision, mobility, or dexterity could make access difficult.
- ☐ Use only a provider-approved tool of the correct size. Store it in a known, dry, accessible place near—but not attached to or obstructing—the equipment.
- ☐ Photograph a wide view showing the route and a close view showing the control and label. Do not photograph account numbers, keys, access codes, or other sensitive details.
- ☐ Keep the route clear. Make sure labels identify the correct home or unit without covering warnings, vents, meters, seals, or operating instructions.

SKL-003

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Stop the entire drill and keep away if there is fire, smoke, sparks, arcing, a gas odor, or hissing. Do not touch a switch, control, phone, garage-door opener, vehicle, flame, or anything else that could create a spark near a suspected gas leak. Leave by a safe route, warn others, and contact emergency services and the utility from a safe location.

Practice Finding Utility Shutoffs — continued

ELECTRICITY

Locate, record, and explain

1. From a dry, unobstructed position, locate the service panel and the main disconnect identified for your home. Multi-unit buildings may have controls managed by the owner or utility.
2. Read the existing label without opening an equipment cover. Ask a qualified electrician to correct missing, confusing, or mismatched labels.
3. Photograph the route, panel location, and main-disconnect label. Record the location below.
4. Point without touching and say: “This is the main electrical disconnect. In an emergency I will follow the utility, fire service, or electrician's instructions. I will approach only if the area and equipment are dry, intact, and free of fire or sparking.”

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Electricity stop conditions: Stop and keep away from a damaged, hot, buzzing, smoking, or exposed panel; standing water or wet equipment; sparks or arcing; fire; or a control you cannot reach without climbing, moving debris, entering a restricted space, or approaching another hazard. Do not touch the panel or use a tool. Call emergency services for immediate danger and notify the electric utility or a qualified electrician from a safe place.

Electric utility: _____ **Emergency number:** _____
Main disconnect location: _____
Required tool, if provider/electrician specifies one: _____
Photo saved/printed at: _____ **Date:** _____

SKL-003

Practice Finding Utility Shutoffs — continued

WATER

Locate, record, and explain

1. Locate the home's main water shutoff. Distinguish it from fixture valves, irrigation controls, fire-sprinkler controls, and any utility-owned street or meter valve.
2. Check that the route is clear and the label is readable. Do not enter a flooded space or force a buried, corroded, leaking, or stuck valve.
3. Photograph the route, a wide view, and the labeled control. Ask the water provider or a qualified plumber which control residents may operate and which tool, if any, is correct.
4. Point without turning and say: “This is my home water shutoff. I know which direction and tool the provider or plumber specifies. I will not operate a utility-owned or fire-suppression control unless authorized.”

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Water stop conditions: Stop if the control is inaccessible; submerged or surrounded by standing water; near exposed wiring or electrical equipment; damaged, leaking, badly corroded, or stuck; or if reaching it requires entering an unsafe space. Do not force it. Keep away from electrical hazards and call the water utility, property manager, or a qualified plumber; call emergency services for immediate danger.

Water utility: _____ **Emergency number:** _____
Home shutoff location: _____
Required tool, if provider/plumber specifies one: _____
Photo saved/printed at: _____ **Date:** _____

SKL-003

DRAFT

Practice Finding Utility Shutoffs — continued

NATURAL GAS

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Follow your gas utility provider's instructions about when to shut off gas. Rules and equipment vary. Do not shut off gas merely for this drill. If gas is shut off for any reason, **never turn gas service back on yourself**; only the utility or another professional specifically authorized by the utility may restore service and relight appliances.

Locate, record, and explain—without touching

1. Using the provider's information, identify the meter and resident-operable shutoff, if any, from a safe outdoor position. Do not confuse appliance valves with the service shutoff.
2. Do not touch or test the valve. Do not remove a cover, break a seal, dig, or enter a utility-only or locked area.
3. Photograph the safe approach, meter, and provider-identified shutoff without including the meter/account number. Record the provider-specified tool and keep it accessible only if the provider directs.
4. From well away from the equipment, say: “I will shut off gas only when my gas provider instructs me to do so. If I smell gas or hear hissing, I will leave without operating anything that could spark, then call from a safe location. I will never restore gas service myself.”

SKL-003

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Gas stop conditions: Stop, do not approach or touch the meter, and leave the area for any gas odor, hissing, damaged pipe or meter, fire, smoke, sparks, or inaccessible control. Do not search for the leak or attempt a repair. From a safe location, call emergency services and the gas utility as their instructions direct.

Gas utility: _____ **Emergency number:** _____
Provider-identified shutoff location: _____
Provider-required tool: _____
Photo saved/printed at: _____ **Date:** _____

Practice Finding Utility Shutoffs — continued

FINISH THE NO-SHUTOFF PRACTICE

1. Have another household member use the photos and written clues to locate each control without touching it.
2. Take turns describing who to call, the provider's conditions for shutoff, the safe approach, the correct tool, and every reason to stop.
3. Correct labels and access problems through the provider, property manager, or qualified trade professional. Do not modify utility equipment yourself.
4. Review after moving in, changing providers, remodeling, or learning that equipment or instructions changed. Replace outdated photographs.

HOUSEHOLD RECORD AND FUTURE HOME & UTILITIES SECTION

This hands-on sheet is for recognition and verbal rehearsal. Keep durable provider instructions, inspection or repair records, diagrams, account-safe contact information, and restoration planning in the future **Home & Utilities** section. When that section is added, it should refer back to this drill rather than duplicate the practice steps.

Practice partner: _____ **Practice date:** _____ **Next review:** _____
Accessible tool-storage location: _____
Person who can help or act if I cannot: _____

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

LOCAL PROVIDER DETAILS — [VERIFY] BEFORE USE OR PUBLICATION

[VERIFY] Electric provider's shutoff and emergency instructions: _____
[VERIFY] Water provider's resident-operable control, tool, and instructions: _____
[VERIFY] Gas provider's conditions for shutoff, approved tool, and emergency instructions: _____
[VERIFY] Local emergency number and fire-service instructions: _____

Do not fill this block from memory, a search result, or a neighbor's procedure. Confirm directly with each responsible provider or authority; record the representative or official source and date.

Verified by/source: _____ **Date:** _____

SKL-003

Practice Finding Utility Shutoffs — continued

REQUIRED TECHNICAL AND FIRE-SERVICE REVIEW

Do not approve or publish this handout until the reviews below are complete. Obtain review of the applicable controls, tools, stop conditions, emergency contacts, and local-info block from each relevant local utility. Where a utility will not review interior customer-owned equipment, obtain review from a qualified electrician for electrical content and a qualified plumber for water content. Also obtain a separate fire-service review of the emergency actions and fire, spark, and gas-leak language.

Electric utility / qualified electrician: _____ **Role/license:** _____
Water utility / qualified plumber: _____ **Role/license:** _____
Gas utility representative: _____ **Role:** _____
Fire-service reviewer: _____ **Agency/role:** _____
Review dates and corrections completed: _____

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Safety Skills”; Pacific Gas and Electric Company, “Natural Gas Safety.” Accessed 2026-09-29. Provider-specific procedures and contacts remain [VERIFY] pending the local reviews recorded above.

DRAFT

Put On and Check a Disposable Respirator

Use a genuine, NIOSH-approved disposable particulate respirator only when current public-health advice recommends one. Follow the instructions for your exact make and model.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Know its limits. This respirator filters particles; it **does not supply oxygen** and does **not protect against gases or vapors**. Leave immediately for cleaner air if you feel dizzy, faint, nauseated, confused, or short of breath.

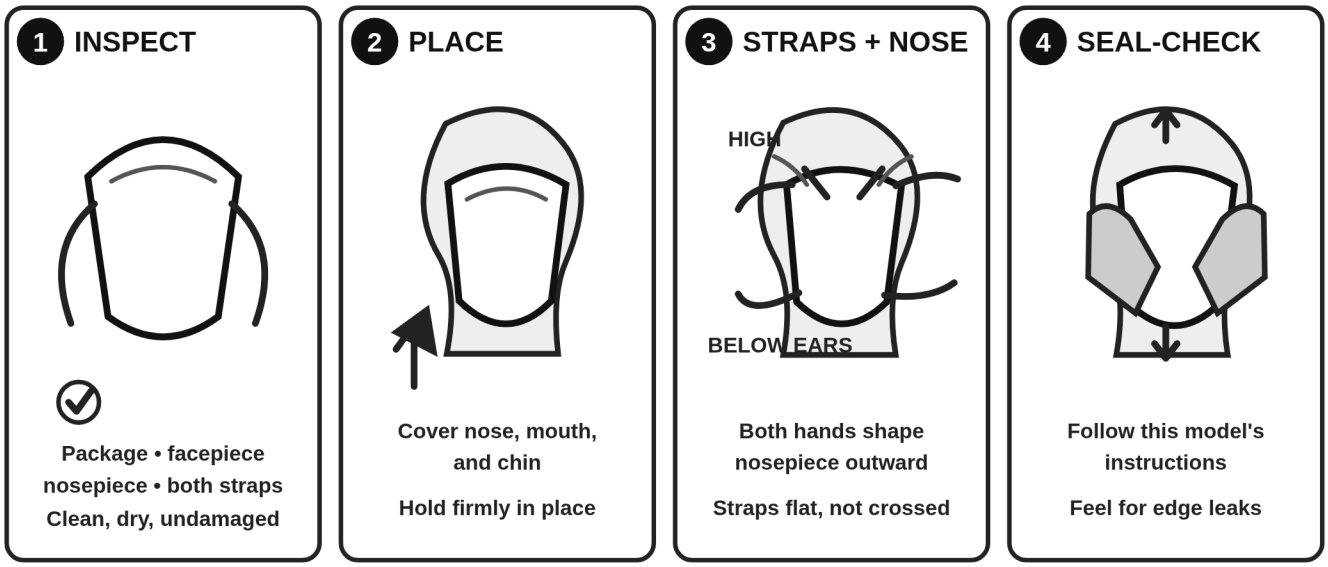
BEFORE YOU PUT IT ON

1. **Read the package.** Confirm the respirator is NIOSH approved, is the right model and size for you, and is within any marked shelf life. Find the model's donning and user seal-check instructions.

2. **Inspect it.** Use a clean, dry respirator. Check the facepiece, nosepiece, valves (if present), staples, and both straps. Do not use it if a part is missing, torn, stretched, cracked, soiled, or otherwise damaged.

3. **Clear the seal area.** Hair, jewelry, glasses, clothing, or anything else must not pass between skin and the sealing edge. Facial hair such as stubble, beards, or some mustaches can prevent a seal. Some face shapes or sizes may not seal with a particular model.

SKL-004



Inspect → place → position and shape → seal-check. Strap locations and the seal-check method can vary; use the manufacturer's instructions for your model.

Original diagram based on NIOSH guidance; see asset manifest.

Put On and Check a Disposable Respirator — continued

PUT IT ON

1. **Place:** Cup the respirator in your hand with the nosepiece at your fingertips and straps hanging free. Cover your **nose, mouth, and chin**; hold it firmly against your face.
2. **Position both straps:** Pull the **lower strap below your ears, around your neck**. Pull the **upper strap high on the back of your head**. Keep straps flat and untwisted. Do not cross them or put both around the ears unless the manufacturer specifically directs that arrangement.
3. **Shape:** Using fingertips from **both hands**, press the nosepiece inward while moving outward along both sides of your nose. Do not pinch it with one hand; that can leave gaps.

Put On and Check a Disposable Respirator — continued

A user seal check is required every time you put on the respirator. It is not the same as a workplace fit test.

CHECK THE SEAL EVERY TIME

1. **Use the model-specific method.** Follow the package or manufacturer instructions. The method may be a positive-pressure check, negative-pressure check, or another specified procedure. Do not invent a method.

2. **Usually, cover the filtering surface** with both hands without crushing or shifting it. For a respirator with a valve, the instructions may tell you to cover the valve instead.

3. **Breathe as directed** by the manufacturer—often a gentle exhale, inhale, or both. Feel around the entire sealing edge, especially at the nose and chin.

Pass or fail?

Seal passes	Seal fails
The facepiece responds as the instructions describe, and no air leaks around its edges.	Air moves toward your eyes, fogs glasses, or leaks at the nose, cheeks, or chin; the facepiece shifts; or the model's check does not respond as described.

If it fails: adjust the nosepiece and straps, reposition the respirator, and repeat the same check. If it still leaks, try another NIOSH-approved model or size. **Do not enter or remain in smoky or contaminated air without a seal. Move to cleaner air and follow current local public-health advice.**

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Do not improvise. Do not knot, staple, cut, tape, or add material to the respirator to force a fit. Do not wear a second respirator over it unless its manufacturer specifically allows that use.

Put On and Check a Disposable Respirator — continued

REPLACE IT—AND KNOW WHEN TO GET HELP

- **Replace and discard** the respirator when it becomes wet, dirty, damaged, contaminated, misshapen, or difficult to breathe through, or when its straps no longer hold a seal. Replace it whenever the manufacturer directs. Do not wash or disinfect a disposable respirator.
- **Children:** Adult respirators may not fit children, and NIOSH does not approve respirators specifically for children. A child who cannot obtain and maintain a seal should be moved to cleaner air; a caregiver should follow current local public-health and pediatric guidance rather than alter the respirator.
- **Breathing or heart conditions:** A respirator can make breathing harder. Ask a health-care professional before use if you have a breathing or heart condition, and follow current public-health advice. Remove it and seek cleaner air if breathing becomes difficult; seek urgent help for severe symptoms.
- **No seal:** Facial hair and some face shapes prevent an adequate seal with some models. If no available model seals, do not improvise. Reduce exposure, move to cleaner air, and contact your local public-health agency for current alternatives and instructions.

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

Review required before distribution: This draft requires review by a qualified medical/public-health subject-matter expert and an editor. Local recommendations can change; check Los Angeles County Public Health and CDC guidance for the present event.

SKL-004

SOURCES

Sources: NIOSH, *How to Use Your N95 Respirator* and *Particulate Respirators*; CDC, *Protecting Yourself from Wildfire Smoke*; Los Angeles County Department of Public Health, *Wildfire Smoke*. Accessed 2026-09-29.

DRAFT

Household Evacuation Drill Card

Practice moving everyone and essential equipment to a safe ready-to-leave point. This card tests the household plan; it does not replace it.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

Exercise only—stop for any real alert or danger. Drills must not imitate an official alert, block a road, create smoke or flames, or require unsafe lifting. Say “DRILL” in every spoken or written drill message. Stop immediately if anyone is distressed, an animal becomes unsafe, equipment could be damaged, or conditions change.

USE THE PLAN YOU ALREADY MADE

Review these handouts before scheduling the drill. Correct the plan there rather than copying it onto this card.

- **EVS-001** — readiness, contacts, meeting places, and final leave-now check
- **EVS-002** — go-bags, medicines, documents, power, and essential equipment
- **EVS-003** — local evacuation terms, decision points, and when to leave
- **EVS-004** — two routes, destinations, and a safe place to pause
- **EVS-005** — primary and backup transportation, pickup, loading, and access
- **EVS-006** — children, caregivers, animals, handlers, and loading practice

Household / location: _____ **Drill date:** _____

Observer / timekeeper: _____ **Planned stop point:** _____

SKL-005

BEFORE-DRILL CHECKLIST

- ☐ The six EVS handouts above are current, and every participant knows this is a future exercise even though the start time will be unannounced.
- ☐ A responsible organizer chose a calm practice window, checked weather and surroundings, and told neighbors or building staff if the activity might concern them.
- ☐ The organizer selected an unmistakable household-only cue containing the word **“DRILL”**; it does not copy an alert tone, siren, sender name, message format, evacuation order, or emergency-service wording.
- ☐ Every participant may pause or opt out. Children and people who could be distressed know what “DRILL” means; no surprise cue will be used for anyone who needs advance notice.
- ☐ The stop point is on private property or another permitted safe area **before any sidewalk crossing, public road, traffic lane, or vehicle movement into traffic**.
- ☐ Exits and accessible paths are clear. The drill uses no smoke, flame, damaged route, live hazard, road obstruction, unsafe transfer, or lift beyond a person's training and ability.
- ☐ Phones remain available for real calls. The observer will cancel the drill for a real alert, emergency, injury, distress, unsafe animal behavior, or blocked safe exit.

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

ASSIGN HOUSEHOLD ROLES

Assign a backup for every essential role. One person may hold more than one role only if the timed practice shows that is workable.

Role	Primary	Backup	Task in this drill
Lead / account for people	_____	_____	Give the drill cue; check names at stop point
Children / dependents	_____	_____	Gather, reassure, and supervise
Animals	_____	_____	Use practiced carrier or restraint
Medicines / medical supplies	_____	_____	Retrieve only the prepared set
Mobility / communication equipment	_____	_____	Bring device, aids, power, and instructions
Go-bags / keys / documents	_____	_____	Move staged essentials without overloading
Transportation assistance	_____	_____	Make the practice request; confirm pickup plan
Observer / timekeeper	_____	_____	Record times and stop unsafe activity

RUN THE DRILL

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Unannounced simulated alert: At an unannounced time within the agreed practice window, the organizer says or sends: **“DRILL—household evacuation practice. Use our plan now.”** Do not broadcast it publicly or use emergency tones, sirens, agency names, or official-alert styling.

1. **Start and notify.** Timekeeper records the start. The lead gives the household-only cue. Everyone states or demonstrates their assigned action. **Start time:** _____
2. **Gather people.** Caregivers move household members by the practiced accessible path to the planned stop point. Account for everyone; do not search beyond the drill area. **People gathered:** _____
3. **Gather essential equipment.** Assigned people bring only staged go-bags, keys, medicines, communication and mobility aids, and animal equipment identified in EVS-002 and EVS-006. Do not add last-minute packing. **Equipment gathered:** _____
4. **Practice transport contact or loading.** Make only a prearranged practice call or text and begin safe loading in a legal, off-road location. Say “DRILL” to the helper. Do not summon emergency services or an unbriefed provider. **Contact / loading complete:** _____
5. **Stop before public traffic.** Stop at the named safe point before entering or crossing a public road, moving a vehicle into traffic, or beginning the planned route. Account for every person, animal, and essential item. **Ready-to-leave time:** _____

Total time from start to ready-to-leave: _____

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

This is the end of the drill. Do not drive the evacuation route as part of this card. If the household separately practices a route, plan that activity under ordinary traffic laws and the safety limits in EVS-004 and EVS-005.

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

CHOOSE THE VARIANTS YOUR HOUSEHOLD NEEDS

- ☐ **Children:** use simple words and a familiar adult; practice shoes, comfort or communication items, hand-holding, car seats, and the meeting point. Never hide or pretend a caregiver is missing.
- ☐ **Animals:** use the usual handler and species-appropriate carrier, leash, harness, or restraint. Practice calmly and stop for fear, aggression, escape risk, or unsafe lifting. Use EVS-006 for large-animal practice; do not improvise loading.
- ☐ **Mobility devices:** use the normal accessible path and trained assistance. Include device controls, charger or power, transfer aids, and securement notes. Never carry a person or device on stairs or perform a transfer unless the people involved are trained and it is routinely safe.
- ☐ **Medication:** retrieve the prepared, labeled supply or an empty practice container from its normal safe location. Maintain required security and temperature; do not delay or change a dose for the drill.
- ☐ **Transportation assistance:** practice the agreed call or message with a pre-briefed helper, including pickup entrance, passenger count, mobility-device space, animal capacity, and boarding support. Clearly say no actual pickup is requested unless one was scheduled.

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

AFTER-ACTION REVIEW

Talk immediately after the drill. Record observable problems, not blame.

Prompt	What happened?	Change to test next time
Communication failure: who missed or misunderstood the cue or role?	_____	_____
Blocked route: which door, path, gate, or stop point did not work?	_____	_____
Forgotten items: what essential prepared item was missed, and why?	_____	_____
Accessibility barrier: what prevented noticing, understanding, moving, communicating, transferring, loading, or waiting safely?	_____	_____

Obstacles discovered: _____

_____

Corrective actions, owner, and due date: _____

_____

Next practice date: _____ **One change to retest:** _____

REVIEW REQUIRED BEFORE APPROVAL

◎ **LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL**

Do not approve this exercise until both reviews are complete.

Accessibility reviewer: _____ **Organization / qualification:** _____

Reviewed routes, cues, roles, timing, assistance, and variants for accessibility barriers.

Required changes: _____ **Date:** _____ **Initials:** _____

Emergency-management or fire-service reviewer: _____ **Agency / role:** _____

Reviewed the simulated alert, stop point, traffic limits, fire safety, and conflict with local procedures.

Required changes: _____ **Date:** _____ **Initials:** _____

Changes completed by: _____ **Date:** _____ **Approval recorded by:** _____

Household Evacuation Drill Card — continued

SOURCES

Sources: Ready.gov, “Evacuation,” “Individuals with Disabilities,” and “Pets and Animals.” Accessed 2026-09-29. Use EVS-001 through EVS-006 for the household planning guidance this drill tests.

UNDER-REVIEW

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation

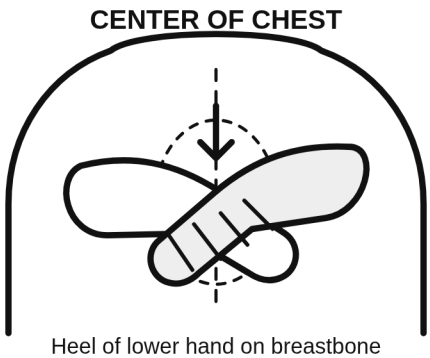
Practice with an instructor. This companion supports skills training and later review; it is not a course, a skills test, or CPR/AED certification.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Under review—do not publish as medical instruction. A currently qualified CPR/AED instructor or medical professional must review this handout before release. In an emergency, follow the emergency call-taker and AED prompts.

IF A TEEN OR ADULT SUDDENLY COLLAPSES

1. **Check the scene.** Stop and look for traffic, fire, electricity, violence, falling material, water, or other danger. Do not enter an unsafe scene. Use available protective equipment without delaying lifesaving care.
2. **Check response and breathing.** Tap both shoulders and shout. If the person does not respond and is not breathing normally—or is only gasping—treat this as cardiac arrest. Do not spend more than 10 seconds checking.
3. **Call and get an AED.** Call emergency services, or point to a specific person: “You—call **[VERIFY: local emergency number]** and bring the AED.” Put a mobile phone on speaker so the call-taker can coach you.
4. **Begin hands-only CPR.** Place the person face-up on a firm, flat surface. Kneel beside the chest. Put the heel of one hand in the center of the chest, place the other hand on top, and interlock your fingers.

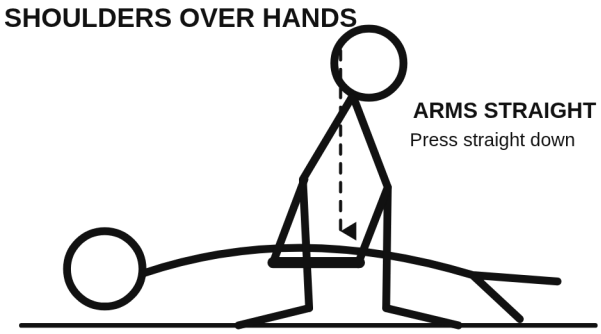


Hand position. Center of the chest, on the breastbone.
Original diagram checked against the 2025 AHA CPR/ECC Guidelines.

SKL-006

UNDER-REVIEW

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued



Body posture. Shoulders over straight arms; press vertically. Original diagram checked against the 2025 AHA CPR/ECC Guidelines.

PUSH HARD AND FAST

- Push straight down at **100–120 compressions a minute**.
- For an average adult, compress **at least 2 inches (5 cm)** but not more than 2.4 inches (6 cm).
- Let the chest return fully after every push. Keep pauses as short as possible.
- Continue until an AED tells you to pause, the person shows signs of life, trained help takes over, the scene becomes unsafe, or you are too exhausted to continue.

SKL-006

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Hands-only CPR is for a teen or adult who suddenly collapses. People trained and willing to give breaths should use the CPR method taught in their current course.

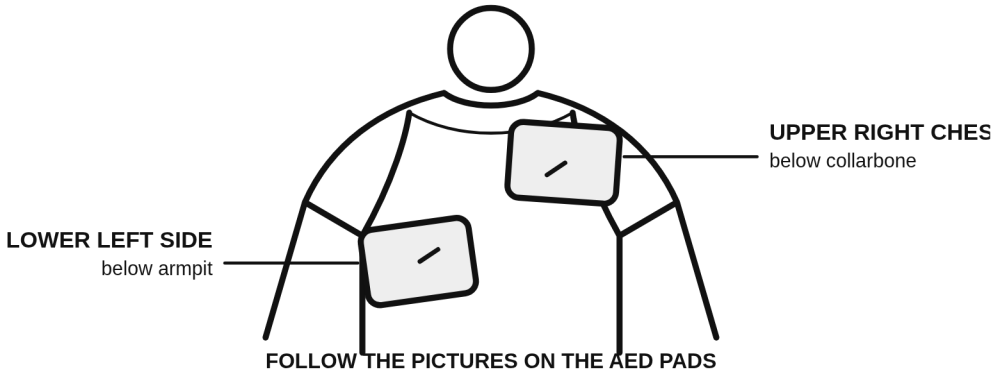
UNDER-REVIEW

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

Use an AED as soon as it arrives. It will analyze the heart rhythm and gives a shock only when indicated.

USE THE AED: TURN IT ON AND LISTEN

1. **Turn on the AED.** Open the lid or press the power button. Follow every visual and spoken prompt. Continue CPR while another rescuer prepares the AED, if possible.
2. **Bare and prepare the chest.** Remove clothing. If the chest is wet, dry it quickly. Use the AED kit and follow its prompts for medication patches or heavy chest hair; do not delay unnecessarily.
3. **Attach the pads.** Peel off the backing and press pads firmly to the bare chest exactly as the pictures on the pads show. Use adult pads for an adult.



Common adult anterolateral placement. One pad below the right collarbone; one on the lower left side below the armpit. The pictures on the actual pads control.
Original diagram checked against the 2025 AHA CPR/ECC Guidelines.

SKL-006

1. **Clear for analysis.** Say “Clear!” and make sure nobody is touching the person while the AED analyzes.
2. **If a shock is advised, clear again.** Look from head to toe, loudly say “Clear,” and make sure nobody is touching the person. Press the flashing shock button if prompted. A fully automatic AED may deliver the shock itself.
3. **Resume CPR immediately.** Start compressions again and follow the AED prompts. Keep going until trained help takes over or the person shows signs of life. Leave pads attached.

△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

Water and electricity: do not use an AED while the person is in water or while you are standing in water. Move to a safe, dry surface if this can be done safely; dry the chest and follow the device prompts.

DIFFERENT EMERGENCIES NEED CURRENT TRAINING

Children and infants: Ages, techniques, compression depth, breaths, when to call, and pediatric AED use differ. Take a current pediatric CPR/AED course; do not use this adult quick sequence as pediatric instruction. Follow the call-taker and AED prompts in an emergency.

Drowning: Rescue breaths are especially important after drowning, and water rescue adds hazards. Take current drowning-response CPR and water-safety training. Never enter water unless trained and it is safe; call emergency services and follow the call-taker’s directions.

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

PRACTICE AND LOCALIZE BEFORE USE

- **Recommended:** instructor-led, hands-on practice with feedback manikins and AED trainers, followed by the course's required skills check.
- **Local course providers: [VERIFY: list current qualified CPR/AED course providers, registration links, languages, accessibility, and cost]**
- **Required technical review: [VERIFY: name, current CPR/AED instructor credential or medical qualification, credential expiration if applicable, and review date]**

Hands-Only CPR & AED Orientation — continued

SOURCES

Guideline edition used for content and all three diagrams: *2025 American Heart Association Guidelines for Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation and Emergency Cardiovascular Care*, published October 22, 2025: cpr.heart.org/en/resuscitation-science/cpr-and-ecc-guidelines. American Heart Association, “Hands-Only CPR”: cpr.heart.org/en/cpr-courses-and-kits/hands-only-cpr. Accessed 2026-09-29. Recheck against the current edition during required qualified review.

DRAFT

Severe Bleeding Response

A quick reminder after recognized STOP THE BLEED® or equivalent instructor-led training—not a substitute for hands-on practice.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Life-threatening bleeding is an emergency. Call 911 or your local emergency number now. Do not delay emergency activation to read this handout. Follow the dispatcher's instructions.

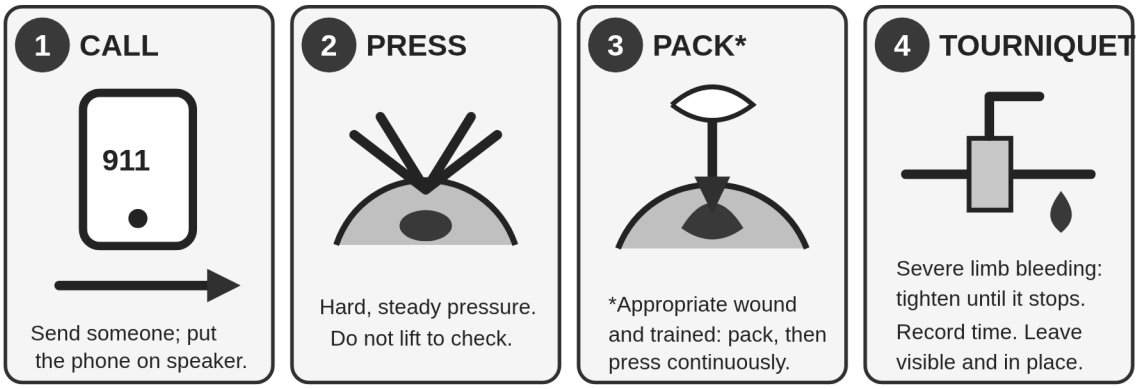
△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

DRAFT—DO NOT DISTRIBUTE FOR USE. A clinician or certified bleeding-control instructor must review the words and diagram before this handout moves beyond draft.

RECOGNIZE AND ACT

Suspect life-threatening bleeding when blood flows continuously or spurts, pools on the ground, soaks clothing or bandages, or when the person shows shock or confusion. Act immediately.

1. **Make the scene safe.** Do not enter traffic, fire, violence, electrical, structural, or other danger. Use disposable gloves and eye protection when available; do not delay lifesaving pressure if barriers are unavailable.
2. **Activate help.** Call emergency services, or point to a person and tell them to call and bring a bleeding-control kit. Put the phone on speaker if you are alone.
3. **Find and expose the injury.** Remove or cut clothing only as needed to see where blood is coming from. Check for more than one wound while protecting the person from cold.
4. **Press continuously.** Place gauze or a clean dressing directly on the bleeding site. Push hard with both hands and hold steady until bleeding stops or responders take over. Do not lift the dressing to check; add material on top if needed.



Call → press → pack if trained → tourniquet for a severely bleeding limb. The sequence follows medically reviewed American College of Surgeons STOP THE BLEED training resources; this local adaptation still requires clinician or certified-instructor review.

SKL-007

Severe Bleeding Response — continued

IF DIRECT PRESSURE DOES NOT CONTROL IT

Pack an appropriate wound—only if trained

For a deep wound where a tourniquet cannot be used, such as the groin, armpit, shoulder, or neck, tightly pack bleeding-control gauze into the wound to the bleeding source, then press hard and continuously. Use hemostatic gauze if your training and product directions support it; otherwise use gauze from the bleeding-control kit. **Do not pack the chest, abdomen, or an eye.** Do not remove packing.

Use a commercial tourniquet for severe arm or leg bleeding

1. Place a recognized **commercial tourniquet** 2–3 inches (5–8 cm) above the bleeding wound, between the wound and torso. Do not place it over the wound or a joint. If the wound cannot be located quickly, place it high and tight on the limb.
2. Pull the strap tight and fasten it. Twist the windlass until bleeding stops, then secure the windlass. It will hurt. If bleeding continues, tighten further or apply a second commercial tourniquet above the first if available and you are trained.
3. Write the application time below and on the tourniquet if it has a time field. Keep it uncovered and visible. Stay with the person, keep them warm, and monitor breathing until responders arrive.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Never remove an embedded object or probe a wound. Apply pressure around an embedded object. **Never** loosen, remove, or conceal an applied tourniquet; only emergency or medical professionals should remove it.

SKL-007

Equipment boundary: This handout recommends a recognized commercial tourniquet and purpose-made bleeding-control gauze. It does not teach or recommend improvised tourniquets or improvised wound-packing material.

RECORD AND HAND OVER

Responder information	Record
Tourniquet application time (include a.m./p.m.)	_____ : _____ a.m. / p.m.
Tourniquet location / number applied	_____
Other care given and changes observed	_____ _____
Care handed to (agency / responder)	_____
Handoff date and time	_____ _____ : _____

Tell responders: where every wound is; when each tourniquet was applied; whether the wound was packed; what products were used; and any changes in breathing, alertness, or bleeding.

SOURCES

American College of Surgeons, *STOP THE BLEED Resources—Posters and Booklet* and *STOP THE BLEED Online Training*: www.stopthebleed.org/resources-poster-booklet/ and www.stopthebleed.org/training/online-course/. Accessed 2026-09-29.

UNDER-REVIEW

Move Preparedness Supplies Safely

Plan before moving water containers, go-bags, sandbags, animal supplies, batteries, and other preparedness equipment. A lighter trip is usually the safer trip.

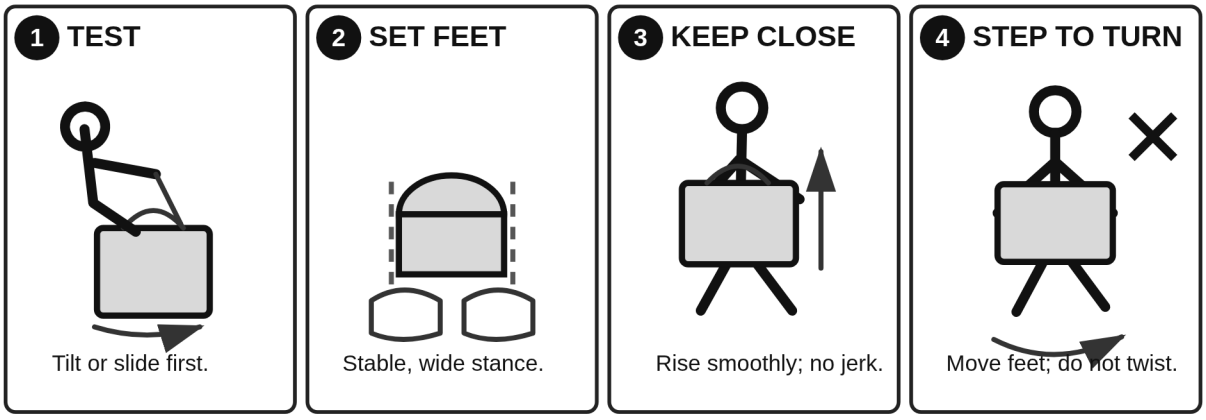
✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

STOP—do not lift or continue if the load shifts or is unstable; the route is wet, slippery, dark, steep, or obstructed; your grip is poor; or you feel pain, dizziness, shortness of breath, unusual weakness, or fatigue. Stop if the weight is beyond your capability. Set it down safely if you can—never try to “push through.”

BEFORE YOU LIFT

1. **Test without committing:** read a weight label if present, then push, tilt, or lift one edge a few centimeters. If it is hard to control, do not lift it.
2. **Make it smaller or lighter:** remove items; use smaller water containers; half-fill when appropriate; or divide food, animal feed, litter, and sandbags into more trips. Close lids and secure loose contents.
3. **Clear the whole route:** choose the shortest usable path. Remove cords, rugs, debris, and low obstacles. Open doors, turn on lights, secure pets, and identify a level set-down spot before starting.
4. **Choose an aid:** use a cart, hand truck, wagon, rolling bag, shoulder-height shelf, ramp, or other rated equipment when available. Keep loads low and secured; stay within the aid's rating. Do not ride on material-handling equipment.

LIFT AND CARRY



Test → set → hold close → step. The safest posture cannot make an over-heavy or unstable load safe.

Original Fire Watch diagram; technical basis: OSHA and NIOSH.

SKL-008

Move Preparedness Supplies Safely — continued

1. Wear secure, closed-toe footwear. Stand on firm, dry, stable footing with feet apart and one foot slightly forward. Get close to the load.
2. Use secure handles or opposite lower corners. Keep a neutral, comfortable back position; bend at the hips and knees as your abilities allow. Keep fingers away from pinch points.
3. Brace gently and rise smoothly with the load close to your body. Do not jerk. Keep the load between knee and shoulder height when practical, and keep your view clear.
4. **Never twist while holding the load.** Turn your whole body by taking small steps. Set down smoothly on a stable surface; protect fingers and toes.

UNDER-REVIEW

Move Preparedness Supplies Safely — continued

No universal “safe weight” applies to everyone. Size, shape, distance from the body, repetition, terrain, health, and individual capability all matter. When unsure, divide the load, use an aid, or ask for help.

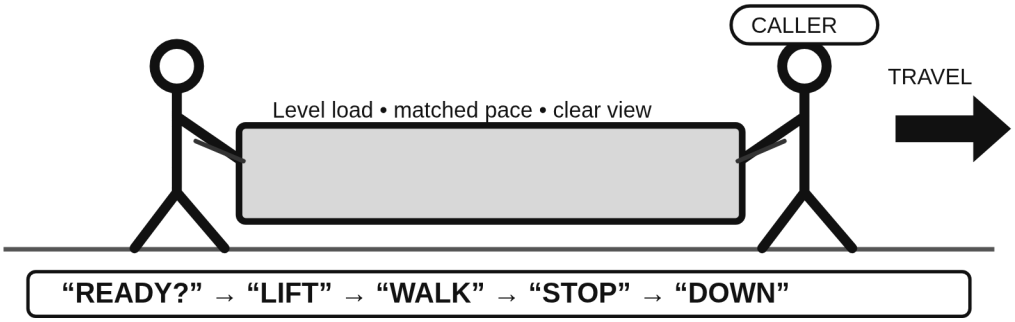
UNDER-REVIEW

Move Preparedness Supplies Safely — continued

Plan shared carries and accessible alternatives before an evacuation, outage, or storm makes the job urgent.

TWO-PERSON CARRY

1. Do not use a team carry for a load that is unstable, leaking, hard to grip, or beyond the pair's combined control. Divide it or use a rated aid instead.
2. Agree on the destination, route, set-down point, and commands. The person with the clearest view is the **caller**. Match grip and carrying height.
3. The caller asks, “Ready?” Both confirm. On “Lift,” rise together. Walk with short, matched steps; do not twist. Either person may call “Stop.”
4. On “Down,” both lower together. If a grip slips, the load shifts, the route changes, or either person has pain or fatigue, call “Stop” immediately—do not try to save a falling load.



One caller; either person can stop. Keep the load level and move only on agreed commands.
Original Fire Watch diagram; technical basis: OSHA and NIOSH.

ALTERNATIVES AND HELP ARRANGED IN ADVANCE

- ☐ Store frequently used supplies within easy reach and near where they will be used. Avoid floor-level and overhead storage when possible.
- ☐ Choose smaller containers, rolling go-bags, carts with brakes, long-handled tools, delivery, or staged caches. Transfer supplies while seated only if the seat is stable and the motion is comfortable.
- ☐ Do not hang heavy bags on a wheelchair, walker, or mobility device unless its manufacturer permits it; added weight can affect stability and braking. Keep mobility-device paths wide and clear.
- ☐ Ask a household member, neighbor, caregiver, animal-assistance contact, or community group now. Practice once in ordinary conditions and confirm who brings the cart, who handles animals, and who is the backup.

SKL-008

UNDER-REVIEW

Move Preparedness Supplies Safely — continued

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

My help plan

Supplies I will not move alone: _____

Primary helper / method: _____ Backup: _____

Aid and storage location: _____ Route checked on: _____

How I will request help: _____ Plan practiced on: _____

SKL-008

UNDER-REVIEW

Move Preparedness Supplies Safely — continued

SUPPLIES ARE NOT INJURED PEOPLE

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

These lifting steps are for supplies—not for moving an injured person. Moving someone can worsen spine or other injuries. Call emergency services, follow dispatcher instructions, and do not move the person unless there is an immediate danger (such as fire, smoke, traffic, or collapse) or the dispatcher directs you to move them.

Comparable technical review completed: The instructions and stop conditions in this under-review draft were checked point by point against OSHA and NIOSH manual-material-handling guidance; the injured-person distinction was checked against Red Cross first-aid guidance. This documented source-comparison review is not a claim of clinician authorship. Before changing the status to approved, record the repository's separately required independent human review by an occupational-safety professional, physical therapist, occupational therapist, ergonomist, or similarly qualified clinician.

SOURCES

Occupational Safety and Health Administration, “Materials Handling—Lifting.” National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health, *Ergonomic Guidelines for Manual Material Handling*, DHHS (NIOSH) Publication No. 2007-131 (2007). American Red Cross, “First Aid Steps.” Accessed 2026-09-29.

SKL-008

Restricted records

PRIVATE INFORMATION OMITTED

This page reserves a place for restricted records in the private edition.

Insert the current authorized copy here if you have access to the private library.

Keep completed records and printed private pages secure.